# TET15-P1: A Three-Field Hu–Washizu Tetrahedron

Research Note

Alejandro Mota[1]*

[1]Mechanics of Materials, Sandia National Laboratories, Livermore, CA 94550, USA

October 22, 2026

**Abstract**

TET15-P1 is a tetrahedral finite element for the large-deformation plasticity of nearly incompressible materials: materials whose bulk modulus $\kappa$, the resistance to a change of volume, is much larger than their shear modulus $\mu$, the resistance to a change of shape, as in rubber and in metals during plastic flow. Three fields — the motion, a scalar volumetric strain and a pressure — are coupled through a Hu–Washizu functional, a functional in which the two auxiliary fields are independent of the motion and tied to it by a constraint term. With both auxiliary fields in one discrete space that is discontinuous between elements, the functional reduces exactly to a functional of the motion alone in which the volumetric strain $\theta(J)$, a function of the Jacobian $J$ of the motion, is replaced element by element by its $L^2$ projection onto that space (mean dilatation), and the auxiliary fields are eliminated element by element. The deviatoric (shape-changing) response is evaluated at the quadrature points, so the constitutive law and its return map, the algorithm that projects a trial stress onto the yield surface, run unchanged, and no quantity other than $\theta$ is projected. In its general form the element calls the material at a modified deformation gradient whose volume is the projected one, and needs nothing of the material beyond its stress and tangent; when the stored energy splits exactly into a volumetric part quadratic in $\theta$ and an isochoric (volume-preserving) part, the pressure equals $\kappa$ times the projected strain at every point and the element needs one projection and one material call per quadrature point. Both forms are implemented; the general one takes one pass more over the quadrature points and, with the $J_2$ model, 1.4 to 2.1 times the split form's time per explicit step on six devices. The choice of $\theta(J)$ is a parameter of the formulation, and two instances of the split form are developed, $\theta = \log J$ with the Hencky material and $\theta = J - 1$ with the $J_2$ plasticity model of Simo and Hughes. The element implemented projects $\theta = \log J$, the volumetric part of the logarithmic strain, in both forms, and the $J_2$ model is used with the volumetric energy $\frac{\kappa}{2}(\log J)^2$ in place of its original $\frac{\kappa}{2}\left[\frac{1}{2}(J^2 - 1) - \log J\right]$ (Remark 5).

The discrete spaces are the three-dimensional Crouzeix–Raviart pair: the quadratic tetrahedron enriched with four cubic face bubbles and one quartic interior bubble, polynomials that vanish on a prescribed part of the element boundary, carried by a nodal basis on fifteen nodes (the TET15 displacement element), over a pressure that is linear in the reference coordinates of each element and discontinuous between elements; the name of the element states the two spaces, fifteen nodes for the displacement and a linear ($P_1$) pressure.

Volumetric locking, the excess stiffness of a discretization as $\kappa/\mu$ grows, and spurious soft modes, discrete displacements of vanishing energy, are failures of the two hypotheses of Brezzi's theorem for the pair of discrete spaces: the inf-sup condition, that every discrete pressure is resisted by some discrete displacement with a constant independent of the mesh, and coercivity of the deviatoric form on the discretely isochoric subspace. The inf-sup constant of the pair is measured over a mesh sequence at 0.2968, against 0.2216 for the Taylor–Hood pair (continuous quadratic displacement over continuous linear pressure), whose stability is established; of seven element-local pairs two are stable and five decay. Under a plastic tangent that removes the shear stiffness along the flow direction, the coercivity constant cannot separate pairs, and what separates them is the dilatation carried by their softest modes: 0.20 to 0.27 without decay under refinement for elements with a constant pressure, CT10 of Albany-LCM [12] with its volume-averaged $J$ among them, against a decay as the square of the mesh size $h$ for the

*Email: amota@sandia.gov

Crouzeix–Raviart pair, which in a confined plastic zone has no spurious mode among its twenty softest where the constant-pressure elements retain between five and nineteen.

On Cook's membrane in three dimensions at Poisson's ratio 0.4999, on three meshes of 327 to 14 475 elements, TET15-P1 and CT10 agree in the tip displacement within 0.6% on every mesh, and their pressure fields are smooth away from the singular clamped edge, where the pressure of the quadratic tetrahedron without projection changes sign inside elements over the whole membrane; in the plastic case at Poisson's ratio 0.29 every element converges to the same tip displacement within 0.5% on the finest mesh. A fourteen-point quadrature rule exact to degree five is the smallest that leaves the element its six rigid-body modes, the row-sum lumped mass of the nodal basis is positive, and the explicit stable step is 3.3 times smaller than that of the linear tetrahedron. On the Taylor bar impact in explicit dynamics, with plastic strains above 3, TET15-P1 gives the final radius within 0.05% of the converged value on 25 029 elements, where CT10 needs 1.5 million elements for 0.09%, at 1/67 of its core-seconds on the same machine; per element and time step on one core it takes 1.40 times as long. The smoothness of the equivalent plastic strain, the accumulated norm of the plastic strain increments, in problems with localized plastic flow is not measured here.

**Keywords:** tetrahedral finite element, mixed formulation, Hu–Washizu functional, inf-sup condition, volumetric locking, finite-deformation plasticity

# 1 Problem statement

Tetrahedra are the only practical choice for meshing complex geometry automatically. Their accuracy is insufficient in four regimes: near-incompressible response at bulk-to-shear modulus ratios $\kappa/\mu \lesssim 10^4$, with $\kappa$ the bulk modulus and $\mu$ the shear modulus; isochoric (volume-preserving) plasticity; large rotation; and weak shocks, pressure waves of small amplitude, in materials of high $\kappa/\mu$. The target is one spatial formulation for all four, with the time integrator the only difference between the quasi-static and the dynamic regimes.

Two established remedies fail, and each failure is the failure of one hypothesis of the same theorem; this section identifies the hypothesis in each case.

**Constant pressure relieves locking and introduces soft modes.** CT10, a ten-node tetrahedron subdivided into twelve linear tetrahedra with one element-constant pressure [28, 20], and its five-field extension [12] relieve volumetric locking — the stiffening of a discretization whose displacement space contains too few discrete isochoric fields — with that pressure. Foulk III et al. [12] report that this choice — and it is the choice, not the element — produces a deleterious soft mode "common to both the quadratic and CT10 elementsl element with constant pressure formulations," remedied there by a convex energy penalty. The mechanism is a coercivity failure on the discretely isochoric subspace: an element-constant multiplier does not resist displacement patterns whose volume change varies within the element and averages to zero, so those patterns carry only shear energy. In elasticity every projected-pressure element has such patterns, and a stable pair keeps their energy bounded away from zero; in a confined plastic zone the shear response softens along the flow direction and the pattern can approach zero energy. Section 9.4 shows that on the quadratic tetrahedron these patterns are not exactly of zero energy, and Section 6 states the question that count does not settle.

**Residual-based stabilization contaminates the deviator.** Variational-multiscale stabilization of linear tetrahedra [22] introduces a subgrid pressure of the form

$$p' = c_1\,\tau_{\mathrm{s}}\,(\kappa\,\mathrm{Div}\,\dot{\boldsymbol{\varphi}} - \dot{p})\,, \qquad \tau_{\mathrm{s}} = c_2\,\Delta t, \tag{1}$$

with $c_1$ and $c_2$ tuned coefficients, which is added to the stress before the constitutive update is evaluated. Two consequences follow. The spatial solution depends on the time step $\Delta t$ through $\tau_{\mathrm{s}}$, so there is no quasi-static limit independent of it. The coefficient $c_2$ scales a term that reaches the deviator, and therefore the plastic return map — the algorithm that projects a trial stress onto the yield surface — which is the origin of the oscillations in the equivalent plastic strain, the accumulated norm of the plastic strain increments. No choice of $c_2$ removes this, because the term enters the deviator by construction.

**The common cause.** Brezzi's theorem for the mixed problem asks two things of the pair — the discrete space $U_h$ for the displacement together with the discrete space $Q_h$ for the pressure [5, §3.4, §5.2]: the inf-sup condition, that every pressure mode be resisted by some displacement, whose failure is locking on one side and spurious pressure on the other; and coercivity of the deviatoric form on the discretely isochoric subspace $\ker \boldsymbol{G}_h$, that no displacement the pressure does not resist have zero deviatoric energy, whose failure is a soft mode. The first is a property of the pair alone and is settled in Section 9.5. The second depends on the material tangent as well as on the pair, and Section 6 states what this note claims about it. Neither difficulty is a stabilization problem: the remedy for the first is a pair satisfying the inf-sup condition uniformly in the mesh size, and the second must then be checked where the material can violate it. Section 2 defines both hypotheses.

**Organization.** Section 2 defines volumetric locking, the mixed problem, the inf-sup condition and Brezzi's theorem, and gives the construction by which bubble functions satisfy the inf-sup condition. Section 3 states the continuum formulation and its reduction to mean dilatation. Section 4 defines the discrete spaces, the element, its quadrature rule and mass, and the element algorithm in the form an implementation needs. Section 5 gives the plasticity model. Section 6 states the claim about soft modes under a plastic tangent, Section 7 the explicit time integration, and Section 8 an optional extension. Section 9 reports the measurements on the linearized operator, Section 10 the nonlinear results on Cook's membrane, Section 11 the Taylor bar impact in explicit dynamics, and Sections 13 and 14 summarize the evidence, the open measurements and the limitations.

# 2 Background: locking, the mixed problem and the inf-sup condition

This section defines the terms the rest of the note uses. The setting is small-strain isotropic elasticity, because every stability property below is measured on the linearized operator at the undeformed state (Section 4.1); the notation $\boldsymbol{\epsilon}(\boldsymbol{v}) := \operatorname{sym}\operatorname{Grad}\boldsymbol{v}$ is the small strain of a displacement $\boldsymbol{v}$, $\operatorname{dev}\boldsymbol{\epsilon} := \boldsymbol{\epsilon} - \frac{1}{3}(\operatorname{tr}\boldsymbol{\epsilon})\boldsymbol{I}$ its deviatoric part, and $\operatorname{Div}\boldsymbol{v} = \operatorname{tr}\boldsymbol{\epsilon}(\boldsymbol{v})$ its volume change.

## 2.1 Why low-order tetrahedra lock

The stored energy of an isotropic linear elastic material,

$$W(\boldsymbol{\epsilon}) = \mu|\operatorname{dev}\boldsymbol{\epsilon}|^2 + \tfrac{\kappa}{2}(\operatorname{tr}\boldsymbol{\epsilon})^2, \tag{2}$$

assigns the energy $\kappa/2$ per unit squared volume change and $\mu$ per unit squared shape change. As $\kappa/\mu$ grows, minimizing the energy over a discrete displacement space drives $\operatorname{Div}\boldsymbol{u}_h$ toward zero at every quadrature point, a point of the integration rule: in the limit the discrete solution is confined to the discrete displacements whose volume change vanishes at every quadrature point. Whether that subspace is rich enough to represent the deformation is a matter of counting. The divergence of a linear tetrahedron is constant, so each element imposes one constraint; a mesh with six tetrahedra per vertex, the count of the structured meshes of Section 9.1, has about six constraints per vertex against three displacement unknowns per vertex, two constraints per unknown. Few displacements satisfy all of them, so the discrete solid is far stiffer than the material, by an amount that grows with $\kappa/\mu$ and does not decrease with the mesh size. That is volumetric locking. The quadratic tetrahedron has a linear divergence, four constraints per element against about $2 \cdot 3 = 6$ unknowns per element on the same meshes (Section 9.3), and locks as well.

The remedy is to impose the constraint in an average sense, through an independent pressure field that acts as its Lagrange multiplier, the force that enforces it. This is a mixed method: a method with two independent discrete fields, displacement and pressure, whose behavior depends on the pair of discrete spaces chosen for them.

## 2.2 The mixed problem and the two hypotheses of Brezzi's theorem

In the incompressible limit the mixed problem reads: find the displacement $\boldsymbol{u}_h \in U_h$ and the pressure $p_h \in Q_h$ with

$$\begin{aligned} a(\boldsymbol{u}_h, \boldsymbol{v}) + b(\boldsymbol{v}, p_h) &= f(\boldsymbol{v}) \quad \text{for all } \boldsymbol{v} \in U_h, \\ b(\boldsymbol{u}_h, q) - \tfrac{1}{\kappa}\,(p_h, q) &= 0 \qquad \text{for all } q \in Q_h, \end{aligned} \tag{3}$$

with

$$a(\boldsymbol{u}, \boldsymbol{v}) := 2\mu \int_\Omega \operatorname{dev} \boldsymbol{\epsilon}(\boldsymbol{u}) : \operatorname{dev} \boldsymbol{\epsilon}(\boldsymbol{v})\, \mathrm{d}V, \qquad b(\boldsymbol{v}, q) := \int_\Omega q\, \operatorname{Div} \boldsymbol{v}\, \mathrm{d}V, \tag{4}$$

with $f$ the work of the external loads and $(\cdot,\cdot)$ the $L^2$ inner product; $a$ is the deviatoric energy form, $b$ the work of the pressure on the volume change, and the second equation is the constitutive relation $p = \kappa \operatorname{Div} \boldsymbol{u}$ tested against the pressure space, which becomes the constraint $b(\boldsymbol{u}_h, q) = 0$ as $\kappa \to \infty$. Brezzi's theorem [6], [5, Theorem 5.2.1 and §5.2], gives two conditions under which (3) has a unique solution that converges to the continuum one with constants independent of the mesh size $h$.

**The inf-sup condition.** There is a $\beta > 0$, independent of $h$, with

$$\beta_h := \inf_{q \in Q_h} \sup_{\boldsymbol{v} \in U_h} \frac{\displaystyle\int_\Omega q\, \operatorname{Div} \boldsymbol{v}\, \mathrm{d}V}{\|q\|_{L^2}\, \|\operatorname{Grad} \boldsymbol{v}\|_{L^2}} \;\geq\; \beta. \tag{5}$$

In words: every discrete pressure does work on the volume change of some discrete displacement, in a ratio bounded below independently of the mesh. The condition is also named after Ladyzhenskaya, Babuška and Brezzi (LBB). Its failure has two forms. If $\beta_h = 0$ there is a pressure mode that no displacement resists: the pressure is not determined, modes of alternating sign between neighboring elements appear, and the system becomes singular as $\kappa/\mu \to \infty$; the pair $P_1/P_0$ (linear displacement, constant pressure) has 45 such modes on the coarsest mesh of Section 9.5 and 558 on the finest. If $\beta_h > 0$ on every mesh but $\beta_h \to 0$ under refinement, the pressure is determined but the error grows with $1/\beta_h$: the stresses oscillate and the displacement is too stiff, and locking returns as the mesh is refined.

**Coercivity on the discretely isochoric subspace.** There is an $\alpha > 0$, independent of $h$, with

$$a(\boldsymbol{v}, \boldsymbol{v}) \;\geq\; \alpha\, \|\operatorname{Grad} \boldsymbol{v}\|_{L^2}^2 \quad \text{for all } \boldsymbol{v} \in \ker \boldsymbol{G}_h := \{\boldsymbol{v} \in U_h : b(\boldsymbol{v}, q) = 0 \text{ for all } q \in Q_h\}. \tag{6}$$

In words: every nonzero discrete displacement whose volume change the pressure space does not see has a deviatoric energy bounded below. A displacement in $\ker \boldsymbol{G}_h$ with zero deviatoric energy has no stiffness at all; it is a spurious soft mode.

**The error estimate.** Under both hypotheses [5, Theorem 5.2.2],

$$\|\operatorname{Grad}(\boldsymbol{u} - \boldsymbol{u}_h)\| + \|p - p_h\| \;\leq\; C\Big(1 + \frac{1}{\alpha}\Big)\Big(1 + \frac{1}{\beta_h}\Big)\Big[\inf_{\boldsymbol{v} \in U_h} \|\operatorname{Grad}(\boldsymbol{u} - \boldsymbol{v})\| + \inf_{q \in Q_h} \|p - q\|\Big]\,: \tag{7}$$

the error is at most a factor times the best approximation the two spaces allow, and the factor is what the two constants control.

**Measuring $\beta_h$.** With $\{\boldsymbol{\phi}_i\}$ a basis of $U_h$, the functions of nodes on the fixed boundary excluded, and $\{\chi_m\}$ a basis of $Q_h$, let

$$K_{ij} = \int_\Omega \operatorname{Grad} \boldsymbol{\phi}_i : \operatorname{Grad} \boldsymbol{\phi}_j\, \mathrm{d}V, \qquad G_{mi} = \int_\Omega \chi_m\, \operatorname{Div} \boldsymbol{\phi}_i\, \mathrm{d}V, \qquad M_{mn} = \int_\Omega \chi_m \chi_n\, \mathrm{d}V, \tag{8}$$

the Gram matrix of the norm $\|\operatorname{Grad} \boldsymbol{v}\|$, the discrete constraint operator and the pressure mass matrix. For a fixed pressure vector $q$ the largest value over $\boldsymbol{v}$ of $(q^{\mathsf{T}}\boldsymbol{G}\boldsymbol{v})^2/\boldsymbol{v}^{\mathsf{T}}\boldsymbol{K}\boldsymbol{v}$ is $q^{\mathsf{T}}\boldsymbol{G}\boldsymbol{K}^{-1}\boldsymbol{G}^{\mathsf{T}}q$, so

$$\beta_h^2 = \lambda_{\min}^{\neq 0}\big(\boldsymbol{G}\boldsymbol{K}^{-1}\boldsymbol{G}^{\mathsf{T}},\ \boldsymbol{M}\big), \tag{9}$$

the smallest nonzero generalized eigenvalue [8]. With the whole boundary fixed the constant pressure does no work on any admissible displacement, so one eigenvalue is always zero and is excluded; any further zero is an unresisted pressure mode. Section 9.1 gives the computation.

### 2.3 How the enriched pair satisfies the inf-sup condition

A sufficient condition for (5) is the existence of a Fortin operator [11], [5, §5.4]: a linear map $\Pi_h$ from the continuum displacement space into $U_h$ with

$$b(\boldsymbol{v} - \Pi_h \boldsymbol{v}, q) = 0 \text{ for all } q \in Q_h, \qquad \|\mathrm{Grad}\, \Pi_h \boldsymbol{v}\| \le C_\Pi \|\mathrm{Grad}\, \boldsymbol{v}\|, \tag{10}$$

which gives $\beta_h \ge \beta / C_\Pi$ with $\beta$ the continuum inf-sup constant. The operator must reproduce, for every $q$ in $Q_h$, the work of $q$ on the volume change of $\boldsymbol{v}$, with a bounded gradient. For a pressure that is linear on each element $T$, a tetrahedron of the mesh, and discontinuous between elements, integration by parts on one element,

$$\int_T q\, \mathrm{Div}\, \boldsymbol{w}\, \mathrm{d}V = -\int_T \mathrm{Grad}\, q \cdot \boldsymbol{w}\, \mathrm{d}V + \int_{\partial T} q\, \boldsymbol{w} \cdot \boldsymbol{n}\, \mathrm{d}S, \tag{11}$$

shows what has to be matched: the flux $\boldsymbol{w} \cdot \boldsymbol{n}$ weighted by $q$ on each face, and the interior integral of $\boldsymbol{w}$ against the constant $\mathrm{Grad}\, q$. Two kinds of bubble supply the two parts. A face bubble $b_F$, a cubic polynomial that vanishes on the three other faces of the element, times the face normal $\boldsymbol{n}_F$, changes the boundary term on face $F$ alone and controls the mean of $q$ on that face, and with it the jump of the pressure between the two elements sharing $F$; four face bubbles per element control the element mean of $q$ and its values on the faces. The interior bubble $b_T$, a quartic polynomial that vanishes on the whole element boundary, times $\mathrm{Grad}\, q$, changes the interior term alone: $\int_T q\, \mathrm{Div}(b_T\, \mathrm{Grad}\, q)\, \mathrm{d}V = -\int_T b_T |\mathrm{Grad}\, q|^2\, \mathrm{d}V < 0$ for $\mathrm{Grad}\, q \neq 0$, so it controls the gradient of the pressure inside each element. Face bubbles alone leave the linear part of the pressure uncontrolled, and the interior bubble alone leaves the constant part uncontrolled: it vanishes on the boundary, so its volume change has zero mean on the element and does no work on a constant pressure (Remark 7). The displacement space with both enrichments over the linear discontinuous pressure is the three-dimensional Crouzeix–Raviart pair [10], [5, Example 8.7.2], whose stability in three dimensions, for the whole family of Crouzeix–Raviart elements, is also proved by Sauter and Torres [21], and the construction above is the proof of its stability on any shape-regular family of meshes. Section 9.5 measures its constant and confirms that neither enrichment alone suffices.

## 3 Continuum formulation

This section states the kinematics, the stored energy, the three-field functional, its reduction to a displacement functional, the requirements it places on the material, and the stress it produces.

### 3.1 Kinematics and the volumetric–isochoric split

A body $\Omega \subset \mathbb{R}^3$ undergoes a motion $\boldsymbol{x} = \boldsymbol{\varphi}(\boldsymbol{X}, t)$ with deformation gradient $\boldsymbol{F} := \mathrm{Grad}\, \boldsymbol{\varphi}$ and Jacobian $J := \det \boldsymbol{F} > 0$. The multiplicative factorization

$$\boldsymbol{F} = J^{1/3} \bar{\boldsymbol{F}}, \qquad \bar{\boldsymbol{F}} := J^{-1/3} \boldsymbol{F}, \qquad \det \bar{\boldsymbol{F}} = 1, \tag{12}$$

separates the two kinematic contributions this formulation treats differently: the mixed treatment acts on $J$ alone, and the plasticity on $\bar{\boldsymbol{F}}$ alone.

The mixed field is a scalar function of $J$ alone. Let

$$\theta = \theta(J), \qquad \theta'(J) > 0, \qquad \theta(1) = 0, \qquad \theta'(1) = 1, \tag{13}$$

be a strictly increasing volumetric strain measure, normalized to vanish with unit slope in the undeformed state. The normalization has two consequences. It makes $\kappa$ in (15) the physical bulk modulus for every admissible $\theta$, so that two instances of the formulation are calibrated to the same material rather than to two different ones. And since $\partial J / \partial \boldsymbol{F} = J \boldsymbol{F}^{-\mathsf{T}}$,

$$\frac{\partial \theta}{\partial \boldsymbol{F}} = \theta'(J)\, J\, \boldsymbol{F}^{-\mathsf{T}}, \tag{14}$$

so (13) also forces $\partial\theta / \partial \boldsymbol{F} = \boldsymbol{I}$ at $\boldsymbol{F} = \boldsymbol{I}$ for every admissible $\theta$ (Section 4.1).

Two choices are used below and are developed in Section 3.7: the logarithmic measure $\theta = \log J$, and $\theta = J - 1$. Both satisfy (13), and by Remark 1 they nevertheless give different elements.

### 3.2 Stored energy

The formulation is developed for a stored energy that splits exactly along (12), with a volumetric part quadratic in $\theta$:

$$W(\boldsymbol{F}) = W^{\mathrm{vol}}(\theta) + W^{\mathrm{iso}}(\bar{\boldsymbol{F}}), \qquad W^{\mathrm{vol}}(\theta) = \tfrac{\kappa}{2}\theta^2. \tag{15}$$

Section 3.5 states what each half of (15) requires of the material.

Given (15), the volumetric constitutive relation is linear,

$$p = \partial W^{\mathrm{vol}}/\partial\theta = \kappa\theta, \tag{16}$$

and it is this linearity — not the choice of $\theta$, and not the logarithmic measure specifically — that makes the discrete pressure equal $\kappa\bar{\theta}$ pointwise in Section 4.2. The elimination itself rests on less, as Section 3.5 shows.

The isochoric response is the $W^{\mathrm{iso}}$ the material supplies. It is evaluated at the pointwise $\bar{\boldsymbol{F}}$ and is never projected, which is the property Section 5 requires. Plasticity acts entirely inside $W^{\mathrm{iso}}$, through an isochoric internal variable evolved by a return map; neither (15) nor (16) changes when it does.

### 3.3 Three-field functional

Only the volumetric response is treated mixedly. Introduce an independent volumetric strain $\bar{\theta}$ and constrain it to $\theta(\boldsymbol{\varphi})$ through a multiplier $\bar{p}$, which at stationarity is the pressure:

$$\begin{aligned}\Pi[\boldsymbol{\varphi},\bar{\theta},\bar{p}] := &\int_\Omega W^{\mathrm{vol}}(\bar{\theta})\,\mathrm{d}V + \int_\Omega W^{\mathrm{iso}}\big(\bar{\boldsymbol{F}}(\boldsymbol{\varphi})\big)\,\mathrm{d}V + \int_\Omega \bar{p}\,\big(\theta(\boldsymbol{\varphi}) - \bar{\theta}\big)\,\mathrm{d}V \\ &- \int_\Omega \rho_0\,\boldsymbol{b}\cdot\boldsymbol{\varphi}\,\mathrm{d}V - \int_{\partial_T\Omega} \boldsymbol{T}\cdot\boldsymbol{\varphi}\,\mathrm{d}S,\end{aligned} \tag{17}$$

with $\rho_0$ the reference density, $\boldsymbol{b}$ the body force per unit mass, and $\boldsymbol{T}$ the traction prescribed on the part $\partial_T\Omega$ of the boundary. The isochoric energy is evaluated at the pointwise $\bar{\boldsymbol{F}}(\boldsymbol{\varphi})$ — for the Hencky instance of Section 3.7, at $\boldsymbol{e}(\boldsymbol{\varphi})$ — and carries no auxiliary field; Remark 3 gives the reason.

### 3.4 Reduction to the mean-dilatation formulation

With $\bar{\theta}$ and $\bar{p}$ in one discrete space, (17) reduces to the mean-dilatation formulation of Simo et al. [25]; this section gives the reduction.

Put $\bar{\theta}$ and $\bar{p}$ in the same discrete space $Q_h$, as Section 4.1 requires. Stationarity in $\bar{\theta}$ then gives $\bar{p} = \kappa\bar{\theta}$ exactly rather than after a projection, and stationarity in $\bar{p}$ gives $\bar{\theta} = \mathcal{P}_h\,\theta$, the $L^2$ projection of $\theta$ onto $Q_h$. The constraint term of (17) then vanishes identically:

$$\int_\Omega \bar{p}\,\big(\theta - \bar{\theta}\big)\,\mathrm{d}V = \kappa\int_\Omega \bar{\theta}\,(\theta - \mathcal{P}_h\theta)\,\mathrm{d}V = 0, \tag{18}$$

because $\kappa\bar{\theta} \in Q_h$ while $(\theta - \mathcal{P}_h\theta) \perp Q_h$ by the definition of the projection. What is left is a functional in the motion alone,

$$\Pi[\boldsymbol{\varphi}] = \int_\Omega W^{\mathrm{iso}}\big(\bar{\boldsymbol{F}}(\boldsymbol{\varphi})\big)\,\mathrm{d}V + \int_\Omega \tfrac{\kappa}{2}\,(\mathcal{P}_h\theta)^2\,\mathrm{d}V, \tag{19}$$

whose stationarity conditions are exactly the three-field equations of Section 3.8.

Equation (19) is the mean-dilatation formulation of Simo et al. [25], in which the volumetric strain is replaced by its projection onto an element-wise space, and the mechanism of the $\bar{B}$ family (projected strain–displacement operator) and the $\bar{F}$ family (projected deformation gradient) of elements; Boffi et al. [5, §8.12] set out the relation between reduced integration, projected pressure, and the mixed method it is equivalent to. The reduction is exact by (18), and no property of $\theta$ or of $W^{\mathrm{vol}}$ enters it: the exactness is a property of the discretization, that the two auxiliary fields share one space. What the material must supply is stated in Section 3.5, and the quantity the formulation leaves open is $Q_h$, which Section 4.1 selects and Section 9 measures.

Table 1: What seven material models satisfy. Column 2 is the spread of $W(\boldsymbol{F}) - W(\bar{\boldsymbol{F}})$ across twenty random isochoric parts at each of four fixed $J \in [0.85, 1.2]$, relative to its own magnitude; a spread below $10^{-12}$ means the split (20) holds to rounding error. Columns 3 and 4 are the relative residual of a least-squares fit of the extracted $W^{\mathrm{vol}}(J) = W(J^{1/3}\boldsymbol{I}) - W(\boldsymbol{I})$ over $J \in [0.8, 1.25]$ to a quadratic in each candidate volumetric variable; in both exact cases the fitted coefficient is $\kappa/2$ to five digits. Two materials admit a quadratic $W^{\mathrm{vol}}$, and they disagree on the variable. Script: `prototype/materials.jl`, which needs Norma.

| | split (20) | $W^{\mathrm{vol}}$ quadratic in | |
|---|---|---|---|
| material | spread at fixed $J$ | $J-1$ | $\log J$ |
| Linear elastic | $2.0 \times 10^{0}$ | — | — |
| Saint-Venant Kirchhoff | $3.0 \times 10^{1}$ | — | — |
| Neo-Hookean | $4.2 \times 10^{-13}$ | $5.9 \times 10^{-2}$ | $1.3 \times 10^{-1}$ |
| Reciprocal neo-Hookean | $4.8 \times 10^{-13}$ | $1.8 \times 10^{-1}$ | $6.5 \times 10^{-3}$ |
| Seth–Hill ($m = n = 1$) | $4.3 \times 10^{-13}$ | $1.8 \times 10^{-1}$ | $6.5 \times 10^{-3}$ |
| Hencky | $1.4 \times 10^{-13}$ | $1.8 \times 10^{-1}$ | $\mathbf{1.7 \times 10^{-15}}$ |
| $J_2$, Simo–Hughes | $5.9 \times 10^{-13}$ | $\mathbf{5.3 \times 10^{-15}}$ | $1.8 \times 10^{-1}$ |

## 3.5 Requirements on the material

This section states what each half of (15) requires of the material, together with a third condition that is not a requirement of this section, and reports which materials meet them. The two conditions are those of the form of the element implemented, in which the material is called once per quadrature point and the pressure equals $\kappa\bar{\theta}$ at every point; Section 3.6 gives the form of the element for a material that satisfies neither, at the price of one projection and one pass more.

**An exact volumetric–isochoric split.** This condition is the one that lets the element call the material at the pointwise deformation. The element evaluates $W$ at the pointwise deformation, subtracts the pointwise volumetric energy and adds it back at the projected strain, so the subtraction must leave no volumetric remainder:

$$W(\boldsymbol{F}) = W^{\mathrm{vol}}(J) + W^{\mathrm{iso}}(\bar{\boldsymbol{F}}), \qquad \bar{\boldsymbol{F}} := J^{-1/3}\boldsymbol{F}, \qquad \det \bar{\boldsymbol{F}} = 1. \tag{20}$$

Whether a material satisfies (20) is decidable without knowing $W^{\mathrm{vol}}$: if the split exists then $W(\boldsymbol{F}) - W(\bar{\boldsymbol{F}}) = W^{\mathrm{vol}}(J) - W^{\mathrm{vol}}(1)$ depends on $J$ alone, so holding $J$ fixed while varying the isochoric part must leave the difference unmoved. Column 2 of Table 1 is that test, run over seven material models: linear elasticity, Saint-Venant–Kirchhoff, neo-Hookean, reciprocal neo-Hookean, Seth–Hill, Hencky and the $J_2$ plasticity model of Simo and Hughes [24], as implemented in the finite-element code Norma. Five of the seven satisfy it.

**A quadratic $W^{\mathrm{vol}}$.** This condition is a convenience and not a necessity. Stationarity in $\bar{p}$ gives $\bar{\theta} = \mathcal{P}_h\theta$ regardless of the material, and stationarity in $\bar{\theta}$ then gives

$$\bar{p} = \mathcal{P}_h\big(\partial W^{\mathrm{vol}}/\partial\bar{\theta}\big) \tag{21}$$

in general — the projection of a known function of the already computed $\bar{\theta}$, one more mass-matrix solve with a nonlinear integrand and nothing implicit. When $W^{\mathrm{vol}}$ is quadratic its derivative is linear, $\kappa\bar{\theta}$ already lies in $Q_h$, the projection in (21) is the identity, and $\bar{p} = \kappa\bar{\theta}$ holds pointwise; otherwise $\bar{p} = \mathcal{P}_h W^{\mathrm{vol}\prime}(\mathcal{P}_h\theta)$ is a doubly projected pressure. The reduction (19) is exact either way, with $W^{\mathrm{vol}}(\mathcal{P}_h\theta)$ in place of the quadratic, and the elimination of Section 4.2 is linear either way; what the quadratic case gives is the pointwise relation and one projection fewer.

**The logarithmic measure itself.** This condition is required by nothing in the present section. It is required by Section 5.

**The case developed here.** The formulation is developed in detail for materials satisfying (20) with a quadratic $W^{\mathrm{vol}}$, because that is where the pointwise relation holds. Table 1 admits exactly two, and they do not agree on the variable: Hencky is quadratic in $\log J$ to $1.7 \times 10^{-15}$, and the Simo–Hughes $J_2$ model in its

original form is quadratic in $J-1$ to $5.3\times10^{-15}$. Each is exact in its own variable and wrong by 18% in the other, so material and volumetric variable are not independently selectable, and neither choice generalizes to the other material. Section 3.7 develops both.

The three remaining split materials — neo-Hookean, its reciprocal, and Seth–Hill — are admissible with one projection more (Section 3.6) and are not developed further.

### 3.6 General materials

This section gives the element for a material that does not satisfy the conditions of Section 3.5. Two cases are distinguished by what the material exposes. In the first the split (20) exists and is accessible, and only the volumetric energy $W^{\mathrm{vol}}(\theta)$ is not quadratic. In the second nothing is accessible beyond what every finite-element code obtains from a material model: the stored energy $W(\boldsymbol{F})$, the first Piola–Kirchhoff stress $\boldsymbol{P}(\boldsymbol{F})=\partial W/\partial\boldsymbol{F}$ and the tangent $\mathbb{A}(\boldsymbol{F})=\partial^2W/\partial\boldsymbol{F}\partial\boldsymbol{F}$, with the internal variables the model carries. The second case is the general one: it applies to a code whose material models cannot be modified, and it contains the first and the split form as special cases.

**Case 1: an accessible split with a non-quadratic volumetric energy.** Nothing in Section 3.3 changes. With $\bar\theta$ and $\bar p$ in one space $Q_h$, stationarity in $\bar p$ gives $\bar\theta=\mathcal{P}_h\theta$ as before, and stationarity in $\bar\theta$ gives

$$\int_\Omega \big(W^{\mathrm{vol}\prime}(\bar\theta)-\bar p\big)\,q\,\mathrm{d}V=0 \text{ for all } q\in Q_h, \qquad \text{that is} \qquad \bar p=\mathcal{P}_h\,W^{\mathrm{vol}\prime}(\bar\theta), \tag{22}$$

the projection of a known function of the already computed $\bar\theta$. The constraint term of (17) vanishes as in (18), because $\bar p$ lies in $Q_h$ and $\theta-\mathcal{P}_h\theta$ is orthogonal to it, so the functional reduces to

$$\Pi[\boldsymbol{\varphi}]=\int_\Omega W^{\mathrm{iso}}\big(\bar{\boldsymbol{F}}(\boldsymbol{\varphi})\big)\;\mathrm{d}V+\int_\Omega W^{\mathrm{vol}}(\mathcal{P}_h\theta)\;\mathrm{d}V, \tag{23}$$

whose derivative reproduces (22), since $\mathcal{P}_h$ is self-adjoint in $L^2$: $\int W^{\mathrm{vol}\prime}(\bar\theta)\,\mathcal{P}_h(\delta\theta)\,\mathrm{d}V=\int\mathcal{P}_hW^{\mathrm{vol}\prime}(\bar\theta)\,\delta\theta\,\mathrm{d}V$. The stress at a quadrature point is (43) with this $\bar p$. Four things follow.

1. With the constant projection nothing changes: $\bar\theta$ is constant on the element, so $W^{\mathrm{vol}\prime}(\bar\theta)$ is constant and the projection in (22) is the identity. This is the mean-dilatation element of Simo et al. [25], which was formulated for a general $W^{\mathrm{vol}}$.

2. With the linear projection the pressure is projected twice, and $\bar p(\boldsymbol{\xi}_q)\neq W^{\mathrm{vol}\prime}(\bar\theta(\boldsymbol{\xi}_q))$: the pressure at a quadrature point is not the constitutive response of the projected strain at that point. Using $W^{\mathrm{vol}\prime}(\bar\theta(\boldsymbol{\xi}_q))$ there instead is not the derivative of any functional, gives an unsymmetric tangent and fails the consistency checks of Section 4.5; it is not admissible.

3. The tangent replaces the constant matrix $\kappa\boldsymbol{D}\boldsymbol{M}^{-1}\boldsymbol{D}^{\mathsf{T}}$ of Section 4.4 by $\boldsymbol{D}\boldsymbol{M}^{-1}\tilde{\boldsymbol{U}}\boldsymbol{M}^{-1}\boldsymbol{D}^{\mathsf{T}}$ with $\tilde U_{mn}=\sum_q w_qj_q\,W^{\mathrm{vol}\prime\prime}(\bar\theta_q)\,\chi_m(\boldsymbol{\xi}_q)\chi_n(\boldsymbol{\xi}_q)$, a weighted mass matrix assembled at every iteration, and the volumetric stress $\bar p_q\,\partial\boldsymbol{g}/\partial\boldsymbol{F}$ of (44) uses the projected $\bar p_q$; the tangent stays symmetric. In the linearized problem of Section 2.2 the compressibility term $-(1/\kappa)(p,q)$ becomes a term weighted by $1/W^{\mathrm{vol}\prime\prime}(\bar\theta)$, which varies inside the element and with the deformation; the inf-sup constant $\beta_h$ is unchanged, since it depends only on the spaces and on the constraint operator, and the constants of Brezzi's theorem then involve the smallest and largest values of $W^{\mathrm{vol}\prime\prime}$ over the body, which must be positive: $W^{\mathrm{vol}}$ must be convex in $\theta$ over the range of $\bar\theta$ reached.

4. The second projection can be avoided by a change of variable. Any $W^{\mathrm{vol}}(J)$ with a single minimum at $J=1$ and $W^{\mathrm{vol}\prime\prime}(1)=\kappa>0$ is quadratic in

$$\theta(J):=\operatorname{sign}(J-1)\,\sqrt{2W^{\mathrm{vol}}(J)/\kappa}, \tag{24}$$

which satisfies (13) with $\theta=J-1+O((J-1)^2)$ and is convex-admissible wherever $W^{\mathrm{vol}}$ is. The element of Section 4.4 then applies unchanged with this $\theta$. For the volumetric law $W^{\mathrm{vol}}=\frac{\kappa}{4}(J^2-1-2\log J)$ of Albany-LCM, for example, $\theta^2=(J^2-1-2\log J)/2$. What distinguishes this choice from a non-quadratic $W^{\mathrm{vol}}$ in the variable $J-1$ is the quantity averaged over the element, $\mathcal{P}_h\theta$ against $\theta(\mathcal{P}_h(J-1))$; by Remark 1 the two are different elements that converge to the same solution.

**Case 2: a material without an accessible split.** The element calls the material at a modified deformation gradient whose volume is the projected one. With $J$ the pointwise Jacobian and

$$\tilde{J} := \theta^{-1}\big(\mathcal{P}_h\theta(J)\big), \qquad s := (\tilde{J}/J)^{1/3}, \qquad \tilde{\boldsymbol{F}} := s\,\boldsymbol{F}, \qquad \det\tilde{\boldsymbol{F}} = \tilde{J}, \tag{25}$$

the element is the stationarity of

$$\Pi[\boldsymbol{\varphi}] = \int_\Omega W\big(\tilde{\boldsymbol{F}}(\boldsymbol{\varphi})\big)\,\mathrm{d}V - \Pi_{\mathrm{ext}}. \tag{26}$$

Here $\theta^{-1}$ is the inverse of the strictly increasing $\theta(J)$; for $\theta = J-1$, $\tilde{J} = 1+\mathcal{P}_h(J-1) = \mathcal{P}_h J$, and for $\theta = \log J$, $\tilde{J} = \exp(\mathcal{P}_h \log J)$. The isochoric part of $\tilde{\boldsymbol{F}}$ is that of $\boldsymbol{F}$, since $\tilde{J}^{-1/3}\tilde{\boldsymbol{F}} = J^{-1/3}\boldsymbol{F}$, so the material is evaluated at the pointwise shape change and the projected volume change. Equation (26) is a functional of the motion alone for every material, whether or not its energy splits; it is the mean-dilatation construction of Simo et al. [25] with the projection $\mathcal{P}_h$ in place of the element mean, and with the constant projection and $\theta = J-1$ it is that construction, in which the $\bar{F}$ element of Souza Neto et al. [27] replaces the element mean of $J$ by its value at the centroid. For a material with the split (20), $W(\tilde{\boldsymbol{F}}) = W^{\mathrm{vol}}(\theta(\tilde{J})) + W^{\mathrm{iso}}(\bar{\boldsymbol{F}}) = W^{\mathrm{vol}}(\mathcal{P}_h\theta) + W^{\mathrm{iso}}(\bar{\boldsymbol{F}})$, so (26) is (23), and with a quadratic $W^{\mathrm{vol}}$ it is (19): the general element contains both.

**The residual of case 2.** Let $\tilde{\boldsymbol{P}} := \boldsymbol{P}(\tilde{\boldsymbol{F}})$ be the stress the material returns at $\tilde{\boldsymbol{F}}$, with its internal variables updated there, and let

$$\tilde{p} := \frac{1}{3\tilde{J}}\,\tilde{\boldsymbol{P}} : \tilde{\boldsymbol{F}} = \tfrac{1}{3}\operatorname{tr}\tilde{\boldsymbol{\sigma}} \tag{27}$$

be the mean Cauchy stress at $\tilde{\boldsymbol{F}}$, positive in expansion. The variation of (25) is $\delta\tilde{\boldsymbol{F}} = s\,\delta\boldsymbol{F} + \delta s\,\boldsymbol{F}$ with $\delta s = \frac{s}{3}\,(\delta\tilde{J}/\tilde{J} - \delta J/J)$, $\delta J = J\,\boldsymbol{F}^{-\mathsf{T}} : \delta\boldsymbol{F}$ and $\delta\tilde{J} = \delta\bar{\theta}/\theta'(\tilde{J})$, $\delta\bar{\theta} = \mathcal{P}_h\big(\theta'(J)\,\delta J\big)$. Substituting into $\delta\Pi = \int \tilde{\boldsymbol{P}} : \delta\tilde{\boldsymbol{F}}\,\mathrm{d}V$, using $\tilde{\boldsymbol{P}} : \tilde{\boldsymbol{F}} = 3\tilde{J}\tilde{p}$ and moving the projection onto the other factor by self-adjointness gives the stress that multiplies $\operatorname{Grad}\boldsymbol{\psi}$ at a quadrature point,

$$\boldsymbol{P}_q = s_q\,\tilde{\boldsymbol{P}}_q - \tilde{p}_q\,\tilde{J}_q\,\boldsymbol{F}_q^{-\mathsf{T}} + \bar{p}_q\,\theta'(J_q)\,J_q\,\boldsymbol{F}_q^{-\mathsf{T}}, \qquad \bar{p} := \mathcal{P}_h\!\left(\frac{\tilde{p}}{\theta'(\tilde{J})}\right), \tag{28}$$

and $\boldsymbol{R}_a = \sum_q w_q j_q\,\boldsymbol{P}_q\operatorname{Grad}N_a(\boldsymbol{\xi}_q)$ as in (43). The first term is the material's stress scaled to the pointwise volume, the second removes its mean part, and the third puts back the projected mean stress with the pointwise volumetric kinematics. For a material with the split, $\tilde{\boldsymbol{P}} = \boldsymbol{P}^{\mathrm{iso}}(\bar{\boldsymbol{F}})\,s^{-1} + W^{\mathrm{vol}\prime}(\bar{\theta})\,\theta'(\tilde{J})\,\tilde{J}\,\tilde{\boldsymbol{F}}^{-\mathsf{T}}$, the isochoric stress does no work on $\tilde{\boldsymbol{F}}$, and (28) reduces to (43) with $\bar{p} = \mathcal{P}_h W^{\mathrm{vol}\prime}(\bar{\theta})$; with a quadratic $W^{\mathrm{vol}}$ the projection is the identity and $\bar{p} = \kappa\bar{\theta}$. For $\theta = J-1$ and the constant projection, $\bar{p} = \tilde{p}$ on the element and (28) is $\boldsymbol{P}_q = s_q\tilde{\boldsymbol{P}}_q + \tilde{p}\,(J_q - \tilde{J})\,\boldsymbol{F}_q^{-\mathsf{T}}$.

**The passes of case 2.** Three passes over the quadrature points replace the two of Section 4.4. The first computes $\bar{\theta}$ by (42) and, from it, $\tilde{J}_q$ and $s_q$. The second forms $\tilde{\boldsymbol{F}}_q$, calls the material once at each point, stores $\tilde{\boldsymbol{P}}_q$ and $\tilde{p}_q$, and accumulates $\bar{b}_m = \sum_q w_q j_q\,\chi_m(\boldsymbol{\xi}_q)\,\tilde{p}_q/\theta'(\tilde{J}_q)$, from which $\bar{p} = \boldsymbol{M}^{-1}\bar{\boldsymbol{b}}$ with the mass matrix of (42). The third assembles the residual from the stored $\tilde{\boldsymbol{P}}_q$ and (28). The storage is one stress tensor per quadrature point of the element; the material is called once per point per residual, as in the split form. Where the split is accessible the second projection is still exact but the third pass is unnecessary, since $\bar{p}$ follows from $\bar{\theta}$ alone.

**The tangent of case 2.** The tangent is the second derivative of (26). Along two increments with gradients $\delta_1\boldsymbol{F}$ and $\delta_2\boldsymbol{F}$ at the quadrature points,

$$D^2\Pi[\delta_1\boldsymbol{\varphi},\delta_2\boldsymbol{\varphi}] = \sum_q w_q j_q\Big[\delta_1\tilde{\boldsymbol{F}}_q : \mathbb{A}_q : \delta_2\tilde{\boldsymbol{F}}_q + \tilde{\boldsymbol{P}}_q : \big(\delta_1 s_q\,\delta_2\boldsymbol{F}_q + \delta_2 s_q\,\delta_1\boldsymbol{F}_q + \delta_1\delta_2 s_q\,\boldsymbol{F}_q\big)\Big], \tag{29}$$

with $\mathbb{A}_q$ the material tangent at $\tilde{\boldsymbol{F}}_q$, the variations $\delta\tilde{\boldsymbol{F}}$ and $\delta s$ as above, and

$$\begin{aligned}
\delta_1\delta_2 s &= \frac{\delta_1 s}{3}\Big(\frac{\delta_2\tilde{J}}{\tilde{J}} - \frac{\delta_2 J}{J}\Big) + \frac{s}{3}\Big(\frac{\delta_1\delta_2\tilde{J}}{\tilde{J}} - \frac{\delta_1\tilde{J}\,\delta_2\tilde{J}}{\tilde{J}^2} - \frac{\delta_1\delta_2 J}{J} + \frac{\delta_1 J\,\delta_2 J}{J^2}\Big),\\
\delta_1\delta_2 J &= J\,(\boldsymbol{F}^{-\mathsf{T}} : \delta_1\boldsymbol{F})(\boldsymbol{F}^{-\mathsf{T}} : \delta_2\boldsymbol{F}) - J\,\operatorname{tr}\big(\boldsymbol{F}^{-1}\delta_1\boldsymbol{F}\,\boldsymbol{F}^{-1}\delta_2\boldsymbol{F}\big),\\
\delta_1\delta_2\tilde{J} &= \frac{\mathcal{P}_h\big(\theta''(J)\,\delta_1 J\,\delta_2 J + \theta'(J)\,\delta_1\delta_2 J\big)}{\theta'(\tilde{J})} - \frac{\theta''(\tilde{J})}{\theta'(\tilde{J})}\,\delta_1\tilde{J}\,\delta_2\tilde{J}.
\end{aligned} \tag{30}$$

The projection in $\delta\tilde{J}$ couples the quadrature points of the element, as $\delta\bar{\theta}$ does in (44): in matrix form the tangent is the sum of the quadrature-point blocks and of terms of the form $\boldsymbol{D}\boldsymbol{M}^{-1}(\cdot)\boldsymbol{M}^{-1}\boldsymbol{D}^{\mathsf{T}}$ and $\boldsymbol{D}\boldsymbol{M}^{-1}(\cdot)$ with the matrix $\boldsymbol{D}$ of Section 4.4. The tangent is symmetric, and an implementation is verified by the difference checks of Section 4.5: the residual against the energy (26) and the tangent against the residual, which detect any omitted term.

**What the general element changes.** The requirements of Section 3.5 disappear: the material supplies $W$, $\boldsymbol{P}$ and $\mathbb{A}$ and nothing else, and the choice of $\theta(J)$ is free within (13). The return map runs at $\tilde{\boldsymbol{F}}_q$, and the internal variables are updated there, so strain and stress are evaluated at the same point and the same deformation, as Section 5 requires. For a material whose isochoric response depends on $J$, a material without the split, that response is evaluated at $\tilde{J}$ instead of $J$; the difference is of the order of $\theta - \mathcal{P}_h\theta$ and vanishes under refinement. The pressure entering the residual is the projection of the material's own mean stress at $\tilde{\boldsymbol{F}}$, with the pointwise relation between pressure and projected strain recovered only when $W^{\mathrm{vol}}$ is quadratic in $\theta$. The inf-sup constant of the pair is unchanged. Coercivity of the linearized operator requires the material's volumetric tangent, $\partial\tilde{p}/\partial\tilde{J}$ at fixed shape, to be positive over the states reached. The element needs the element-level assembly of Section 4.4 and one pass more, and its cost per element is one material call per quadrature point plus the two $4 \times 4$ solves.

**Implementation.** Both forms are implemented in Carina in one physics type with a form parameter, chosen at setup: the split form when the material exposes the split, the general form otherwise, and the general form on request for any material (input key `volumetric form`). The volumetric variable is a property of the element, not of the material, and is $\theta = \log J$ in both forms; the split form applies to a material whose own volumetric strain is $\log J$, since its pressure $\kappa\bar{\theta}$ is the stationarity condition of the energy $\frac{\kappa}{2}\theta^2$ written in the material's $\theta$, and the general form to any other (Remark 5). The general residual takes the three passes above with the fourteen stresses $\tilde{\boldsymbol{P}}_q$ held on the stack. Calling the material again in the third pass instead of storing them gives the same residual to rounding; on the Taylor bar mesh at $h = 0.75$ mm with the $J_2$ model it takes 1.30 times as long on a CPU with 12 threads, 1.35 on an AMD RX 7600 and 1.48 on an NVIDIA L4, and 0.87 times on a V100, 0.75 on an A100 and 0.74 on an H100 (`benchmark/tet15-p1/taylor/implicit_timing.jl`). Carina stores them. The element matrix and the diagonal and nodal-block kernels of the preconditioners assemble (29) in closed form. The stress $\boldsymbol{P}_q$ of (28) depends on the deformation gradient at its own point and on the element only through $\bar{\theta}$ and $\bar{p}$, so that its variation is $\delta\boldsymbol{P}_q = \mathbb{C}_q : \delta\boldsymbol{F}_q + \mathbb{E}_q\,\delta\bar{\theta} + \mathbb{H}_q\,\delta\bar{p}$, with $\mathbb{C}_q$ a $9 \times 9$ matrix and $\mathbb{E}_q$, $\mathbb{H}_q$ $9 \times n_p$ matrices, $n_p$ the number of projection functions; both $\delta\bar{\theta}$ and $\delta\bar{p}$ are sums over the points of the element. The element matrix is then the sum of the quadrature-point matrices $w_q j_q\,\mathbb{G}_q\mathbb{C}_q\mathbb{G}_q^{\mathsf{T}}$, $\mathbb{G}_q$ the discrete gradient, and of two corrections of rank at most $n_p$, and it uses the material tangent $\mathbb{A}_q$ at $\tilde{\boldsymbol{F}}_q$ once per quadrature point. It equals the derivative of the element residual by forward-mode differentiation to rounding, which the kernels used before: that derivative took one pass with three directions per node, fifteen passes per element, each evaluating $\mathbb{A}_q$ at every point. The action on a vector remains one forward-mode pass with one direction, in which the material's stress and tangent at $\tilde{\boldsymbol{F}}_q$ supply the value and the derivative of $\tilde{\boldsymbol{P}}_q$, so that a material that writes its internal variables into real-valued storage is never called with derivative-carrying numbers. On the Taylor bar mesh at $h = 0.75$ mm with the $J_2$ model in plastic flow, the closed form reduced the time of the element matrix from 1078 to 133 ms on a CPU with 12 threads, against 147 ms for the split form, and the time of the diagonal from 1032 to 89 ms against 75 ms; on an AMD RX 7600 the diagonal went from 483 to 54 ms, against 22 ms for the split form, and the action takes 30 ms against 21 ms. Measured on the Taylor bar mesh at $h = 0.75$ mm (Section 11, 339 993 unknowns) with the $J_2$ model, the general residual takes 1.36 times the split form's time on a CPU with 12 threads (16.2 against 11.9 ms) and 1.60 times on an AMD RX 7600 (13.6 against 8.5 ms); per explicit step of a run the ratio is 1.36 on a CPU with 16 threads, 1.42 on the RX 7600, 1.71 on an NVIDIA L4, 2.18 on an A100, 2.27 on a V100 and 2.43 on an H100 (Table 16). The split form remains the default for that model.

The diagonal and nodal-block kernels of the preconditioners first held, per element, the fourteen stresses of the second pass and four $45 \times n_p$ coupling matrices, and evaluated the material twice per quadrature point (the stress in the second pass, the stress and the tangent in the third); on the GPUs they took 3.2 to 5.7 times the split form's diagonal. Two of the four matrices are the same matrix, $\mathbb{D} = \sum_q w_q j_q \theta'(J_q) J_q (\mathbb{G}_q \boldsymbol{F}_q^{-\mathsf{T}}) \chi_q^{\mathsf{T}}$, which depends on the geometry and $J$ only; with $\mathbb{D}M^{-1}$ formed before the material loop, the contribution of each quadrature point is added to the diagonal at that point, and the second pass accumulates $\bar{\boldsymbol{b}}$ without

Table 2: The two instances of (15). Everything above the rule is fixed by the generic development; everything below it is where the instances differ. $\boldsymbol{b}^{\mathrm{e}} := \boldsymbol{F}^{\mathrm{e}}(\boldsymbol{F}^{\mathrm{e}})^{\mathsf{T}}$ is the elastic left Cauchy–Green tensor, with $\boldsymbol{F}^{\mathrm{e}}$ the elastic part of the multiplicative decomposition $\boldsymbol{F} = \boldsymbol{F}^{\mathrm{e}}\boldsymbol{F}^{\mathrm{p}}$, and $\bar{\boldsymbol{b}}^{\mathrm{e}} := J^{-2/3}\boldsymbol{b}^{\mathrm{e}}$ its isochoric part.

| | Hencky | Simo–Hughes |
|---|---|---|
| volumetric variable $\theta$ | $\log J$ | $J-1$ |
| $\theta'(J)$ | $1/J$ | $1$ |
| $\partial\theta/\partial\boldsymbol{F}$ | $\boldsymbol{F}^{-\mathsf{T}}$ | $J\,\boldsymbol{F}^{-\mathsf{T}}$ |
| $W^{\mathrm{vol}}(\theta)$ | $\frac{\kappa}{2}(\log J)^2$ | $\frac{\kappa}{2}(J-1)^2$ |
| isochoric argument | $\boldsymbol{e} = \operatorname{dev}\boldsymbol{\epsilon}$, $\boldsymbol{\epsilon} = \frac{1}{2}\log\boldsymbol{C}$ | $\bar{\boldsymbol{b}}^{\mathrm{e}}$ |
| $W^{\mathrm{iso}}$ | $\mu\,\lVert\boldsymbol{e}\rVert^2$ | $\frac{\mu}{2}(\operatorname{tr}\bar{\boldsymbol{b}}^{\mathrm{e}} - 3)$ |
| return map | radial return in $\boldsymbol{\epsilon}$ | radial return on $\bar{\boldsymbol{b}}^{\mathrm{e}}$ |
| small-strain models usable unmodified | yes | no |
| implemented in Carina | no | yes, with consistent tangent |

storing its stresses. The material returns its stress and tangent from one call (one return map for $J_2$), and the point matrix is formed without a $9 \times 9 \times 9$ product. The general diagonal then took 38.9 instead of 53.1 ms on the RX 7600, and on NVIDIA cards 8.9 instead of 25.1 ms (H100), 20.0 instead of 43.2 ms (A100), 34.6 instead of 112.4 ms (V100, the same card for both) and 58.2 instead of 54.5 ms (L4); on a CPU it is unchanged. The register counts of the compiled kernels explain the spread: the NVIDIA compiler receives no register limit, but the kernels call the element loop and the material as separate device functions, and the compiler chose 128 registers per thread for the restructured kernel on every card, against 255 (L4) and 32 (H100) for the former one, whose local frame was 50 kB per thread on the H100. Inlining every call into the kernel (CUDA.jl's `always_inline`) gives the same kernel on the V100, A100, L4 and H100 (128 registers, a local frame of 13.7 kB instead of 22 kB) and shortens the general diagonal by a further 26 to 44%, the general action by 14 to 57%, the split action by 41 to 71% and the split diagonal by 28 to 48% (except on the L4, +4.5%); against the former kernel the general diagonal is then 3.9 (A100), 5.3 (V100), 5.0 (H100) and 1.3 (L4) times faster. Marking only the material functions inline is not safe: on the A100 the compiler then gave the general diagonal 32 registers and it became 44% slower. Since the finite-element library launches its kernels with a backend derived from its arrays, the launcher of Carina makes that backend the inlining one for CUDA arrays (`bin/cuda_always_inline.jl`), so that runs on NVIDIA cards are compiled with `always_inline`; AMDGPU.jl compiles with it by default, which is why inlining the material functions changed nothing on the RX 7600.

**Remark 1** (The volumetric variable is a modeling choice)**.** Projecting $\log J$ and projecting $J-1$ do not give the same element. Measured on one tetrahedron under a displacement quadratic in $\boldsymbol{X}$, with the element mean as the projection and a Hencky material so that both variants use the same exact $W^{\mathrm{vol}}$, the element energies differ by $9.4 \times 10^{-4}$ at 0.5% nominal strain, $1.0 \times 10^{-2}$ at 5%, $5.6 \times 10^{-2}$ at 20% and $2.7 \times 10^{-1}$ at 50% (`prototype/materials.jl`). The difference is $O(\text{strain})$ and vanishes with it, so both are consistent discretizations of the same continuum problem; they are different elements, and they differ by 5.6% to 27% at 20% to 50% strain, the finite-deformation regime of Section 1. Which variable is projected is therefore a modeling decision.

## 3.7 The two admissible instances

Table 1 leaves two materials. They agree on everything Sections 3.1 to 3.4 requires; Table 2 lists where they differ.

The Hencky instance is the one (31) defines: with

$$\boldsymbol{\epsilon} := \tfrac{1}{2}\log\boldsymbol{C} \in \mathbb{S}, \qquad \boldsymbol{C} := \boldsymbol{F}^{\mathsf{T}}\boldsymbol{F}, \tag{31}$$

evaluated by inverse scaling and squaring with Padé approximants — repeated square roots of $\boldsymbol{C}$ followed by a rational approximant of the logarithm [16] — the volumetric–deviatoric decomposition

$$\boldsymbol{\epsilon} = \tfrac{1}{3}\theta\boldsymbol{I} + \boldsymbol{e}, \qquad \theta = \operatorname{tr}\boldsymbol{\epsilon} = \log J, \qquad \boldsymbol{e} = \operatorname{dev}\boldsymbol{\epsilon}, \tag{32}$$

is orthogonal in the Frobenius inner product, and the split of (15) is inherited from the strain measure rather than imposed on it. The Simo–Hughes instance imposes it instead, through the $J^{-2/3}$ factor in $\bar{\boldsymbol{b}}^{\mathrm{e}}$; $\det \bar{\boldsymbol{b}}^{\mathrm{e}} = 1$ then makes $W^{\mathrm{iso}}$ independent of $J$ by construction. Both are exact, and Table 1 confirms both to machine precision. Three consequences follow.

**The generic development covers both.** Nothing in Sections 3.1 to 3.4, and nothing in the discretization of Sections 4.1 to 4.2, refers to either column of Table 2. The reduction (19), the pointwise relation $\bar{p} = \kappa\bar{\theta}$, and the element-local elimination hold for any $\theta$ satisfying (13) and any $W^{\mathrm{iso}}$ satisfying (15).

**The pairing at $\boldsymbol{F} = \boldsymbol{I}$ is instance-independent.** By (14), $\partial\theta/\partial\boldsymbol{F} = \boldsymbol{I}$ at $\boldsymbol{F} = \boldsymbol{I}$ in both columns; Section 4.1 draws the consequence for the stability results.

**The instances differ in plasticity only.** The last two rows of Table 2 are the entire difference, and they follow from (32), as Section 5 develops. Remark 5 states what the implemented instance, Simo–Hughes, entails.

### 3.8 Variations

With $\boldsymbol{\varphi} \in \mathcal{U}$, the space of motions of finite deformation energy that take the prescribed values on $\partial_{\boldsymbol{\varphi}}\Omega$, the part of the boundary on which the motion is prescribed; $\bar{\theta}, \bar{p} \in \mathcal{Q}$, the space of square-integrable scalar fields; test functions $\boldsymbol{\psi} \in \mathcal{U}$ vanishing on $\partial_{\boldsymbol{\varphi}}\Omega$; and $\vartheta, \pi \in \mathcal{Q}$:

$$
\begin{aligned}
D_{\boldsymbol{\varphi}}\Pi(\boldsymbol{\psi}) &= \int_\Omega \bar{p}\,\frac{\partial\theta}{\partial\boldsymbol{\varphi}}[\boldsymbol{\psi}]\,\mathrm{d}V + \int_\Omega \boldsymbol{s}(\boldsymbol{e}(\boldsymbol{\varphi})) : \frac{\partial\boldsymbol{e}}{\partial\boldsymbol{\varphi}}[\boldsymbol{\psi}]\,\mathrm{d}V - \int_\Omega \rho_0\,\boldsymbol{b}\cdot\boldsymbol{\psi}\,\mathrm{d}V - \int_{\partial_T\Omega} \boldsymbol{T}\cdot\boldsymbol{\psi}\,\mathrm{d}S = 0,\\
D_{\bar{\theta}}\Pi(\vartheta) &= \int_\Omega \left(\kappa\bar{\theta} - \bar{p}\right)\vartheta\,\mathrm{d}V = 0,\\
D_{\bar{p}}\Pi(\pi) &= \int_\Omega \left(\theta(\boldsymbol{\varphi}) - \bar{\theta}\right)\pi\,\mathrm{d}V = 0.
\end{aligned}
\tag{33}
$$

Here $\boldsymbol{s}$ is the deviatoric stress conjugate to $\boldsymbol{e}$, given by the material law (Section 5). The kinematic derivatives are

$$
\frac{\partial\theta}{\partial\boldsymbol{\varphi}}[\boldsymbol{\psi}] = \theta'(J)\,J\,\boldsymbol{F}^{-\mathsf{T}} : \operatorname{Grad}\boldsymbol{\psi}, \qquad \frac{\partial\boldsymbol{e}}{\partial\boldsymbol{\varphi}}[\boldsymbol{\psi}] = \mathbb{L}^{\mathrm{dev}}(\boldsymbol{C}) : \operatorname{sym}\left(\boldsymbol{F}^{\mathsf{T}}\operatorname{Grad}\boldsymbol{\psi}\right), \tag{34}
$$

with $\mathbb{L}(\boldsymbol{C}) := \partial\log\boldsymbol{C}/\partial\boldsymbol{C}$ the Fréchet derivative of the matrix logarithm [16] and $\mathbb{L}^{\mathrm{dev}} := \mathbb{L} - \frac{1}{3}\boldsymbol{I}\otimes\boldsymbol{C}^{-1}$. The volumetric derivative follows from Jacobi's formula and (14). The deviatoric expression is written for the Hencky instance of Table 2; the Simo–Hughes instance replaces it with the variation of $\bar{\boldsymbol{b}}^{\mathrm{e}}$, and nothing outside this equation changes.

### 3.9 Stress reconstruction

Collecting $(33)_1$ into the form $\int \boldsymbol{P} : \operatorname{Grad}\boldsymbol{\psi}\,\mathrm{d}V$, with $\boldsymbol{P}$ the first Piola–Kirchhoff stress, the stress conjugate to $\boldsymbol{F}$, gives in general

$$
\boldsymbol{P} = \theta'(J)\,J\,\bar{p}\,\boldsymbol{F}^{-\mathsf{T}} + \boldsymbol{F}\left(\mathbb{L}(\boldsymbol{C}) : \boldsymbol{s}\right). \tag{35}
$$

The deviatoric term is $\mathbb{L}$ and not $\mathbb{L}^{\mathrm{dev}}$ applied to $\boldsymbol{s}$. Moving $\mathbb{L}^{\mathrm{dev}}$ off the strain variation in (34) and onto $\boldsymbol{s}$ takes its transpose, which carries the $\frac{1}{3}$ term onto $\operatorname{tr}\boldsymbol{s} = 0$, and $\mathbb{L}$ is self-adjoint because $\log\boldsymbol{C}$ is the gradient of $\operatorname{tr}(\boldsymbol{C}\log\boldsymbol{C} - \boldsymbol{C})$.

When the deviatoric response is elastic, $\boldsymbol{s} = 2\mu\,\boldsymbol{e}$ is a function of the current $\boldsymbol{C}$ alone through an isotropic law, so $\boldsymbol{s}$ is coaxial with $\boldsymbol{C}$ at every quadrature point; the off-diagonal blocks of $\mathbb{L}$ in the principal basis then act on nothing and (35) collapses to

$$
\boldsymbol{P} = (\varpi\boldsymbol{I} + \boldsymbol{s}_x)\,\boldsymbol{F}^{-\mathsf{T}} = \boldsymbol{\tau}\,\boldsymbol{F}^{-\mathsf{T}}, \qquad \boldsymbol{\tau} := \varpi\boldsymbol{I} + \boldsymbol{s}_x = J\,\boldsymbol{\sigma}, \qquad \varpi := \theta'(J)\,J\,\bar{p}, \tag{36}
$$

in which $\boldsymbol{\tau} = J\,\boldsymbol{\sigma}$ is the Kirchhoff stress, $\boldsymbol{\sigma}$ the Cauchy stress, and $\boldsymbol{s}_x := \boldsymbol{R}\,\boldsymbol{s}\,\boldsymbol{R}^{\mathsf{T}}$ the spatial deviator, with $\boldsymbol{R}$ the rotation of the polar decomposition $\boldsymbol{F} = \boldsymbol{R}\boldsymbol{U}$. The material $\boldsymbol{s}$ of (32) and the spatial $\boldsymbol{s}_x$ are different

tensors; in material form the same statement reads $\boldsymbol{P} = \boldsymbol{F}^{-\mathsf{T}}\boldsymbol{s}$, which agrees with (36) because $\boldsymbol{s}$ and $\boldsymbol{U}$ commute when coaxial.

The Kirchhoff pressure $\varpi$ carries the whole of the instance dependence. For the Hencky instance $\theta'(J)J = 1$ and $\varpi = \bar{p}$; for the Simo–Hughes instance $\theta'(J)J = J$ and $\varpi = J\bar{p}$, giving $\boldsymbol{\tau} = J\bar{p}\,\boldsymbol{I} + \boldsymbol{s}$ with $\bar{p} = \kappa(J-1)$, which is the Kirchhoff stress of Simo and Hughes [24, BOX 9.1] and is what both codes compute. Agreement of (35) with both implementations confirms the normalization (13).

**Remark 2** (Coaxiality is an elastic property)**.** Equation (36) rests on $\boldsymbol{s}$ being coaxial with $\boldsymbol{C}$, which holds only when $\boldsymbol{s}$ is a function of the current $\boldsymbol{C}$ alone. It fails in two settings, and the second is the one this formulation exists for. With an independent discrete stress field, $\boldsymbol{s}$ is tied to $\boldsymbol{C}$ only weakly and is not coaxial with it at an arbitrary iterate. With plasticity, the return map (46) evaluates $\boldsymbol{s} = 2\mu(\boldsymbol{e} - \boldsymbol{e}^{\mathrm{p}}_{n+1})$ against a stored plastic strain $\boldsymbol{e}^{\mathrm{p}}_{n}$, which is coaxial with the current $\boldsymbol{C}$ only under proportional loading; whenever the principal axes rotate — the large-rotation regime of Section 1 — $\boldsymbol{s}$ is not coaxial with $\boldsymbol{C}$, the off-diagonal blocks of $\mathbb{L}$ do not vanish, and (36) is wrong. In both settings (36) holds at best at a converged proportional state, and assembling the residual from it gives a residual that is not the derivative of the energy, with an error that is undetected under proportional loading. The residual is assembled from (35); Miehe et al. [15] carry the full projection tensor for this reason.

**Remark 3.** No deviatoric mixed pair appears because none is needed. Volumetric locking is a constraint phenomenon: at $\kappa/\mu \gg 1$ the near-isochoric constraint over-determines the displacement space, and relieving it requires a multiplier. The deviatoric response is not constrained in the same sense and admits no analogous locking mode. Adding a deviatoric pair adds degrees of freedom, an inf-sup condition that has to be established separately, and — if strain and stress are placed in different spaces — a constitutive law evaluated across two discretizations, which is the error that corrupts plastic strain fields when the strain is interpolated in one space and the stress evaluated in another. Section 8 gives the construction that adds strain as an independent field should a later requirement demand it.

# 4 Discretization

This section selects the pair of discrete spaces, defines the element that carries the displacement, gives the element-local elimination of the auxiliary fields, and states the element algorithm in the form an implementation needs. $P_k$ denotes continuous piecewise polynomials of degree $k$ on the mesh, $P^{\mathrm{disc}}_k$ the discontinuous ones, and a bubble a polynomial on one element that vanishes on a prescribed part of its boundary; $U_h/Q_h$ denotes the pair with displacement space $U_h$ and pressure space $Q_h$.

## 4.1 The pair

Let $U_h \subset \mathcal{U}$ carry the motion and $Q_h \subset \mathcal{Q}$ carry both $\bar{\theta}$ and $\bar{p}$. Two requirements fix the choice.

**Same space for both scalars.** $\bar{\theta}$ and $\bar{p}$ are placed in one space $Q_h$. This is what makes the constraint term vanish identically and the functional reduce to (19); it is the only thing that reduction needs. Given it, and a quadratic $W^{\mathrm{vol}}$ (Section 3.5), $(33)_2$ reads $\bar{p} = \kappa\bar{\theta}$ pointwise rather than in a projected sense, and the composition $\bar{p} = \kappa\,\mathcal{P}_h(\theta)$ is well defined. Splitting the two scalars across different spaces makes the constitutive relation hold only after a projection, determines one field only through its projection onto the other's space, and can leave the discrete system singular.

**Inf-sup stability, in three dimensions.** By (34) the pressure–displacement pairing is $\int \varpi\,\boldsymbol{F}^{-\mathsf{T}} : \mathrm{Grad}\,\boldsymbol{\psi}$ with $\varpi = \theta'(J)\,J\,\bar{p}$, and not $\int \bar{p}\,\boldsymbol{F}^{-\mathsf{T}} : \mathrm{Grad}\,\boldsymbol{\psi}$; the two coincide at $\boldsymbol{F} = \boldsymbol{I}$ and nowhere else. The normalization (13) sets $\theta'(1) = 1$, so $\varpi = \bar{p}$ there and the pairing reduces to the divergence pairing $\int \bar{p}\,\mathrm{Div}\,\boldsymbol{\psi}\,\mathrm{d}V$ — in both instances of Table 2, which is what makes the stability results of Section 9.5 a property of the pair rather than of the material. That pairing is the one of incompressible linear elasticity, in which the pressure is the multiplier of the constraint $\mathrm{Div}\,\boldsymbol{\varphi} = 0$, and its discrete inf-sup condition,

$$\inf_{q \in Q_h} \sup_{\boldsymbol{v} \in U_h} \frac{\int_\Omega q\ \mathrm{Div}\,\boldsymbol{v}\,\mathrm{d}V}{|\boldsymbol{v}|_{H^1}\,\|q\|_{L^2}} \ \geq\ \beta_h, \tag{37}$$

is the condition on the pair. The admissible pairs are therefore those for which $\beta_h$ in (37) is bounded below uniformly in $h$, and stability must also hold on the target range of $\kappa/\mu$ [5].

The pair has been used before in large-deformation hyperelasticity: Chamberland et al. [7], comparing discretizations of a nearly incompressible Mooney–Rivlin material against manufactured solutions on tetrahedral and hexahedral meshes, recommend it and its hexahedral counterpart for nearly incompressible large-deformation problems for accuracy, run time and memory, and observe on some manufactured solutions a larger pressure error than that of Taylor–Hood, which they attribute to a smaller inf-sup constant of the richer pressure space (the constants measured in Section 9.5 are 0.2968 for this pair and 0.2216 for Taylor–Hood on the Freudenthal meshes). Their formulation is the two-field displacement–pressure form, whose pressure equation $\int_{\Omega_0}(J-1)\,q\,\mathrm{d}V - \int_{\Omega_0}\kappa^{-1}p\,q\,\mathrm{d}V = 0$ for all $q$ in the discontinuous space $Q_h$ gives $p = \kappa\,\mathcal{P}_h(J-1)$ element by element; in elasticity their element is therefore the element of this note with $\theta = J-1$ and a volumetric energy quadratic in $\theta$. They also report that on meshes of curved elements a pressure linear in the coordinates of the physical element is more accurate than one linear in the coordinates of the parent element. The element of this note takes the pressure linear in the parent coordinates $\boldsymbol{\xi}$ (Section 4.4); on an element with straight edges these are affine functions of the reference coordinates $\boldsymbol{X}$ and the two choices coincide, and they differ only on elements with curved edges, such as those on the lateral surface of the Taylor bar (Section 11). The effect of that choice on the element of this note is not measured. No use of the pair in finite-deformation plasticity is known to the author.

Stability of a pair depends on the spatial dimension. The conforming Crouzeix–Raviart pair [10] is, in two dimensions, $P_2$ enriched with a cubic interior bubble over $P_1^{\mathrm{disc}}$; its three-dimensional counterpart below carries a quartic interior bubble and cubic face bubbles, and the quadrature degree the element needs follows from the quartic. Unenriched $P_2/P_1^{\mathrm{disc}}$ is stable in two dimensions only on special meshes. In three dimensions Boffi et al. [5, §8.7] state that a constant discontinuous pressure is not controlled by $P_2$: "to control piecewise constant pressure, we need some degrees of freedom on the faces," and the quadratic space has none. The stable three-dimensional choices with a discontinuous pressure therefore require bubble enrichment of the displacement space, and the enrichment has two parts with two functions: face bubbles control the constant pressure, and an interior bubble lifts it to a linear one [5, Example 8.7.2]. Table 3 lists the candidates, and Section 9.5 measures every one of them.

| Displacement | Pressure | 3D stable | Pressure elimination |
|---|---|---|---|
| $P_1$ | $P_0$ | no | local |
| $P_2$ | $P_0$ | **no** | local |
| $P_2 \oplus b_{\mathrm{face}}$ | $P_0$ | yes | local |
| $P_2$ | $P_1^{\mathrm{disc}}$ | **no** | local |
| $P_2 \oplus b_{\mathrm{int}}$ | $P_1^{\mathrm{disc}}$ | no | local |
| $P_2 \oplus b_{\mathrm{int}} \oplus b_{\mathrm{face}}$ | $P_1^{\mathrm{disc}}$ | yes | local |
| $P_2$ | $P_1$ continuous | yes | global |

Table 3: Displacement–pressure pairs on tetrahedra, with three-dimensional stability as Boffi et al. [5, §8.7, Example 8.7.2] give it. Local elimination requires a discontinuous pressure; three-dimensional stability with a discontinuous pressure requires face bubbles, and a linear pressure requires an interior bubble as well.

The pair this formulation requires is $P_2$ enriched with face and interior bubbles over $P_1^{\mathrm{disc}}$. The two enrichments are different kinds of object. The interior bubble vanishes on the whole element boundary: it is never shared, never reached by a boundary condition, and condenses away, adding no global unknown. A face bubble vanishes on three faces and not on its own, so the two elements meeting there share it; it is a global unknown and does not condense. The enrichment therefore adds global degrees of freedom, which Section 9.3 counts. The pressure elimination of Section 4.2 nevertheless stays element by element, because it rests on $Q_h$ being discontinuous and not on the displacement space.

The linear pressure is not forced by the stability results. $P_2 \oplus b_{\mathrm{face}}/P_0$ is also stable (Section 9.5), at a higher constant and with the same number of global unknowns, since the interior bubble condenses. The count of Section 9.2 applies to the unenriched displacement space, and Section 9.4 shows that its modes do not persist after assembly. What separates the two pressure spaces is the claim of Section 6: a constant pressure leaves in $\ker \boldsymbol{G}_h$ the element-scale dilatational modes that a plastic tangent can free, and a linear one does not. Section 9.7 measures both pairs, and that measurement is the reason for the linear pressure.

Both that pair and the Taylor–Hood pair — continuous $P_2$ over continuous $P_1$, whose stability in three dimensions is established [5] and which serves as the positive control of the measurements — are measured in Section 9.5, and every other element-local pair decays. The difference between the two stable pairs is not stability but where the coupling is — a global pressure that cannot be eliminated element by element against global face bubbles that cannot be condensed — and Section 14 quantifies it.

## 4.2 Local elimination

Because $Q_h$ is discontinuous, the mass matrix $[M]_{mn} = \int_\Omega \chi_m \chi_n \,\mathrm{d}V$, with $\{\chi_m\}$ a basis of $Q_h$, is block diagonal by element and constant in the reference configuration. One factorization at setup serves every Newton iteration of every step, and

$$M\{\bar{\theta}\} = \int_\Omega \chi_m \,\theta(\boldsymbol{\varphi}) \,\mathrm{d}V, \qquad \bar{p} = \kappa\bar{\theta}, \tag{38}$$

is an element-local solve, with $\theta = \log J$ for a Hencky material and $\theta = J - 1$ for the Simo–Hughes one (Table 2). The second relation in (38) holds pointwise, rather than only after projection, precisely because $W^{\mathrm{vol}}$ is quadratic; for a material where it is not, it is replaced by a second projection with the same factorization (Section 3.6). Substituting $\bar{p}(\boldsymbol{\varphi})$ into $(33)_1$ leaves a displacement-sized nonlinear problem whose tangent retains the sparsity of the displacement mesh — the auxiliary fields never couple two elements. This is the property that keeps CT10's tangent as sparse as a displacement element's, and it is preserved here.

**Remark 4.** The locality is a consequence of the discontinuous pressure, not of the Hu–Washizu structure. A conforming auxiliary field — one requiring inter-element continuity — would make $\bar{p}(\boldsymbol{\varphi})$ a global function of $\boldsymbol{\varphi}$, and every tangent–vector product would then require a global solve with its mass matrix, which CT10 does not require. That is the main reason the pressure is kept discontinuous.

## 4.3 The element

The displacement space of the pair is carried by a fifteen-node tetrahedron, `TETRA15` in the naming of the Exodus mesh format, with three displacement unknowns at each node. This section defines it in full.

**Nodes.** With $\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_4$ the barycentric coordinates of the tetrahedron, the fifteen nodes are the four vertices (nodes 1–4); the six edge midpoints (nodes 5–10), on the edges 1–2, 2–3, 3–1, 1–4, 2–4, 3–4 in that order; the four face centroids (nodes 11–14), on the faces with vertices 1–3–2, 2–3–4, 1–4–3 and 1–2–4 in that order, which is the side-node convention of the Exodus library (node 14 on side 1, node 12 on side 2, node 13 on side 3, node 11 on side 4); and the centroid (node 15). The first ten are the nodes of the quadratic tetrahedron TET10 in the same order, so a `TETRA10` mesh is converted by adding one node at the centroid of every face and of every element; for a mesh with straight edges the added nodes are the averages of the face and element vertices. Each face is a seven-node triangle: three vertices, three edge midpoints and the centroid.

**The space.** The displacement space on one element is

$$\big[P_2 \oplus \operatorname{span}\{b_{F_1}, \ldots, b_{F_4}\} \oplus \operatorname{span}\{b_T\}\big]^3, \qquad b_F = 27\,\lambda_a\lambda_b\lambda_c, \qquad b_T = 256\,\lambda_1\lambda_2\lambda_3\lambda_4, \tag{39}$$

with $P_2$ the ten quadratic Lagrange functions of the tetrahedron, $b_F$ the cubic bubble of face $F$ with vertices $a$, $b$, $c$, which vanishes on the three other faces and equals one at the centroid of $F$, and $b_T$ the quartic interior bubble, which vanishes on the whole boundary and equals one at the centroid. The space has dimension fifteen per component and contains the complete quadratic polynomials, so the element is conforming and its interpolation error is that of the quadratic tetrahedron.

**The nodal basis.** The functions of (39) in the order listed — the ten Lagrange functions of TET10, then $b_{F_1}, \ldots, b_{F_4}$ in the face order of the nodes, then $b_T$ — form the hierarchical basis $\{\hat{N}_j\}$, so called because the functions of the lower-degree element remain in it and the bubbles are appended. It is not nodal: the Lagrange

functions are nonzero at the face centroids and at the centroid. The nodal basis $\{N_a\}$, with $N_a(\boldsymbol{x}_b) = \delta_{ab}$ at the fifteen nodes, is obtained from it by the constant matrix

$$N_a = \sum_j A_{aj} \hat{N}_j, \qquad \boldsymbol{A} = (\boldsymbol{V}^{-1})^{\mathsf{T}}, \qquad V_{bj} = \hat{N}_j(\boldsymbol{x}_b), \tag{40}$$

with $\boldsymbol{V}$ the values of the hierarchical functions at the nodes, a $15 \times 15$ matrix with rational entries that is inverted exactly once. The gradients transform by the same matrix. Every unknown is then the displacement of a node, so a code that numbers unknowns by node treats the element like any Lagrange element: the four face-centroid unknowns are shared between the two elements of a face and the centroid unknown belongs to one element. Section 9.8 measures the two bases; the nodal one is used.

**Quadrature.** The element is integrated with the fourteen-point rule of Walkington [29], exact for polynomials of degree five, with positive weights. Its points are three orbits of the symmetry group of the tetrahedron: two orbits of four points with barycentric coordinates $(1-3a, a, a, a)$ and its permutations, and one orbit of six points with coordinates $(b, b, \frac{1}{2}-b, \frac{1}{2}-b)$ and its permutations,

$$\begin{aligned} a_1 &= 0.0927352503108912, & w_1 &= 0.01224884051939366, \\ a_2 &= 0.3108859192633006, & w_2 &= 0.01878132095300264, \\ b &= 0.4544962958743503, & w_3 &= 0.007091003462846911, \end{aligned} \tag{41}$$

with the weights normalized to the reference volume $1/6$. The gradient of $b_T$ is cubic and the stiffness integrand of its block is of degree six, which the rule integrates with an error of 35% on that block (Section 9.8); the rules of degree two and three (four and five points) leave the element twenty-one zero-energy modes beyond the six rigid-body modes and cannot be used. The same rule integrates the mass matrix, the projection (38) and the residual.

**Mass.** The consistent mass matrix in the nodal basis has condition number 94 on the reference element. Its row sums, $m_a = \rho \int_e N_a \, \mathrm{d}V$, are positive at every node because the nodal basis is a partition of unity with positive integrals: as fractions of the element mass they are 0.020 at each vertex, 0.038 at each edge midpoint, 0.096 at each face centroid and 0.305 at the centroid. The row-sum lumped mass is therefore admissible for explicit time integration (Section 7), which it is not for TET10, whose vertex row sums are negative.

## 4.4 Element algorithm

This section states what an implementation computes on one element, with the nodal displacements $\boldsymbol{u}_a$ of its fifteen nodes given. The pressure space $Q_h$ on the element is spanned by $\chi_m(\boldsymbol{\xi})$, $m = 1, \dots, 4$, with $\chi = (1, \xi_1, \xi_2, \xi_3)$ in the reference coordinates $\boldsymbol{\xi}$ of the element; the constant projection, the element TET15-P0, which Section 10 also measures, has $\chi = (1)$. The mass matrix of the projection is taken with the reference-configuration volume element, so it does not change with the deformation. Two passes over the quadrature points $\boldsymbol{\xi}_q$, with weights $w_q$ and reference Jacobian determinants $j_q$, compute the residual.

**First pass: the projected volumetric strain.** At each quadrature point, $\boldsymbol{F}_q = \boldsymbol{I} + \sum_a \boldsymbol{u}_a \otimes \operatorname{Grad} N_a(\boldsymbol{\xi}_q)$, $J_q = \det \boldsymbol{F}_q$ and $\theta_q = \theta(J_q)$. Then

$$M_{mn} = \sum_q w_q j_q \, \chi_m(\boldsymbol{\xi}_q) \, \chi_n(\boldsymbol{\xi}_q), \qquad b_m = \sum_q w_q j_q \, \chi_m(\boldsymbol{\xi}_q) \, \theta_q, \qquad \bar{\theta} = \boldsymbol{M}^{-1} \boldsymbol{b}, \tag{42}$$

a $4 \times 4$ solve, and the projected strain and pressure at each point are $\bar{\theta}_q = \sum_m \chi_m(\boldsymbol{\xi}_q) \, \bar{\theta}_m$ and $\bar{p}_q = \kappa \bar{\theta}_q$.

**Second pass: the stress and the residual.** At each quadrature point the material supplies the isochoric first Piola–Kirchhoff stress $\boldsymbol{P}_q^{\mathrm{iso}}$ from $\boldsymbol{F}_q$ and its internal variables, with its own return map, and the element adds the volumetric part with the projected pressure:

$$\boldsymbol{P}_q = \boldsymbol{P}_q^{\mathrm{iso}} + \bar{p}_q \, \boldsymbol{g}_q, \qquad \boldsymbol{g}_q := \left. \frac{\partial \theta}{\partial \boldsymbol{F}} \right|_q = \theta'(J_q) \, J_q \, \boldsymbol{F}_q^{-\mathsf{T}}, \qquad \boldsymbol{R}_a = \sum_q w_q j_q \, \boldsymbol{P}_q \operatorname{Grad} N_a(\boldsymbol{\xi}_q). \tag{43}$$

The residual is the pointwise one with the projected pressure in place of $\kappa\theta_q$; it is the derivative of the element energy $\sum_q w_q j_q \left[W^{\mathrm{iso}}(\bar{\boldsymbol{F}}_q) + \frac{\kappa}{2}\bar{\theta}_q^2\right]$ with respect to the nodal displacements, which Section 4.5 verifies by differences.

**The tangent.** The derivative of (43) along a nodal displacement increment $\boldsymbol{v}$ with gradient $\operatorname{Grad}\boldsymbol{v}_q$ at the quadrature points has three parts: the isochoric material tangent of the model, the geometric term of the volumetric stress, and the coupling through the projection,

$$\begin{aligned} \delta\boldsymbol{P}_q &= \left.\frac{\partial \boldsymbol{P}^{\mathrm{iso}}}{\partial \boldsymbol{F}}\right|_q : \operatorname{Grad}\boldsymbol{v}_q + \bar{p}_q \left.\frac{\partial \boldsymbol{g}}{\partial \boldsymbol{F}}\right|_q : \operatorname{Grad}\boldsymbol{v}_q + \kappa\,\delta\bar{\theta}_q\,\boldsymbol{g}_q, \\ \delta\bar{\theta} &= \boldsymbol{M}^{-1}\sum_q w_q j_q\,\chi(\boldsymbol{\xi}_q)\,(\boldsymbol{g}_q : \operatorname{Grad}\boldsymbol{v}_q), \qquad \delta\bar{\theta}_q = \sum_m \chi_m(\boldsymbol{\xi}_q)\,\delta\bar{\theta}_m, \end{aligned} \tag{44}$$

with, for $\phi(J) := \theta'(J)J$ and $\phi'$ its derivative,

$$\frac{\partial \boldsymbol{g}}{\partial \boldsymbol{F}} : \delta\boldsymbol{F} = \phi'(J)\,J\,(\boldsymbol{F}^{-\mathsf{T}} : \delta\boldsymbol{F})\,\boldsymbol{F}^{-\mathsf{T}} - \phi(J)\,\boldsymbol{F}^{-\mathsf{T}}\delta\boldsymbol{F}^{\mathsf{T}}\boldsymbol{F}^{-\mathsf{T}}. \tag{45}$$

The third term couples the quadrature points of the element: in matrix form it adds $\kappa\,\boldsymbol{D}\boldsymbol{M}^{-1}\boldsymbol{D}^{\mathsf{T}}$ to the sum of the quadrature-point matrices, with $\boldsymbol{D} = \sum_q w_q j_q\,(\operatorname{Grad}N\cdot\boldsymbol{g}_q)\,\chi(\boldsymbol{\xi}_q)^{\mathsf{T}}$ the matrix that maps nodal displacements to the right-hand side of (42). The tangent is symmetric, since it is the second derivative of the element energy. The matrix-free tangent–vector product is (44) applied to $\boldsymbol{v}$ with the two passes; the assembled tangent, its diagonal and its nodal blocks are formed from the same three terms.

**What the material supplies.** A material admissible for the element provides, at a quadrature point with its internal variables: the volumetric strain measure $\theta(J)$ with $\theta'(J)$ and $\theta''(J)$; the bulk modulus $\kappa$; the isochoric energy $W^{\mathrm{iso}}(\bar{\boldsymbol{F}})$; the isochoric first Piola–Kirchhoff stress, together with the update of the internal variables it entails; and the isochoric tangent $\partial\boldsymbol{P}^{\mathrm{iso}}/\partial\boldsymbol{F}$. For the Simo–Hughes $J_2$ model, $\theta = \log J$, $\theta' = 1/J$, $\theta'' = -1/J^2$, $\kappa = \lambda + 2\mu/3$ from the Lamé constants, and the isochoric stress and tangent are those of BOX 9.1 of Simo and Hughes [24] with the volumetric term omitted; the return map on $\bar{\boldsymbol{b}}^{\mathrm{e}}$ and the internal variables $\boldsymbol{F}^{\mathrm{p}}$ and $\bar{\epsilon}^{\mathrm{p}}$ are unchanged. For a material without an accessible split, the passes and the stress are those of Section 3.6, with the material called at the modified deformation gradient (25).

**Assembly.** Because the first pass needs every quadrature point of the element before the second can begin, the element is assembled as a unit, not quadrature point by quadrature point. Internal variables are stored per quadrature point as for any element. Tractions on a face are integrated over the seven-node triangle with the triangle rule of the same degree as the element rule. The element runs under the quasi-static, the implicit and the explicit integrators of the code without change.

## 4.5 Consistency checks

An implementation of Section 4.4 is verified by the following checks, which the implementation in Carina passes (`test/projected-element.jl`, forty-six checks) on a cube of TET15 elements with the $J_2$ model in its elastic range at a converged nonlinear state, so that the geometric and coupling terms of the tangent are nonzero, for both the linear and the constant projection: the residual equals the derivative of the assembled energy by central differences, and the assembled tangent the derivative of the residual, to the truncation error of the differences; the matrix-free action, the diagonal and the nodal-block kernels reproduce the assembled tangent to $10^{-12}$; an affine displacement field is reproduced exactly (patch test, $10^{-10}$), because a constant $J$ is its own projection and the projected element must then agree with the pointwise one; and Newton converges quadratically (relative residual 1, $8.6\times10^{-3}$, $8\times10^{-7}$, $2\times10^{-14}$).

The general form of Section 3.6 passes the same checks (`test/projected-general.jl`, 84 checks) with the neo-Hookean material, which has no accessible split in the material library, with $\theta = \log J$ and both projections, on the CPU and on a GPU, where the Newton history and the displacements agree with the CPU's within $10^{-8}$. Its reduction to the split form is checked on the same cube with the $J_2$ model forced through the general form: the Newton history, the displacements, the internal variables, the energy, the

residual and the assembled tangent agree with the split form's to between $10^{-15}$ and $10^{-13}$ relative, in the elastic range and in a plastic step with an equivalent plastic strain of 0.021. The formulas themselves were checked on one distorted element before the kernels were written (`prototype/general.jl`): the hand-derived residual against the gradient of the energy by automatic differentiation to $4 \times 10^{-16}$, the closed-form tangent against its Hessian to $1.2 \times 10^{-14}$, and the three reductions of Section 3.6 to rounding. The same Julia prototype found that the tangent of the $J_2$ model in the material library, the consistent tangent of BOX 9.2 of Simo and Hughes [24], divided its coefficient $\beta_2$ by $\mu$ instead of the effective modulus $\bar{\mu} = \mu\,\mathrm{tr}(\bar{\boldsymbol{b}}^{e}_{\mathrm{tr}})/3$; the two agree at small strain and the term vanishes without hardening, which is why the library's own checks had not seen it, and the symmetric part of the tangent was off by $5 \times 10^{-2}$ at an equivalent plastic strain of 0.6 reached in one increment. With the correction the symmetric part agrees with the central-difference Jacobian of the stress to $10^{-10}$; what remains, $4 \times 10^{-3}$ to $5 \times 10^{-3}$, is the antisymmetric part that BOX 9.2 drops by construction, so Newton converges linearly, not quadratically, on steps that yield with this model.

# 5 Plasticity

This section develops the logarithmic instance of Table 2; the Simo–Hughes column differs here and nowhere else (Section 3.7), and Remark 5 states what the implemented instance, Simo–Hughes, entails.

The deviatoric response is evaluated at quadrature points of the displacement element, on $\boldsymbol{e}(\boldsymbol{\varphi})$ computed there. The plastic strain is carried as a logarithmic strain $\boldsymbol{e}^{\mathrm{p}}$ and subtracted additively — the construction of Miehe et al. [15], in which a material geometric pre-processing $\boldsymbol{C} \mapsto \boldsymbol{\epsilon}$ and a post-processing through $\mathbb{L}(\boldsymbol{C})$ precede and follow an unmodified small-strain algorithm. This is a different constitutive model from the multiplicative $\boldsymbol{F} = \boldsymbol{F}^{\mathrm{e}}\boldsymbol{F}^{\mathrm{p}}$ plasticity of Simo [23], which also preserves the small-strain return map but applies it to the elastic logarithmic strain of a trial elastic state with an exponential update; the two coincide under proportional loading with fixed principal axes and differ when the axes rotate. Because the constitutive law is linear in logarithmic strain, the $J_2$ return map is the small-strain radial return — the return map that scales the trial deviatoric stress toward the yield surface along its own direction — unchanged:

$$
\begin{aligned}
&\boldsymbol{e}^{\mathrm{tr}} := \boldsymbol{e}(\boldsymbol{\varphi}) - \boldsymbol{e}^{\mathrm{p}}_{n}, \qquad \boldsymbol{s}^{\mathrm{tr}} := 2\mu\,\boldsymbol{e}^{\mathrm{tr}},\\
&\Delta\gamma: \quad \left\|\boldsymbol{s}^{\mathrm{tr}}\right\| - 2\mu\,\Delta\gamma - \sqrt{2/3}\left[\sigma_y + \mathcal{H}'\left(\bar{\epsilon}^{\mathrm{p}}_{n} + \sqrt{2/3}\,\Delta\gamma\right)\right] = 0 \quad \text{if } f^{\mathrm{tr}} > 0, \quad \text{else } \Delta\gamma := 0,\\
&\boldsymbol{e}^{\mathrm{p}}_{n+1} := \boldsymbol{e}^{\mathrm{p}}_{n} + \Delta\gamma\,\boldsymbol{n}, \qquad \boldsymbol{n} := \boldsymbol{s}^{\mathrm{tr}}/\left\|\boldsymbol{s}^{\mathrm{tr}}\right\|, \qquad \bar{\epsilon}^{\mathrm{p}}_{n+1} := \bar{\epsilon}^{\mathrm{p}}_{n} + \sqrt{2/3}\,\Delta\gamma,\\
&\boldsymbol{s} := 2\mu\left(\boldsymbol{e}(\boldsymbol{\varphi}) - \boldsymbol{e}^{\mathrm{p}}_{n+1}\right).
\end{aligned}
\tag{46}
$$

Here $\sigma_y$ is the initial yield stress, $\bar{\epsilon}^{\mathrm{p}}$ the equivalent plastic strain, $\mathcal{H}'$ the hardening function (the increase of the yield stress with $\bar{\epsilon}^{\mathrm{p}}$) and $\mathcal{H}''$ its derivative, the hardening modulus, and $f^{\mathrm{tr}} := \|\boldsymbol{s}^{\mathrm{tr}}\| - \sqrt{2/3}\,[\sigma_y + \mathcal{H}'(\bar{\epsilon}^{\mathrm{p}}_{n})]$ the trial yield function. The consistency condition is a scalar equation in $\Delta\gamma$. For linear hardening it closes in one step, $\Delta\gamma = f^{\mathrm{tr}}/(2\mu + \frac{2}{3}\mathcal{H}'')$, which is the form both codes implement; for nonlinear hardening it is a scalar Newton iteration [24, BOX 3.2]. Internal variables are stored at quadrature points and are never projected, so no interpolation error enters the history. Frame-indifferent interpolation, when tensorial internal variables must be transferred, follows Mota et al. [17].

Three properties follow. They are the motivation for the formulation rather than incidental consequences of it.

**The constitutive law is untouched.** All finite-deformation content is absorbed into two material-independent geometric transforms: the forward map $\boldsymbol{C} \mapsto \boldsymbol{\epsilon}$ and the tangent map $\mathbb{L}(\boldsymbol{C})$ [15]. Between them is an unmodified small-strain algorithm. Any model already written for small strain — $J_2$, kinematic hardening, viscoplasticity, damage — is usable without reformulation. This is the practical content of preferring a Hu–Washizu structure over one built around a particular stress–strain pairing. This property belongs to the logarithmic measure and not to the Hu–Washizu structure, so it is the one place where Section 3.5 does not apply: an admissible material in the sense of (20) need not have it, and the Simo–Hughes model both codes implement does not (Remark 5).

**Strain and stress never cross discretizations.** $\boldsymbol{e}$ is evaluated and $\boldsymbol{s}$ returned at the same quadrature point of the same element. There is no projection between the two, so the interpolation error between two

discrete spaces that corrupts the equivalent plastic strain in stabilized formulations has no mechanism here.

**No stabilization enters the deviator.** There is no subgrid term, no penalty and no tuned coefficient anywhere in the formulation, so nothing of the form (1) can reach the return map.

**Remark 5** (The instance implemented)**.** The instance implemented in Carina, and the one every nonlinear result of Section 10 uses, is the Simo–Hughes $J_2$ model [24, BOX 9.1]: the multiplicative decomposition $\boldsymbol{F} = \boldsymbol{F}^{\mathrm{e}}\boldsymbol{F}^{\mathrm{p}}$ with the volumetric–isochoric split $W = \frac{\kappa}{2}(\log J)^2 + \frac{\mu}{2}(\operatorname{tr}\bar{\boldsymbol{b}}^{\mathrm{e}} - 3)$, and the radial return taken on the isochoric elastic left Cauchy–Green tensor $\bar{\boldsymbol{b}}^{\mathrm{e}}$ rather than on the logarithmic strain. It satisfies (20) exactly — $\det\bar{\boldsymbol{b}}^{\mathrm{e}} = 1$ makes the isochoric term independent of $J$ by construction — and its $W^{\mathrm{vol}}$ is quadratic in $\log J$, so the element of Section 4 uses it in the variable $\theta = \log J$ with no change other than the omission of the volumetric term from the stress the model returns. The original model of Simo and Hughes has $W^{\mathrm{vol}} = \frac{\kappa}{2}\left[\frac{1}{2}(J^2-1) - \log J\right]$ [24, eq. (9.2.3)], and the instance implemented until 2026-10-16 used $\frac{\kappa}{2}(J-1)^2$; the three volumetric laws agree to second order in $J-1$, and the logarithmic one is used so that the element projects the volumetric part of the logarithmic strain whatever the material, which is also what Sierra/SM TET15-P1 projects. Until 2026-10-16 the implemented instance projected $J-1$. The difference is measurable where the pointwise $J$ varies within an element: on the indentation benchmark at $h = a/2$ projecting $J-1$ changed the punch force by 0.21% (case A) and 0.41% (case B) against $\log J$, and with $\log J$ the two implementations agree to 0.06%; on the Taylor bar at $h = 0.38$ mm it changed the final radius by 0.06%, and on Cook's membrane the tip displacement by at most 0.03%. The two instances share the mixed treatment of the volume and differ in the plasticity model: additive plasticity in logarithmic strain in (46), multiplicative plasticity with the return map on $\bar{\boldsymbol{b}}^{\mathrm{e}}$ in the implemented instance; the two coincide under proportional loading with fixed principal axes and differ when the axes rotate. The property that a small-strain model is usable without reformulation belongs to the logarithmic instance alone; the Simo–Hughes return map is specific to its own kinematics. The smoothness of the equivalent plastic strain is a question of whether strain and stress cross discretizations, which Section 4.4 settles for either instance, and it is to be measured with the implemented one (Section 13).

## 6 The claim

This section states the claim of the note: which hypothesis of Brezzi's theorem a plastic tangent can violate, and what distinguishes pairs under it. The second hypothesis is coercivity of the deviatoric form on $\ker \boldsymbol{G}_h$ (Section 1).

In elasticity the second hypothesis holds for every conforming pair: by Korn's inequality, which bounds $\int|\operatorname{Grad}\boldsymbol{v}|^2\,\mathrm{d}V$ by a multiple of $\int|\operatorname{dev}\boldsymbol{\epsilon}(\boldsymbol{v})|^2\,\mathrm{d}V$ for $\boldsymbol{v} \in H^1_0$, the deviatoric form is coercive on all of $U_h$, so it is coercive on $\ker \boldsymbol{G}_h$, the set of discrete displacements whose divergence has zero projection onto $Q_h$ (Section 9.1), and no elastic soft mode is a failure of the theorem. A count of exact zero-energy modes on one element is therefore not an argument against a constant pressure in elasticity; Section 9.4 shows that those modes do not persist after assembly.

Under plastic loading the consistent $J_2$ tangent, the derivative of the stress returned by (46) with respect to the strain, is

$$\mathbb{C}^{\mathrm{ep}} = 2\mu\left(\mathbb{I}^{\mathrm{dev}} - \eta\,\boldsymbol{n}\otimes\boldsymbol{n}\right), \qquad \mathbb{I}^{\mathrm{dev}} := \mathbb{I} - \tfrac{1}{3}\boldsymbol{I}\otimes\boldsymbol{I}, \qquad \boldsymbol{n} := \boldsymbol{s}^{\mathrm{tr}}/\left\|\boldsymbol{s}^{\mathrm{tr}}\right\|, \qquad \eta = \frac{2\mu}{2\mu + \frac{2}{3}\mathcal{H}''}, \tag{47}$$

with $\eta = 1$ for perfect plasticity: the shear stiffness along the flow direction is removed.

Read as a constant, the second hypothesis cannot separate pairs. For every $\boldsymbol{v} \in H^1_0(\Omega)$, integration by parts gives $\int|\operatorname{dev}\boldsymbol{\epsilon}|^2\,\mathrm{d}V = \frac{1}{2}\int|\operatorname{Grad}\boldsymbol{v}|^2\,\mathrm{d}V + \frac{1}{6}\int(\operatorname{Div}\boldsymbol{v})^2\,\mathrm{d}V$, and $(\boldsymbol{n}:\boldsymbol{\epsilon})^2 \le |\operatorname{dev}\boldsymbol{\epsilon}|^2$ since $\boldsymbol{n}$ is a unit deviator, so

$$\frac{1}{2\mu}\int \boldsymbol{\epsilon} : \mathbb{C}^{\mathrm{ep}} : \boldsymbol{\epsilon}\,\mathrm{d}V \;\ge\; (1-\eta)\int|\operatorname{dev}\boldsymbol{\epsilon}|^2\,\mathrm{d}V \;\ge\; \frac{1-\eta}{2}\int|\operatorname{Grad}\boldsymbol{v}|^2\,\mathrm{d}V \tag{48}$$

for every conforming pair and every member of its kernel, isochoric or not. For $\eta < 1$ the coercivity constant on $\ker \boldsymbol{G}_h$ is therefore bounded below uniformly in $h$ and in the pair. For $\eta = 1$ the continuum operator loses strong ellipticity, positivity of the energy of every displacement jump across a plane: a shear band, a displacement jump $\boldsymbol{e}_1$ across a plane with normal $\boldsymbol{e}_2$, has $\boldsymbol{\epsilon} \propto \operatorname{sym}(\boldsymbol{e}_1\otimes\boldsymbol{e}_2)$, to which (47) with that $\boldsymbol{n}$

assigns zero energy, so the constant tends to zero under refinement for every pair as the discrete space resolves narrower bands (Section 9.7). Neither limit says anything about the pair.

What distinguishes the pairs is what the soft directions are. A member of $\ker \boldsymbol{G}_h$ that is nearly isochoric is a shear band the continuum problem also has, and its low energy is physical. A member with pointwise nonzero dilatation of zero element mean has the volumetric energy $\kappa \int (\operatorname{Div} \boldsymbol{v})^2 \, \mathrm{d}V$ in the continuum and none in the element, so once the tangent removes its shear energy the element assigns it zero energy. That is the soft mode reported for constant-pressure elements, and whether $\ker \boldsymbol{G}_h$ contains such members is a property of the pair. For a pair satisfying the inf-sup condition, $\ker \boldsymbol{G}_h$ approximates the space of isochoric displacements at the rate of $U_h$ [5, Prop. 5.1.3], so the dilatation carried by any of its members vanishes with $h$. For an element-constant pressure on a quadratic displacement, $\ker \boldsymbol{G}_h$ contains displacements whose dilatation is nonzero pointwise and averages to zero over each element, and their dilatation does not vanish with $h$.

The claim is therefore the following. Under a plastic tangent, every soft mode of the stable pair with a linear discontinuous pressure carries a dilatation $\int (\operatorname{Div} \boldsymbol{v})^2 \, \mathrm{d}V / \int |\operatorname{Grad} \boldsymbol{v}|^2 \, \mathrm{d}V$ that vanishes under refinement, and a constant pressure has soft modes whose dilatation does not; the soft modes reported for constant-pressure elements are the latter, and no stabilization is needed where they are absent. Both operators are linear at a fixed plastic state, so the claim is tested without a nonlinear solve, and Section 9.7 tests it. If the dilatation of the soft modes does not separate the pairs, the formulation has no advantage over the constant-pressure elements it is meant to replace.

# 7 Dynamics

The spatial formulation is unchanged; the mass matrix enters only the displacement block. Two implementation choices are specified.

**Lumping.** Explicit integration divides by a diagonal mass, so every lumped mass must be positive. Row-sum lumping assigns to each node the row sum of the consistent mass matrix, $m_a = \rho \int N_a \, \mathrm{d}V$, which for a basis whose functions sum to one adds up to the element mass. On the quadratic tetrahedron TET10 the vertex functions have negative integrals, so the row-sum mass is negative at the vertices and cannot be used. In the nodal basis of the enriched element (Section 4.3) every row sum is positive: 0.020 of the element mass at each vertex, 0.038 at each edge midpoint, 0.096 at each face centroid and 0.305 at the centroid, on the reference element and on the distorted and Kuhn elements of Section 9.8. The row-sum lumped mass is used; it conserves the momentum of a rigid translation exactly, because the functions sum to one. The alternative is diagonal-scaling lumping [13] (HRZ: Hinton, Rock and Zienkiewicz), which takes the diagonal of the consistent mass, positive for any basis, and scales it to preserve the element mass. In the nodal basis HRZ also conserves momentum. In the hierarchical basis it does not: a rigid translation has zero coefficient on every bubble unknown, so the mass HRZ assigns to the bubbles, 51% of the element mass on the reference tetrahedron, carries no momentum, unless the scaling runs over the ten Lagrange functions alone with each bubble keeping its consistent diagonal (Section 9.8).

**Critical time step.** From the element eigenvalue bound at $\kappa/\mu = 2$ (Section 9.8), the Courant number $c_p \, \Delta t / h$, with $c_p = \sqrt{(\kappa + 4\mu/3)/\rho}$ the dilatational wave speed, $\rho$ the density, $\Delta t$ the stable step and $h$ the element edge length, is given in Table 12 for the four-node linear tetrahedron (TET4), for TET10 under HRZ, and for the enriched element in both bases. The quadratic element reduces the stable step by a factor of 2.4 against the linear one on the same mesh, and the enrichment a further 1.4 with the nodal basis; the ordering is the same on the distorted element and on a Kuhn tetrahedron of the Freudenthal mesh (Section 9.1). A $P_2$ mesh resolves a given feature with fewer elements; on the Taylor bar (Section 11) the smaller element count more than compensates for the smaller step. These Courant numbers hold on the undeformed element: on a deformed mesh the smallest distance between two nodes does not bound the critical step, which is then computed from the largest eigenvalue of $M_L^{-1} K$ (Section 11).

# 8 Optional five-field variant

This section gives the extension to an independent deviatoric strain field, for non-local regularization or for internal variables requiring their own discrete representation: it introduces $\bar{\boldsymbol{e}}$ and $\bar{\boldsymbol{s}}$ in the same discontinuous space, of the same degree as $Q_h$. Sharing the space keeps the return map at shared quadrature points, keeps every elimination element-local, leaves the discrete system non-singular, and — for a linear deviatoric law, and only then — makes the constitutive relation hold pointwise rather than after a projection; with plasticity $\bar{\boldsymbol{s}} = \mathcal{P}_h\, \boldsymbol{s}(\bar{e})$ is projected. Placing $\bar{\boldsymbol{e}}$ and $\bar{\boldsymbol{s}}$ in different spaces loses each of these properties. Remark 2 also applies: with an independent $\bar{\boldsymbol{s}}$, the residual must be assembled from (35) and not from (36).

# 9 Numerical results

Every measurement below is on a linear operator, and all but those of Section 9.6 are at $\boldsymbol{F} = \boldsymbol{I}$: the condensed operator (51) for the count and the locking sweep, the $H^1$ seminorm for the stability sweep, and the deviatoric form under a plastic tangent for the soft-mode measurements. None needs a solver, a material model, or a mesh reader. The scripts are in `prototype/`, each reports its own result, and `checks.jl` verifies the quadrature, the bubbles, and the conformity of the enriched spaces against values known in advance.

## 9.1 Method

Meshes are generated rather than read, so the refinement sequence is exact. The unit cube is divided into $N^3$ cubes and each cube into six tetrahedra by the Freudenthal (Kuhn) subdivision — the six permutations $(a, b, c)$ giving the Kuhn tetrahedra $\{\boldsymbol{0}, \boldsymbol{e}_a, \boldsymbol{e}_a + \boldsymbol{e}_b, (1,1,1)\}$. That decomposition is conforming across shared cube faces, which the five-tetrahedron split is not. Quadratic meshes add edge midpoints in the node order the reference element expects.

For the stability test the displacement is fixed on the entire boundary and three operators are assembled,

$$K_{ij} = \int \operatorname{Grad} N_i : \operatorname{Grad} N_j \,\mathrm{d}V, \qquad G_{mi} = \int \chi_m \operatorname{Div} N_i \,\mathrm{d}V, \qquad M_{mn} = \int \chi_m \chi_n \,\mathrm{d}V, \tag{49}$$

with $N_i$ the displacement basis functions, $\chi_m$ the pressure basis functions, and $K$ the $H^1$ seminorm, the norm on the displacement in (37); $\ker \boldsymbol{G}$ is the discretely isochoric subspace, the set of displacements whose divergence has zero projection onto $Q_h$. The discrete inf-sup constant is $\beta_h = \sqrt{\lambda_{\min}}$ over the nonzero spectrum of

$$\boldsymbol{G}\boldsymbol{K}^{-1}\boldsymbol{G}^{\mathsf{T}}\, q = \lambda \boldsymbol{M}\, q. \tag{50}$$

Boundary data fixed everywhere always leaves one zero mode, the hydrostatic one, because $\int \operatorname{Div} \boldsymbol{v} = 0$ for $\boldsymbol{v} \in H^1_0$; any zero beyond that is a spurious pressure mode.

## 9.2 Spurious modes on one element

For linear response the count of zero-energy modes is a rank count on a single element. Condensing the three fields gives

$$\boldsymbol{K}_e = \boldsymbol{K}^{\mathrm{dev}} + \boldsymbol{K}^{\mathrm{vol}}, \qquad \boldsymbol{K}^{\mathrm{vol}} := \kappa\, \boldsymbol{G}^{\mathsf{T}} \boldsymbol{M}^{-1} \boldsymbol{G}, \qquad M_{mn} = \int_e \chi_m \chi_n \,\mathrm{d}V, \qquad G_{mi} = \int_e \chi_m \,(\operatorname{tr} \boldsymbol{B})_i \,\mathrm{d}V, \tag{51}$$

with $\boldsymbol{B}$ the strain–displacement operator of the element and $m = \dim Q_h$ on one element. $\boldsymbol{K}^{\mathrm{dev}}$ annihilates every mode with zero deviatoric strain at quadrature: the six rigid-body modes, plus the volumetric directions the displacement space can produce. The second term has rank equal to the number of those directions the pressure space resists, at most $m$. Anything left over carries neither deviatoric nor volumetric energy and is exactly zero-energy:

$$n_{\mathrm{spurious}} = \dim \ker \boldsymbol{K}^{\mathrm{dev}} - 6 - \operatorname{rank} \boldsymbol{K}^{\mathrm{vol}}. \tag{52}$$

For the quadratic tetrahedron $\dim \ker \boldsymbol{K}^{\mathrm{dev}} = 10$: six rigid modes and four volumetric directions, the latter because $\operatorname{tr} \boldsymbol{\epsilon}(\boldsymbol{\varphi})$ is a $P_1$ field. Table 4 reports (52) against the measured spectrum.

Four consequences follow.

| Pressure space | $m$ | $\dim\ker \boldsymbol{K}^{\mathrm{dev}}$ | $\operatorname{rank} \boldsymbol{K}^{\mathrm{vol}}$ | predicted | observed |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| $P_0$ constant | 1 | 10 | 1 | **3** | **3** |
| $P_1$ discontinuous | 4 | 10 | 4 | 0 | 0 |
| $P_2$ discontinuous | 10 | 10 | 4 | 0 | 0 |

Table 4: Spurious zero-energy modes of the three-field quadratic tetrahedron at $\kappa/\mu = 10^4$, on the affine element. Script: `prototype/softmode.jl`.

The constant-pressure element carries three modes that are exactly zero-energy on one element, not merely soft. Whether they persist after assembly is the question of Section 9.4.

A $P_1$-discontinuous pressure removes them without an added energy term and leaves the six rigid-body modes. That is an element-level fact: Sections 9.4 and 9.5 show that the same pair locks and is unstable once assembled.

Enriching the pressure further changes nothing: the rank saturates at four, because four is all the displacement space can produce. Enriching the pressure beyond $P_1^{\mathrm{disc}}$ adds unknowns and leaves the rank unchanged.

The count is a property of the affine element. On a curved element, with the midside nodes displaced so that $\det \boldsymbol{J}$ ranges over $[0.55, 1.19]$, the isoparametric displacement space is not polynomial in $\boldsymbol{x}$, only the dilatation of its four volumetric directions remains free of deviatoric strain, $\dim\ker \boldsymbol{K}^{\mathrm{dev}} = 7$, and the three constant-pressure modes are soft rather than exactly zero: the softest nonzero mode of the constant-pressure element lies one to two orders of magnitude below the softest mode of the linear-pressure element on the same curved element. A four-point rule samples a curved element at four points and reports the affine counts there as well; the count uses a 27-point rule. The assembled behavior of Section 9.4 rests on soft rather than exact modes.

**Remark 6.** This identifies the mechanism. Inf-sup stability is a global property of a mesh sequence and is invisible on one element; the rank argument above says which modes exist, not whether the constant in the stability estimate persists under refinement; Section 9.5 measures it.

## 9.3 A necessary condition from degree-of-freedom counts

Whether the constant in the stability estimate persists under refinement is a property of a mesh sequence, and a necessary condition for it follows from counting.

Write $n_u$ for the number of free displacement degrees of freedom and $n_p$ for the pressure degrees of freedom. The Schur complement of the mixed system is $\boldsymbol{S} = \boldsymbol{G}\boldsymbol{K}^{-1}\boldsymbol{G}^{\mathsf{T}}$, an $n_p \times n_p$ matrix of rank at most $n_u$. If $n_p > n_u$ then $\boldsymbol{S}$ is singular by counting, the pressure space carries modes no displacement can resist, and no inf-sup constant exists — regardless of the values those constants would otherwise take.

Table 5 counts them on a Freudenthal-subdivided cube.

| Pair | $N$ | $n_u$ | $n_p$ | $n_p/n_u$ |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| $P_2/P_0$ | 12 | 36,501 | 10,368 | 0.284 |
| $P_2/P_1^{\mathrm{disc}}$ | 12 | 36,501 | 41,472 | **1.136** |
| $P_2 \oplus b_{\mathrm{int}}/P_1^{\mathrm{disc}}$ | 12 | 67,605 | 41,472 | 0.613 |
| $P_2 \oplus b_{\mathrm{int}} \oplus b_{\mathrm{face}}/P_1^{\mathrm{disc}}$ | 12 | 127,221 | 41,472 | 0.326 |

Table 5: Degree-of-freedom counts on the unit cube, displacement fixed on the boundary. Script: `prototype/infsup.jl`.

For $P_2/P_1^{\mathrm{disc}}$ the ratio exceeds one, and its limit is computable. The quadratic nodes of this mesh family fill the $(2N+1)^3$ grid, so with the whole boundary fixed $n_u = 3(2N-1)^3 \to 24N^3$, while $n_p = 4 \cdot 6N^3 = 24N^3$ regardless of boundary data. The ratio tends to one: the pair is critically determined in the limit, which excludes a uniform inf-sup constant.

The finite-$N$ ratio depends on the boundary condition: with the whole boundary fixed, $n_u = 3(2N-1)^3$ and the ratio exceeds one at every $N$; with one face fixed, $n_u = 6N(2N+1)^2$ and it is below one at every $N$. Both tend to one.

**Proposition 1.** *On a tetrahedral mesh family with at least six tetrahedra per vertex asymptotically — the Freudenthal family among them — and the boundary fixed, $P_2/P_1^{\mathrm{disc}}$ is not inf-sup stable, and refinement does not restore stability.*

The restriction to the mesh family is necessary. On a general tetrahedral mesh with $n_V$ vertices, $n_E$ edges and $n_T$ tetrahedra, Euler's relation for a simply connected three-dimensional mesh gives $n_E \approx n_V + n_T$, so $n_u \approx 3(2n_V + n_T)$, $n_p = 4n_T$, and $n_p/n_u \to 4/(3(2n_V/n_T + 1))$, which exceeds one only when $n_T/n_V > 6$. Below that the count refutes nothing, and on other mesh families the pair can be stable: Zhang [31] shows $P_2/P_1^{\mathrm{disc}}$ stable on Powell–Sabin tetrahedral meshes once their known spurious pressure modes are filtered. The general three-dimensional result is Boffi et al. [5, Remark 8.6.2]: with a $P_k$ displacement, a discontinuous pressure is stable on general meshes only at degree $k-3$, so for $k = 2$ nothing is admissible without enrichment.

Adding one interior bubble per element supplies $3n_{\mathrm{el}}$ further displacement degrees of freedom and moves the ratio to 0.613; adding the four face bubbles as well — the enrichment Section 4.1 calls for — supplies $3n_{\mathrm{f}}$ more, one vector unknown per interior face, and moves it to 0.326. Both satisfy $n_p < n_u$. The enrichment also fixes the number of global unknowns. The interior bubble condenses; the face bubbles are shared and do not. The global displacement count of the full enrichment is therefore 36,501 + 59,616 = 96,117, which is 2.6 times the 36,501 of $P_2/P_0$ — also the nodal count of CT10 on the same `TETRA10` mesh — and 2.5 times the 38,698 global unknowns of Taylor–Hood, whose 2,197 vertex pressures cannot be eliminated. The 127,221 in Table 5 is the dimension of the space, not the number of global unknowns.

The count has precedents. $n_p/n_u$ is the constraint count of Nagtegaal et al. [18], whose subject — locking of simplicial elements in the fully plastic range — is this note's, and its reciprocal $\varrho = n_u/n_p$ is the constraint ratio of Hughes [14, §4.3.7], with $\varrho = 3$ the optimum in three dimensions. At $N = 12$: $\varrho = 3.52$ for $P_2/P_0$, 0.88 for $P_2/P_1^{\mathrm{disc}}$, 1.63 with the interior bubble, and 3.07 for the full enrichment. The stable pair has the optimal value, and the isochoric fraction $1 - n_p/n_u$ of Section 9.4 is $1 - 1/\varrho$, with 2/3 the optimum.

Whether that limiting degeneracy is the decisive objection on the meshes tested is a separate question, which Section 9.4 answers.

## 9.4 Assembled behavior

The element count of Section 9.2 is a local statement. An element-local mode persists after assembly only if its trace is compatible with every neighbor across every shared face, so the global count can be smaller than $3n_{\mathrm{el}}$, and it is what the argument against a constant pressure rests on.

Table 6 assembles $\boldsymbol{K}^{\mathrm{dev}} + \kappa \boldsymbol{G}^{\mathsf{T}} \boldsymbol{M}^{-1} \boldsymbol{G}$ over meshes under two boundary conditions: the whole boundary fixed, and the base $z = 0$ alone fixed. The second is closer to the conditions of a body confined on part of its boundary and free elsewhere, under which soft modes are reported.

The locking measure is again a rank. A displacement mode has volumetric energy exactly when it lies outside $\ker \boldsymbol{G}$, so as $\kappa \to \infty$ the reachable deformations collapse onto that kernel and $\dim \ker \boldsymbol{G} = n_u - \operatorname{rank} \boldsymbol{G}$ is the discretely isochoric subspace. A large fraction means the element still deforms; a collapse toward zero is volumetric locking.

The fraction is compared with a bound. Since $\operatorname{rank} \boldsymbol{G} \le n_p$, it cannot fall below $1 - n_p/n_u$. A pair that attains that bound has $\operatorname{rank} \boldsymbol{G} = n_p$: every pressure mode is resisted by a distinct displacement direction. A fraction above the bound means that $n_p - \operatorname{rank} \boldsymbol{G}$ pressure modes are unresisted; a pair that cannot reach it, because $n_p > n_u$, is over-determined. The difference $n_p - \operatorname{rank} \boldsymbol{G}$ counts the pressure modes no displacement resists, which with the whole boundary fixed should be exactly one, the hydrostatic mode; Table 7 carries it as a column.

Three findings follow.

**The constant-pressure soft modes do not persist after assembly.** No spurious mode is present under either boundary condition at any mesh. Nor are they present as low-energy modes: the smallest eigenvalue relative to the deviatoric scale is $2.39 \times 10^{-3}$ for $P_0$ against $2.74 \times 10^{-3}$ for $P_1^{\mathrm{disc}}$ on the same mesh with the base alone fixed, and both are the long-wavelength modes of that block. The three modes per element of Section 9.2 exist on each element and are element-local: their traces do not match across faces.

What this test does not detect is the mode Foulk III et al. [12] report, which is remedied there by a penalty and therefore has energy, small and not zero. Those are the displacement modes in $\ker \boldsymbol{G}_{P_0}$ whose divergence is nonzero pointwise, which carry shear energy alone in the element; whether they are spurious is

| boundary | Pair | $N$ | $n_u$ | $n_p$ | rank $\boldsymbol{G}$ | fraction | bound |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| whole | $P_2/P_0$ | 3 | 375 | 162 | 158 | 0.579 | 0.568 |
| | | 4 | 1029 | 384 | 380 | 0.631 | 0.627 |
| | $P_2/P_1^{\mathrm{disc}}$ | 3 | 375 | 648 | 363 | **0.032** | — |
| | | 4 | 1029 | 1536 | 957 | **0.070** | — |
| | $\oplus\, b_{\mathrm{int}}$ | 3 | 861 | 648 | 644 | 0.252 | 0.247 |
| | | 4 | 2181 | 1536 | 1532 | 0.298 | 0.296 |
| | $\oplus\, b_{\mathrm{face}}$ | 3 | 1185 | 648 | 646 | 0.455 | 0.453 |
| | | 4 | 3045 | 1536 | 1534 | 0.496 | 0.496 |
| | $\oplus\, b_{\mathrm{int}}, b_{\mathrm{face}}$ | 3 | 1671 | 648 | 647 | **0.613** | 0.612 |
| | | 4 | 4197 | 1536 | 1535 | **0.634** | 0.634 |
| | $P_2 \oplus b_{\mathrm{face}}/P_0$ | 3 | 1185 | 162 | 161 | 0.864 | 0.863 |
| | | 4 | 3045 | 384 | 383 | 0.874 | 0.874 |
| base | $P_2/P_0$ | 3 | 882 | 162 | 162 | 0.816 | 0.816 |
| | | 4 | 1944 | 384 | 384 | 0.802 | 0.802 |
| | $P_2/P_1^{\mathrm{disc}}$ | 3 | 882 | 648 | 522 | 0.408 | 0.265 |
| | | 4 | 1944 | 1536 | 1216 | 0.374 | 0.210 |
| | $\oplus\, b_{\mathrm{int}}$ | 3 | 1368 | 648 | 648 | 0.526 | 0.526 |
| | | 4 | 3096 | 1536 | 1536 | 0.504 | 0.504 |
| | $\oplus\, b_{\mathrm{face}}$ | 3 | 1962 | 648 | 648 | 0.670 | 0.670 |
| | | 4 | 4440 | 1536 | 1536 | 0.654 | 0.654 |
| | $\oplus\, b_{\mathrm{int}}, b_{\mathrm{face}}$ | 3 | 2448 | 648 | 648 | 0.735 | 0.735 |
| | | 4 | 5592 | 1536 | 1536 | 0.725 | 0.725 |
| | $P_2 \oplus b_{\mathrm{face}}/P_0$ | 3 | 1962 | 162 | 162 | 0.917 | 0.917 |
| | | 4 | 4440 | 384 | 384 | 0.914 | 0.914 |

Table 6: Assembled count at $\kappa/\mu = 10^4$. The bound is $1 - n_p/n_u$ and is undefined where $n_p > n_u$. Assembled zero-energy modes were zero in every row. Script: `prototype/locking.jl`.

the coercivity question of Section 6, which Section 9.7 measures, and not a count of zeros. CT10 of Foulk III et al. [12] is built on a subdivided-linear displacement space rather than $P_2$, which is a different kernel and is not modeled here; the soft mode of that element may be specific to it. Nothing above contradicts their observation; it does not reproduce it on a quadratic tetrahedron.

**The unenriched pair locks.** With the boundary fixed, $P_2/P_1^{\mathrm{disc}}$ retains 3–7% of its deformation modes as $\kappa$ grows, against 58–63% for $P_0$; with the base alone fixed, 37–41% against 80%. Under either boundary condition it is the pair that over-constrains, and locking is the more serious failure because the element returns a stiff response and no spurious mode indicates the error.

**The interior bubble raises the rank of $\boldsymbol{G}$ over a linear pressure.** As Remark 7 states, the interior bubble adds nothing to the rank over $P_0$. Against the linear pressure modes its columns are not zero: it raises $\operatorname{rank}\boldsymbol{G}$ from 957 to 1532 at $N = 4$, and the interior-only pair has an isochoric fraction of 0.252–0.298. The full enrichment reaches 0.61–0.63, equal to $P_0$'s to two digits and without $P_0$'s element-level degeneracy; it attains the bound $1 - n_p/n_u$ to three digits and the interior-only pair to two, so every pressure mode is resisted by a distinct displacement direction; and for the full pair $n_p - \operatorname{rank}\boldsymbol{G} = 1$ at every mesh, the hydrostatic mode alone, where $P_2/P_0$ and the interior-only pair carry four: the enrichment raises $\operatorname{rank}\boldsymbol{G}$ to $n_p - 1$.

## 9.5 Stability, measured against a validated control

The count of Section 9.3 is a necessary condition; Table 7 shows that it is not sufficient.

Two properties of the computation allow meshes to $N = 8$. With $\boldsymbol{K} = \boldsymbol{P}^{\mathsf{T}}\boldsymbol{L}\boldsymbol{L}^{\mathsf{T}}\boldsymbol{P}$ from a sparse Cholesky, $q^{\mathsf{T}}\boldsymbol{G}\boldsymbol{K}^{-1}\boldsymbol{G}^{\mathsf{T}}q = \|\boldsymbol{L}^{-1}(\boldsymbol{G}^{\mathsf{T}}q)_{[p]}\|^2$, so $\beta_h$ is the smallest nonzero singular value of $\boldsymbol{W} = \boldsymbol{L}^{-1}\boldsymbol{G}^{\mathsf{T}}\boldsymbol{M}^{-1/2}$ — never forming $\boldsymbol{G}\boldsymbol{K}^{-1}\boldsymbol{G}^{\mathsf{T}}$, and so never squaring the condition number of the quantity measured. And the null

dimension is fixed independently as $n_p - \operatorname{rank} \boldsymbol{G}$, so the cut is taken by index rather than by selecting a threshold. The gap is unambiguous: $O(10^{-15})$ below it against $O(10^{-2})$ above.

The sweep carries a positive control, the Taylor–Hood pair, whose stability in three dimensions is established [5]: a valid test must report it stable. A negative control alone cannot detect a test that reports every pair unstable; the negative control, $P_1/P_0$, gives $\beta_h = 0.333$, 0.229, 0.165, 0.129 at $N = 2$ to 5 with 45, 138, 303, 558 unresisted pressure modes, the alternating-sign spurious pressure mode of that pair (script `prototype/infsup.jl`).

| Pair | $h = 1/2$ | 1/4 | 1/6 | 1/8 | null | local rate |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| $P_2/P_1$ continuous (control) | 0.1734 | 0.2186 | 0.2214 | **0.2216** | 1 | −0.003 |
| $P_2/P_0$ | 0.1001 | 0.0755 | 0.0544 | 0.0418 | 4 | 0.97 |
| $\oplus\, b_{\text{int}}$ | 0.1015 | 0.0756 | 0.0544 | — | 4 | 0.84 |
| $\oplus\, b_{\text{face}}$ | 0.4671 | 0.4228 | 0.4060 | **0.3967** | 1 | 0.076 |
| $P_2/P_1^{\text{disc}}$ | 0.1132 | 0.0424 | 0.0277 | — | $n_p - n_u$ | 1.04 |
| $\oplus\, b_{\text{int}}$ | 0.0782 | 0.0564 | 0.0406 | — | 4 | 0.83 |
| $\oplus\, b_{\text{face}}$ | 0.0938 | 0.0701 | 0.0497 | — | 2 | 0.88 |
| $\oplus\, b_{\text{int}}, b_{\text{face}}$ | 0.2875 | 0.2962 | **0.2968** | — | 1 | −0.003 |

Table 7: $\beta_h$ over a Freudenthal mesh sequence, whole boundary fixed, ordered as the construction of Boffi et al. [5, Example 8.7.2] runs. "null" is $n_p - \operatorname{rank} \boldsymbol{G}$, the pressure modes no displacement resists, which must be one; "local rate" is $\ln(\beta_N/\beta_{N+1})/\ln((N+1)/N)$ at the last refinement, with $\beta_N$ the constant at refinement $N$, constant for a genuine power law and shrinking toward zero for a sequence approaching a limit. Script: `prototype/beta.jl`.

The control is reported stable: $\beta_h$ rises and settles on 0.2216, flat to three digits over the last three refinements, which validates the reading of the remaining rows.

Every row of Table 7 is what Boffi et al. [5] predict. What the sweep establishes is that the scripts are sound and that the theory applies to this mesh family; what it adds to the theory is the constants. The rows are ordered as the construction of Boffi et al. [5, Example 8.7.2] adds degrees of freedom.

**$P_2$ does not control a constant pressure in three dimensions.** $P_2/P_0$ decays at a local rate approaching one, although $n_p/n_u = 0.284$, and carries four pressure null modes at every mesh where one is allowed: the hydrostatic mode and three exact spurious modes that no quadratic displacement resists. That is the statement of Boffi et al. [5, §8.7] quoted in Section 4.1, and the three modes are the pressure modes that face degrees of freedom would resist.

**The interior bubble cannot supply it.** $P_2 \oplus b_{\text{int}}/P_0$ reproduces $P_2/P_0$ to three digits with the same four null modes, for the reason in Remark 7. Over $P_1^{\text{disc}}$ the interior bubble changes $\beta_h$ from 0.0424 to 0.0564 at $h = 1/4$ and from 0.0277 to 0.0406 at $h = 1/6$, and the rate falls from 1.04 to 0.83, but the sequence decays and four null modes remain. This pair has $n_p/n_u = 0.613$ (Table 5) and is unstable.

**Face bubbles control the constant pressure.** $P_2 \oplus b_{\text{face}}/P_0$ drops the null dimension to one at every mesh and its $\beta_h$ approaches from above with a local rate that falls from 0.16 to 0.08 over the sequence, below the constant rate of a power law and above the rate −0.003 of the control. The seven refinements measured, of which Table 7 shows four, cannot separate a limit near 0.35 from a slow decay on their own, and the row is reported as consistent with stable; its stability rests on Boffi et al. [5, Example 8.7.2], whose proof constructs, from the face degrees of freedom, a displacement that matches the divergence of any given field in the mean on every face. Over $P_1^{\text{disc}}$ the face bubbles alone leave one spurious linear pressure mode per mesh and $\beta_h$ decays: controlling the linear modes is the function of the interior bubble.

**Both together are the three-dimensional Crouzeix–Raviart pair, and it is stable.** $\beta_h$ rises monotonically to 0.2968, flat to three digits over the last three refinements, with a local rate of −0.003 — the same rate as the control's, and at a higher constant than the control's 0.2216. The pressure null space is one dimensional at every mesh. Each part of the enrichment controls one part of the pressure space, and neither controls the other's.

Table 8: $\beta_h$ at $N = 5$ on deformed configurations, whole boundary fixed, with the local rate over $N = 4 \to 5$ in parentheses for the Crouzeix–Raviart pair; the null dimension is one on every row for the three left-hand pairs. The $P_2/P_0$ column gives its null dimension and $\beta_h$: its three exact spurious modes exist only on the affine mesh.

| map | $J$ | $P_2/P_1$ cont. | $P_2 \oplus b_{\text{face}}/P_0$ | $P_2 \oplus b_{\text{int}} \oplus b_{\text{face}}/P_1^{\text{disc}}$ | $P_2/P_0$ (null, $\beta_h$) |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| reference | 1 | 0.221 | 0.413 | 0.297 (−0.003) | 4, 0.063 |
| twist 90° | 0.99–1.01 | 0.189 | 0.385 | 0.204 (0.18) | 1, 0.027 |
| twist 180° | 0.98–1.05 | 0.137 | 0.345 | 0.116 (0.42) | 1, 0.051 |
| parabolic shear | 1 | 0.176 | 0.336 | 0.183 (0.05) | 1, 0.005 |
| inflation | 1.0–2.3 | 0.192 | 0.368 | 0.276 (0.01) | 1, 0.004 |
| compression | 0.5 | 0.192 | 0.333 | 0.213 (0.00) | 4, 0.038 |

**Remark 7** (The distinct functions of the two enrichments)**.** The interior bubble has zero pairing with a constant pressure: it vanishes on the whole element boundary, so $\int_{\Omega_e} \operatorname{Div} \boldsymbol{b}_{\text{int}} = 0$ and its columns of $\boldsymbol{G}$ against a $P_0$ mode are identically zero. It pairs only with the linear pressure modes, which is why it changes $P_2/P_1^{\text{disc}}$ and changes the $P_2/P_0$ constant by at most 0.0014 (the $P_2 \oplus b_{\text{int}}/P_0$ row of Table 7, with the same null dimension): upward, because enlarging $U_h$ cannot lower $\beta_h$, and by at most 0.0014, because the bubble's columns of $\boldsymbol{G}$ against $P_0$ are zero. `checks.jl` reads those columns directly and confirms it. The face bubbles are what supply a displacement response to the pressure jump across a face, which is the mode a discontinuous pressure needs resisted.

$P_2/P_0$ and $P_2 \oplus b_{\text{int}}/P_1^{\text{disc}}$ have $n_p/n_u = 0.284$ and 0.613 and are unstable: a ratio above one excludes a pair, and a ratio below one does not admit it.

**Remark 8** (Mesh dependence)**.** These results are for the Freudenthal subdivision, a structured family, and structured meshes are where pair counterexamples characteristically arise: the alternating-sign spurious pressure mode of $P_1/P_0$ has its largest amplitude on them. A pair can degenerate on a structured mesh and remain well behaved on a general one. On this family, $P_2/P_0$, $P_2/P_1^{\text{disc}}$ and $P_2 \oplus b_{\text{int}}/P_1^{\text{disc}}$ decay; confirming that as a property of the pairs rather than of the mesh needs a sequence of unstructured meshes, which this study does not have. Section 9.6 gives one measurement in the opposite sense: on the non-affine images of this mesh the $P_2/P_0$ constant is smaller. The affirmative result needs no such confirmation, since Boffi et al. [5, Example 8.7.2] establish it on any shape-regular family; what the sweep adds is the constant.

## 9.6 Stability on a deformed configuration

Every measurement above is at $\boldsymbol{F} = \boldsymbol{I}$. At a finite deformation the pairing is $\int \varpi \operatorname{div}_{\boldsymbol{x}} \boldsymbol{\psi} \, \mathrm{d}V$ (Section 4.1), the divergence pairing on the deformed configuration with the pressure scaled by $1/J$, and whether $\beta_h$ stays bounded below under a large non-affine deformation is what the regime of Section 1 requires. Auricchio et al. [3] show, on a two-dimensional finite-strain problem with a loading parameter, that mixed elements stable in linear elasticity (the MINI triangle, a mixed-enhanced quadrilateral and the quadrilateral $Q_2/P_1^{\text{disc}}$) fail to reproduce the range of the parameter over which the continuum problem is stable: the discrete problem becomes unstable where the continuum one is stable, or stays stable where it is not; and Auricchio et al. [4] conclude that for such pairs in finite elasticity the causes are identified but a general remedy is still missing. This section measures the constant of the pair on deformed configurations for that reason. The operators (49) are assembled on the isoparametric image of the quadratic mesh under a prescribed map, with the derivatives, the divergence and the volume taken on the image and the pressure basis on the reference cell as the element uses it, and with the boundary conditions of the reference cube; the scaling by $1/J$ changes $\beta_h$ by at most the ratio of extreme Jacobians and is not applied. Five maps of the unit cube, about its center: a twist about the vertical axis by 90° and by 180° over the height, isochoric and non-affine, with shear strains near 2 at the corners of the latter; a parabolic shear $x_1 = X_1 + \frac{1}{2}X_3^2$, isochoric; a radial inflation with $J$ from 1 to 2.3; and an affine compression to $J = \frac{1}{2}$ as a control, since an affine map changes $\beta_h$ only through the element aspect ratio. Table 8 gives the result at $N = 5$ with the local rate over the last refinement. Script: `prototype/deformed.jl`.

Three findings follow.

**$\beta_h$ is not uniform in the deformation.** It decreases with the local shear of the map for every pair, and most for the Crouzeix–Raviart pair: from 0.297 to 0.204 under the 90° twist, 0.116 under the 180° twist and 0.183 under the parabolic shear, against 0.221 → 0.189, 0.137, 0.176 for Taylor–Hood and 0.413 → 0.385, 0.345, 0.336 for the face-bubbled constant-pressure pair. The inflation, which changes $J$ by a factor of 2.3 but shears little, leaves the constant at 0.276. The affine compression gives 0.213, flat to four digits from $N = 3$: the aspect-ratio effect alone. The dependence is on the shear of the deformation and not on its volume change.

**At a fixed deformation the sequence in $h$ is consistent with a positive limit.** The local rate of the Crouzeix–Raviart pair falls with $N$ on every non-affine map: 0.28, 0.22, 0.18 over $N = 2$ to 5 for the 90° twist, 0.67, 0.53, 0.42 for the 180° twist, and 0.05 for the parabolic shear (through $N = 5$). A power-law decay would hold its rate. The 180° row has not flattened by $N = 5$, and its shear strain of about 2 at the corners is beyond what a plastic zone of the problems listed in Section 13 reaches; the finding is that the constant degrades with the strain, not that it vanishes. At $N = 6$ the pair gives 0.1975, 0.1088 and 0.182 on the three non-affine maps, local rates of 0.17, 0.35 and 0.04, each below the rate before it.

**The exact spurious modes of $P_2/P_0$ belong to the affine mesh.** Under every non-affine map the pressure null dimension of $P_2/P_0$ falls from four to one, the three modes are resisted, and $\beta_h$ of $P_2/P_0$ is smaller on every non-affine image, 0.004 to 0.05, than on the reference mesh, 0.063.

## 9.7 Coercivity under a plastic tangent

The claim of Section 6 is measured as the constant it names. With $\boldsymbol{Z}$ a basis of $\ker \boldsymbol{G}_h$,

$$\lambda_{\min} = \min_{q} \frac{q^{\mathsf{T}}\, \boldsymbol{Z}^{\mathsf{T}} \boldsymbol{K}^{\mathrm{ep}} \boldsymbol{Z}\, q}{q^{\mathsf{T}}\, \boldsymbol{Z}^{\mathsf{T}} \boldsymbol{K}^{H^1} \boldsymbol{Z}\, q}, \qquad \boldsymbol{K}^{\mathrm{ep}}_{ij} = \frac{1}{2\mu} \int \boldsymbol{\epsilon}_i : \mathbb{C}^{\mathrm{ep}} : \boldsymbol{\epsilon}_j \, \mathrm{d}V, \tag{53}$$

is the smallest generalized eigenvalue of the deviatoric form under the tangent (47) against the $H^1$ seminorm, restricted to the discretely isochoric subspace. It is dimensionless, it is taken on the exact kernel rather than through a penalty, and it is the constant of the second hypothesis; (48) says what to expect of it, at least $(1 - \eta)/2$ for every pair when $\eta < 1$ and a decay to zero for every pair when $\eta = 1$. The quantity that carries the claim is the dilatation of the eigenmodes,

$$r_v(\boldsymbol{v}) := \frac{\int (\mathrm{Div}\, \boldsymbol{v})^2 \, \mathrm{d}V}{\int |\mathrm{Grad}\, \boldsymbol{v}|^2 \, \mathrm{d}V}, \tag{54}$$

zero for an isochoric field. The flow direction is uniform, $\boldsymbol{n} = \mathrm{sym}(\boldsymbol{e}_1 \otimes \boldsymbol{e}_2)/\sqrt{2}$ or $\boldsymbol{n} = \mathrm{dev}(\boldsymbol{e}_3 \otimes \boldsymbol{e}_3)/\,\|\cdot\|$, which is the most unfavorable choice: the continuum operator then admits shear bands of any width, a decaying eigenvalue is expected of every pair, and only the dilatation of the mode says whether the band is physical. The tangent is taken at $\eta = 1$ and at $\eta = 0.9$, the boundary is fixed everywhere, and each pair is measured elastically ($\eta = 0$) on the same kernel. Script: `prototype/plastic.jl`.

**The scripts are checked by an identity.** By the identity behind (48), the elastic form on any kernel satisfies $\lambda = \frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{6} r_v$, so its lowest mode has $r_v = 0$ and $\lambda_1 = 0.5$ exactly. Every row of the sweep reproduces this; at $N = 2$ for $P_2/P_0$, where the kernel has no isochoric member, $\lambda_1 = 0.5024$ with $r_v = 0.0146$, as the identity requires. The identity is also the check on the energy metric of the scripts.

**The constant does not separate pairs, as (48) predicts.** Under the shear direction $\lambda_1$ decays for every pair, the control included, at rates between $h^{1.5}$ and $h^2$: the discrete spaces resolve narrower shear bands, which the continuum operator admits with zero energy. Under the uniaxial direction no shear band has $\boldsymbol{\epsilon} \propto \boldsymbol{n}$, and $\lambda_1$ converges for the three element-local pairs, to 0.10 for $P_2/P_0$, 0.071 for $P_2 \oplus b_{\mathrm{face}}/P_0$ and 0.13 for the Crouzeix–Raviart pair, while it decays for Taylor–Hood. At $\eta = 0.9$ every $\lambda_1$ lies above the lower bound 0.05 of (48), the smallest being the control's 0.067.

Table 9: Lowest mode of the deviatoric form on $\ker \boldsymbol{G}_h$ under the tangent (47) at $\eta = 1$, Freudenthal cube with the whole boundary fixed: the eigenvalue $\lambda_1$ of (53) and the dilatation $r_v$ of its mode, (54), for a shear and a uniaxial flow direction. The elastic lowest mode has $\lambda_1 = 0.500$ and $r_v = 0$ on every row, as the identity behind (48) requires. At $\eta = 0.9$ every $\lambda_1$ exceeds the lower bound 0.05 of (48) and the dilatations agree with those below to two digits. Script: `prototype/plastic.jl`.

| | | $\boldsymbol{n} = \mathrm{sym}(\boldsymbol{e}_1 \otimes \boldsymbol{e}_2)/\sqrt{2}$ | | $\boldsymbol{n} = \mathrm{dev}(\boldsymbol{e}_3 \otimes \boldsymbol{e}_3)/\,\|\cdot\|$ | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Pair | $N$ | $\lambda_1$ | $r_v$ | $\lambda_1$ | $r_v$ |
| $P_2/P_0$ | 3 | 0.109 | 0.065 | 0.117 | 0.208 |
| | 4 | 0.067 | 0.034 | 0.106 | 0.217 |
| | 5 | 0.047 | 0.029 | 0.101 | **0.220** |
| $P_2 \oplus b_{\mathrm{face}}/P_0$ | 3 | 0.044 | 0.044 | 0.082 | 0.274 |
| | 4 | 0.026 | 0.028 | 0.074 | 0.268 |
| | 5 | 0.017 | 0.019 | 0.071 | **0.261** |
| $P_2 \oplus b_{\mathrm{int}} \oplus b_{\mathrm{face}}/P_1^{\mathrm{disc}}$ | 3 | 0.074 | 0.036 | 0.147 | 0.018 |
| | 4 | 0.049 | 0.019 | 0.139 | 0.0074 |
| | 5 | 0.032 | 0.0066 | 0.134 | **0.0042** |
| $P_2/P_1$ continuous (control) | 3 | 0.056 | 0.051 | 0.053 | 0.861 |
| | 4 | 0.030 | 0.029 | 0.026 | 0.929 |
| | 5 | 0.019 | 0.020 | 0.016 | **0.956** |

Table 10: Spurious modes among the twenty lowest of the plastic form on $\ker \boldsymbol{G}_h$ ($r_v > 0.1$) in a confined plastic zone with a varying flow direction, at $N = 3, 4, 5$.

| field | boundary | $P_2/P_0$ | $P_2 \oplus b_{\mathrm{face}}/P_0$ | $P_2 \oplus b_{\mathrm{int}} \oplus b_{\mathrm{face}}/P_1^{\mathrm{disc}}$ | $P_2/P_1$ cont. |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| indentation | whole fixed | 16, 15, 7 | 18, 17, 5 | 4, **0, 0** | 20, 18, 17 |
| indentation | base fixed | 11, 1, 0 | 13, 5, 0 | **0, 0, 0** | 14, 7, 5 |
| twist | whole fixed | 14, 18, 15 | 18, 13, 8 | 1, 4, **0** | 20, 20, 20 |
| twist | base fixed | 5, 2, 0 | 13, 7, 4 | **0, 0, 0** | 12, 13, 12 |

**The dilatation of the soft modes separates them, in the direction claimed.** Under the uniaxial direction the lowest modes of both constant-pressure pairs carry $r_v = 0.20$–$0.27$ at every refinement, with no decay. These are the modes of Section 6: the element assigns them no energy for a dilatation the continuum resists with $\kappa$, and they are the softest modes the element has. The lowest modes of the Crouzeix–Raviart pair carry 0.040, 0.018, 0.0074 and 0.0042 over $N = 2$ to 5, decaying as $h^2$, the rate at which Boffi et al. [5, Prop. 5.1.3] makes $\ker \boldsymbol{G}_h$ approximate the isochoric space; its soft modes are physical. Under the shear direction the lowest modes of every pair are shear bands whose dilatation decays, the Crouzeix–Raviart pair's three to four times smaller than the others' at $N = 5$. Counted over the twenty lowest modes, with a mode called spurious when $r_v > 0.1$ (the stable pair's soft modes lie below 0.02 from $N = 4$ on, the spurious ones at 0.2–0.4): under the uniaxial direction at $N = 5$ all twenty of each constant-pressure pair's and of Taylor–Hood's are spurious, and none of the Crouzeix–Raviart pair's at any $N$; under the shear direction the twenty lowest of every element-local pair are bands at $N = 5$. The spurious modes of a constant pressure are therefore present in both directions but are the lowest modes only where the flow admits no band; the next paragraph therefore counts them among the twenty lowest in a zone with a varying flow direction.

**A confined zone with a varying flow direction.** The flow direction and the plastic zone are taken from a prescribed displacement field: $\boldsymbol{n} = \mathrm{dev}\,\boldsymbol{\epsilon}(\boldsymbol{u})/\,\|\mathrm{dev}\,\boldsymbol{\epsilon}(\boldsymbol{u})\|$ at each quadrature point and $\eta = 1$ where $|\mathrm{dev}\,\boldsymbol{\epsilon}(\boldsymbol{u})|$ exceeds 0.35 of its peak, $\eta = 0$ elsewhere. Two fields: an indentation of the top face, $u_3 = -\exp(-d^2/w^2)\,X_3$ with $d$ the distance from the vertical axis and $w = \frac{1}{4}$, whose zone is 51% of the volume with elastic surroundings; and the displacement of the 90° twist of Section 9.6, whose zone is 97%. Both are run with the whole boundary fixed and with the base alone fixed. Table 10 counts the spurious modes among the twenty lowest. Script: `prototype/plastic_zone.jl`.

With the whole boundary fixed the constant-pressure pairs retain between five and fifteen spurious modes among their twenty softest at $N = 5$, and under the twist the softest mode of $P_2/P_0$ is spurious at every $N$ up

to 4 ($r_v = 0.22$–$0.31$) and its third at $N = 5$ (0.20). The Crouzeix–Raviart pair has none from $N = 4$ on under the indentation and none at $N = 5$ under the twist, and none at any $N$ with the base alone fixed. Taylor–Hood keeps seventeen to twenty, and under the twist its softest mode's dilatation grows with refinement, 0.29, 0.37, 0.66, 0.74. With the base alone fixed the softest modes of every pair are long-wavelength motions of the block and the counts fall for the constant-pressure pairs too, to zero at $N = 5$ for $P_2/P_0$ and four for the face-bubbled pair, so the spurious modes are then above the twentieth; they are not absent, as the whole-boundary rows show. Whether a nonlinear solve excites them is the open measurement of Section 13.

**Taylor–Hood is the worst pair on this measure.** Its pressure is continuous, so its kernel is divergence-free only against continuous linear test functions, and under the uniaxial direction its lowest modes are dilatation almost entirely: $r_v = 0.86$, 0.93, 0.96 at $N = 3$, 4, 5, with $\lambda_1$ decaying to 0.016. Those modes have no counterpart in the continuum, which resists them with $\kappa$. Taylor–Hood is therefore an alternative for elasticity only (Section 14).

**CT10 on the same measure.** The LCM CT10, the element Section 10 compares against, is measured with the same scripts (`prototype/composite_tet.jl`) as Albany builds it: ten nodes, a displacement that is linear on each of twelve subtetrahedra, the gradient of that displacement projected onto the linear functions of the element for the constitutive update, and a five-point rule of degree three. Two volumetric variants exist in Albany: $J$ replaced by its element mean (the option `Weighted Volume Average J`), whose constraint as $\kappa \to \infty$ is a constant pressure on the projected dilatation, and $J$ at each quadrature point, whose constraint at the five points is a linear discontinuous pressure. With the averaged $J$, under the uniaxial flow direction, the three lowest modes carry $r_v = 0.22$ to 0.25 at $N = 3$, 4, 5 with no decay, all twenty lowest modes are spurious from $N = 4$ on, and in the confined zones of Table 10 with the whole boundary fixed the count at $N = 5$ is 17 under the indentation and 19 under the twist, against 7 and 15 for $P_2/P_0$. With $J$ at each point the discretely isochoric subspace has dimension 0, 0, 2 and 16 at $N = 2$ to 5, against 72 for $P_2/P_1^{\mathrm{disc}}$ at $N = 4$: the element locks, and too few modes exist to count. The average removes the locking and admits the spurious dilatational modes of a constant pressure, in larger numbers than $P_2/P_0$. The measurement is linearized, like every other in this section, and models no stabilization of the element's own zero-energy modes, because the Albany runs of Section 10 use none.

## 9.8 Quadrature rule and basis

Two implementation choices set the number of operations per element and its explicit stable step, and neither is decided by the stability results: the quadrature rule, and the basis that carries the enriched space. Both are measured on one element. Scripts: `prototype/quadrature.jl` and `prototype/basis.jl`.

**Quadrature.** The scripts integrate the enriched element to degree 6 so that the linear measurements are exact. For the element the criterion is weaker: a rule is admissible when the condensed stiffness $\boldsymbol{K}_e = \boldsymbol{K}^{\mathrm{dev}} + \kappa \boldsymbol{G}^{\mathsf{T}} \boldsymbol{M}^{-1} \boldsymbol{G}$ has exactly six zero-energy modes, and its effect is the softening it introduces, measured as the extreme generalized eigenvalues of $\boldsymbol{K}_e$(rule) against $\boldsymbol{K}_e$(exact) on the complement of the rigid modes, which are 1 for an exact rule. Table 11 gives both for the rules considered, with a degree-11 rule of 216 points as the reference. The two rules supplied by `ReferenceFiniteElements` (RFE), the Julia package that provides the reference elements and their quadrature, four and five points, leave 21 zero modes and are inadmissible. The eight-point conical rule (a tensor-product Gauss rule mapped onto the tetrahedron) is rank sufficient and softens the element to 0.03–0.10 of its stiffness in the worst direction, which is also inadmissible. Two degree-5 rules are admissible: the 14-point symmetric rule of Walkington [29], which integrates every monomial through degree 5 to $4 \times 10^{-16}$ and over-stiffens the interior bubble's own block by 35% since its gradient-squared is of degree 6, and the 27-point conical rule, which under-stiffens the same block by 9–12%. Assembled, both give the Crouzeix–Raviart pair's constant within 1% (0.293 and 0.298 against 0.297 at $N = 5$), a one-dimensional pressure null space, no spurious mode among the twenty lowest under the uniaxial plastic tangent, and the same dilatation of the lowest mode (0.0073, 0.0074 and 0.0074). The 14-point rule satisfies the criteria — six zero-energy modes, positive weights, 4.6 times fewer points than the 64-point degree-7 rule — and is used, with a stiffer interior bubble.

Table 11: Quadrature rules on the enriched element: zero-energy modes of the condensed stiffness (six is correct) and of the deviatoric stiffness (ten: six rigid modes and the four volumetric directions of Section 9.2), and the extreme softening factors against a 216-point rule, on the reference tetrahedron and on a Kuhn tetrahedron of the Freudenthal mesh. $\kappa/\mu = 10^4$. Script: `prototype/quadrature.jl`.

| | | reference | | | Kuhn | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| rule | points | zero($\boldsymbol{K}_e$) | min | max | zero($\boldsymbol{K}_e$) | min | max |
| RFE degree 2 | 4 | 21 | 0 | 1.30 | 21 | 0 | 1.30 |
| RFE degree 3 | 5 | 21 | $< 0$ | 1.13 | 21 | $< 0$ | 1.12 |
| conical degree 3 | 8 | 6 | 0.10 | 1.14 | 6 | 0.03 | 1.21 |
| Walkington degree 5 | 14 | 6 | 1.00 | 1.35 | 6 | 1.00 | 1.35 |
| conical degree 5 | 27 | 6 | 0.91 | 1.00 | 6 | 0.88 | 1.00 |
| conical degree 7 | 64 | 6 | 1.00 | 1.00 | 6 | 1.00 | 1.00 |

Table 12: Basis choice on the reference tetrahedron, $\kappa/\mu = 2$, $\mu = \rho = 1$: condition numbers of the condensed stiffness on the complement of the rigid modes and of the consistent mass, the smallest lumped mass over $\rho V$, the momentum of a unit translation under the lumped mass over $\rho V$, and the Courant number $c_p \Delta t/h$ from the element bound. Script: `prototype/basis.jl`.

| basis, lumping | cond $\boldsymbol{K}_e$ | cond $\boldsymbol{M}$ | min $m/\rho V$ | momentum | Courant |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| hierarchical, consistent | 797 | 778 | — | — | 0.092 |
| hierarchical, HRZ over all 15 | — | — | 0.014 | 0.486 | 0.097 |
| hierarchical, HRZ over Lagrange 10 | — | — | 0.028 | 1.000 | 0.114 |
| nodal, consistent | 559 | 94 | — | — | 0.092 |
| nodal, HRZ | — | — | 0.021 | 1.000 | 0.145 |
| nodal, row sum | — | — | 0.020 | 1.000 | 0.146 |
| TET10, HRZ | — | — | 0.028 | 1.000 | 0.197 |
| TET10, row sum | — | — | −0.050 | 1.000 | — |
| TET4, row sum | — | — | 0.250 | 1.000 | 0.476 |

**Basis.** The space $P_2 \oplus b_{\text{int}} \oplus b_{\text{face}}$ can be carried by the hierarchical basis of the scripts, ten Lagrange functions and five bubbles, or by the nodal basis with unit value at one of fifteen nodes, the `TETRA15` arrangement: vertices, edge midpoints, face centroids, centroid. The space is the same, so every stiffness and stability result is the same; what differs is conditioning, lumping, and the coefficients of a rigid translation. Table 12 gives the measurements at $\kappa/\mu = 2$. The nodal basis conditions the consistent mass eight times better (94 against 778) and the stiffness better (559 against 797). Under HRZ lumping the hierarchical basis loses 51% of the momentum of a rigid translation unless the normalization runs over the Lagrange functions alone (Section 7); the nodal basis conserves it without qualification, and its lumped masses are positive on every element measured. The explicit stable step from the element bound, as the Courant number $c_p \Delta t/h$, is 0.476 for TET4, 0.197 for TET10 under HRZ, 0.145 for the enriched element in the nodal basis under HRZ, and 0.114 in the hierarchical basis under Lagrange-only HRZ, with the same ordering on the distorted and Kuhn elements. The nodal basis is used: every unknown is attached to a node, so no unknown of a new kind is introduced; its mass lumps correctly by the standard construction; and it takes an 18–27% larger stable step under HRZ (17–28% with its row-sum mass against the hierarchical basis under Lagrange-only HRZ), over the reference, distorted and Kuhn elements of `basis_out.txt`.

## 10 Nonlinear results: Cook's membrane

Every measurement of Section 9 is on the linearized operator. This section measures the element in nonlinear solves, against the LCM CT10 on the same meshes, on Cook's membrane: a tapered panel clamped on one edge and sheared on the opposite one [9], in its nearly incompressible form [26] and in its elastoplastic form, both in three dimensions.

Table 13: Cook's membrane, mean $u_y$ of the loaded face at full load. Rows: element size $h$ with the element count. Elastic case: $E = 240.565$, $\nu = 0.4999$, $q = 6.25$. Plastic case: $E = 206.9$, $\nu = 0.29$, $\sigma_y = 0.45$, $K = 0.12924$, $q = 0.14$. TET15-P1 and TET15-P0: the projected strain $\log J$ (Carina 29c9606); the pointwise columns were run with the volumetric energy $\kappa/2\,(J-1)^2$, which differs from the present $\kappa/2\,(\log J)^2$ at third order in $J-1$, below the digits shown. Driver: `benchmark/tet15-p1/cook/run.jl`; records in `results.tsv`.

| $h$ (elements) | TET10 pointwise | TET15 pointwise | TET15-P1 | TET15-P0 | TET10 Albany | LCM CT10 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| elastic | | | | | | |
| 8 (327) | 8.1960 | 8.2235 | 8.4099 | 8.5639 | 8.1960 | 8.4596 |
| 4 (1860) | 8.3241 | 8.3490 | 8.4536 | 8.5124 | 8.3241 | 8.4643 |
| 2 (14 475) | 8.4203 | 8.4300 | 8.4709 | 8.4955 | 8.4203 | 8.4772 |
| plastic | | | | | | |
| 8 (327) | 0.2689 | 0.2700 | 0.2706 | 0.2752 | 0.2689 | 0.2716 |
| 4 (1860) | 0.2710 | 0.2717 | 0.2721 | 0.2744 | 0.2710 | 0.2725 |
| 2 (14 475) | 0.2720 | 0.2723 | 0.2724 | 0.2734 | 0.2720 | 0.2728 |

**Problem.** The membrane is the trapezoid with corners $(0, 0)$, $(48, 44)$, $(48, 60)$ and $(0, 44)$ in the $x$–$y$ plane, of thickness 10 in $z$, with both $z$ faces free. The face $x = 0$ is clamped in all three components and the face $x = 48$ carries a uniform shear traction $q$ in $y$, applied in ten equal load steps. The material is the Simo–Hughes $J_2$ model (Remark 5) in both codes. Two cases: the elastic one, with Young's modulus $E = 240.565$, Poisson's ratio $\nu = 0.4999$ ($\kappa/\mu = 5000$), a yield stress that is never reached and $q = 6.25$, the plane-strain load $F = 100$ per unit thickness divided by the height 16 of the loaded edge; and the plastic one, with the material of Simo and Armero [26], $E = 206.9$, $\nu = 0.29$, yield stress $\sigma_y = 0.45$, linear isotropic hardening modulus $K = 0.12924$, and $q = 0.14$. Their load $q = 0.1125$ leaves the three-dimensional membrane with free faces almost elastic (tip displacement 0.21 with no difference between elements); the quadratic tetrahedron without projection collapses between $q = 0.16$ and $q = 0.20$, and Albany's Newton iteration on the CT10 stops converging at $q = 0.158$ on the middle mesh and $q = 0.137$ on the finest, so the load is 0.14. The measured quantity is the mean of the displacement $u_y$ over the nodes of the loaded face at full load.

**Meshes and elements.** Three `TETRA10` meshes with element size $h = 8$, 4 and 2 (327, 1860 and 14 475 elements; 647, 3208 and 22 059 nodes) are generated by Cubit and used by both codes; the `TETRA15` meshes are their conversions (Section 4.3; 1721, 9127 and 66 813 nodes). Six elements are compared. In Carina: TET10 with the volumetric response evaluated at each quadrature point (pointwise); TET15 pointwise; TET15-P1, the element of this note, with the linear projection; and TET15-P0, the same displacement element with the constant projection. In Albany-LCM: TET10 pointwise, which serves as the cross-code control; and CT10 with the volume-averaged $J$ and pressure. The displacement unknowns are 1941, 9624 and 66 177 on the `TETRA10` meshes and 5163, 27 381 and 200 439 on the `TETRA15` meshes. Both codes converge each load step to a residual norm of $10^{-6}$ absolute or $10^{-8}$ relative with a direct linear solver; both halve a load step whose Newton iteration fails and grow it back after successful steps.

**Cross-code control.** The pointwise TET10 gives the same tip displacement in Carina and in Albany to six digits on every mesh and in both cases (8.19605 elastic at $h = 8$; 8.4202946 and 8.4202943 at $h = 2$; 0.27204 plastic at $h = 2$), although the two codes take the volumetric stress as $\kappa(J-1)$ (Carina before 2026-10-16) and $\kappa(J - 1/J)/2$: at these volumetric strains the two laws agree to the digits shown. The comparison between the other elements rests on this check.

**Tip displacement.** Table 13 gives the results. In the elastic case the pointwise elements converge from below, 8.196, 8.324, 8.420 for TET10 and 8.224, 8.349, 8.430 for TET15, and TET15-P0 from above, 8.564, 8.512, 8.496. TET15-P1, 8.410, 8.454, 8.471, and the CT10, 8.460, 8.464, 8.477, are within 0.6% of each other on every mesh and change least with refinement; the limit lies between 8.477 and 8.496. On the coarsest mesh the pointwise TET10 is 3% below the limit and TET15-P1 0.8% below it. In the plastic case every element converges to about 0.273, with the spread between elements shrinking from 2.3% at $h = 8$ to 0.5% at $h = 2$,

and the projected and composite elements closest to the limit on every mesh; at $\nu = 0.29$ and this load the plastic zone does not lock the quadratic elements. On the finest mesh the elastic runs took 1099 s for TET10 and 3214 to 3639 s for the TET15 variants in Carina on 16 threads of one host, and 26 496 and 28 867 s in Albany with a serial direct solver; at $\nu = 0.4999$ the residual grows with $\kappa$ times the square of the volumetric strain of a Newton step, so every element needs load steps of a fraction of a percent of the load in both codes.

**Pressure fields.** The pressure $p = -\operatorname{tr}\boldsymbol{\sigma}/3$, with $\boldsymbol{\sigma}$ the Cauchy stress, is read at the quadrature points of every element at full load and drawn on the face $z = 10$ of the deformed membrane (Figures 1 to 3). Inside each element the field drawn is the polynomial fitted to the quadrature-point values in the least-squares sense with the weights of the rule: quadratic for the fourteen-point rule of TET15, which reproduces the linear and the constant projection to rounding error and the pointwise TET15 pressure, of higher degree, to 0.11 of its largest value; linear for the four-point rule of TET10, which interpolates; and the single value Albany writes per CT10. In the elastic case the pointwise TET10 and TET15 give a pressure that changes sign inside elements over the whole membrane, on every mesh, with a range on the face of $-226$ to 211 and $-512$ to 1010 at $h = 2$. TET15-P1 is smooth except in the layer of elements along the clamped edge, with a range of $-43$ to 61; TET15-P0 and CT10 are smooth and piecewise constant, with ranges of $-7.5$ to 22 and $-9.4$ to 35. The clamped edge is a singular line of the continuum solution: where a clamped face meets a free face the stress is unbounded, and it grows faster as $\nu \to 1/2$. The jumps of TET15-P1 between neighboring elements confirm that the discontinuities are the element's error at that line and nothing else: at every $h$ the six largest jumps on the face lie within one element layer of the clamped edge, the largest $|p|$ of TET15-P1 on the face grows from 22 to 35 to 61 over the three meshes as an unbounded field requires, and away from that layer and from the loaded corner the median jump falls from 3.9% to 0.35% of the color limit from $h = 8$ to $h = 2$, faster than $h$, whereas for the two piecewise constant elements it is 12 to 15% of the color limit at $h = 2$, in proportion to $h$. In the plastic case no element oscillates, the six fields agree away from the upper corner of the clamped edge, and the largest pressure on the face at $h = 2$ is 0.715 for TET10, 1.15 for TET15 pointwise, 0.519 for TET15-P1, 0.292 for TET15-P0 and 0.407 for CT10. Scripts: `benchmark/tet15-p1/cook/extract_pressure.jl` and `render_pressure.py`.

**A second implementation.** An implementation of TET15-P1 in Sierra/SM, Sierra/SM TET15-P1, was run on the elastic case on the same meshes, with a neo-Hookean material of the same $\kappa$ and $\mu$ (deviatoric part as in Carina, volumetric pressure $\kappa(J - 1/J)/2$, which differs from Carina's at second order in $J - 1$, of order $10^{-4}$ here), the traction applied as consistent nodal forces, and a preconditioned conjugate-gradient solver in the Newton iteration. The mean tip displacement is 8.4139, 8.4555 and 8.4722 at $h = 8$, 4 and 2, against 8.4099, 8.4536 and 8.4709 in Carina, a difference of 0.05%, 0.02% and 0.015%, and the maximum agrees to five digits at every level; both codes project $\log J$, and the remaining difference in the mean is of the order of the difference of the two volumetric laws; without the projection the two codes' TETRA15 agree to 0.05%. The Sierra/SM CT10 is within 0.4% of Albany's at $h = 8$ and 4, and its Newton iteration with that solver stalled at $h = 2$ (`benchmark/tet15-p1/cook/README.md`). Sierra/SM TET15-P1 writes one stress per element; its element pressures at $h = 2$ correlate with the element means of Carina's TET15-P1 to 0.999999, with an RMS difference of 0.0054 against a largest $|p|$ of 30.3 (Figure 4). Without the projection the two fields are not comparable element by element: Carina's pressure oscillates in sign inside each element, and the Sierra/SM value is its average.

**What the benchmark establishes.** The element of this note does not lock at $\nu = 0.4999$ on any of the three meshes, agrees in the tip displacement with CT10 within 0.6% and in the limit of refinement, and gives a pressure that is smooth wherever the continuum pressure is, on a mesh where the quadratic tetrahedron without projection gives a pressure that oscillates in sign everywhere. Its unknowns are 3.0 times those of CT10 on the same mesh, the interior bubble not being condensed in the implementation, and the run times above are those of one implementation with a direct solver; a comparison at equal accuracy is not made. The equivalent plastic strain is not measured here: at $q = 0.14$ the plastic zone of the membrane does not lock any of the quadratic elements, so the membrane does not separate them on that quantity.

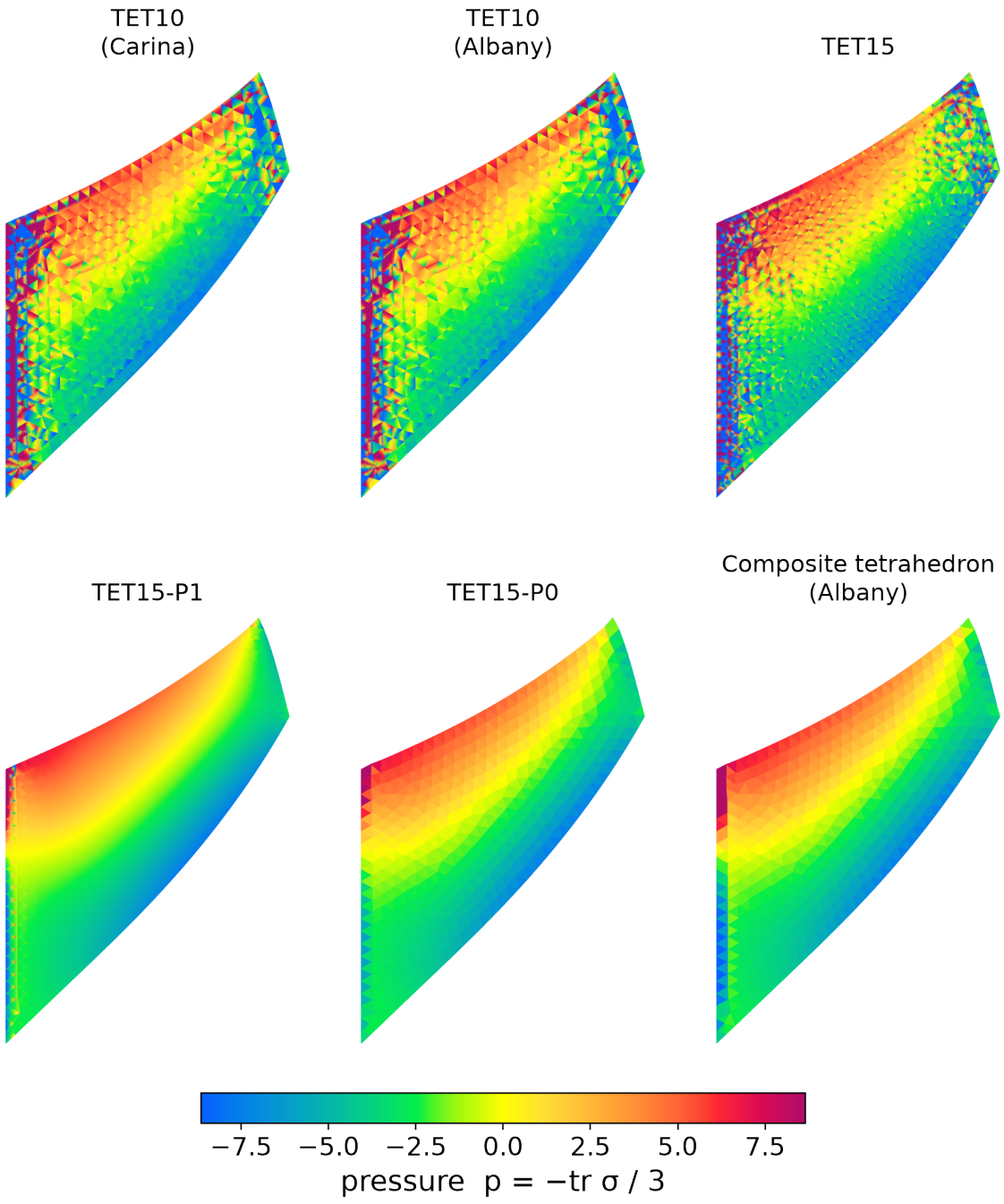



Figure 1: Elastic case, $h = 2$: pressure $p = -\operatorname{tr}\boldsymbol{\sigma}/3$ on the face $z = 10$ of the deformed membrane at full load, for the six elements. One color scale for all panels, symmetric about zero and bounded by the 99th percentile of $|p|$ over TET15-P1, TET15-P0 and CT10; values beyond the scale saturate. Inside each element the pressure drawn is the polynomial fitted to the quadrature-point values (text).

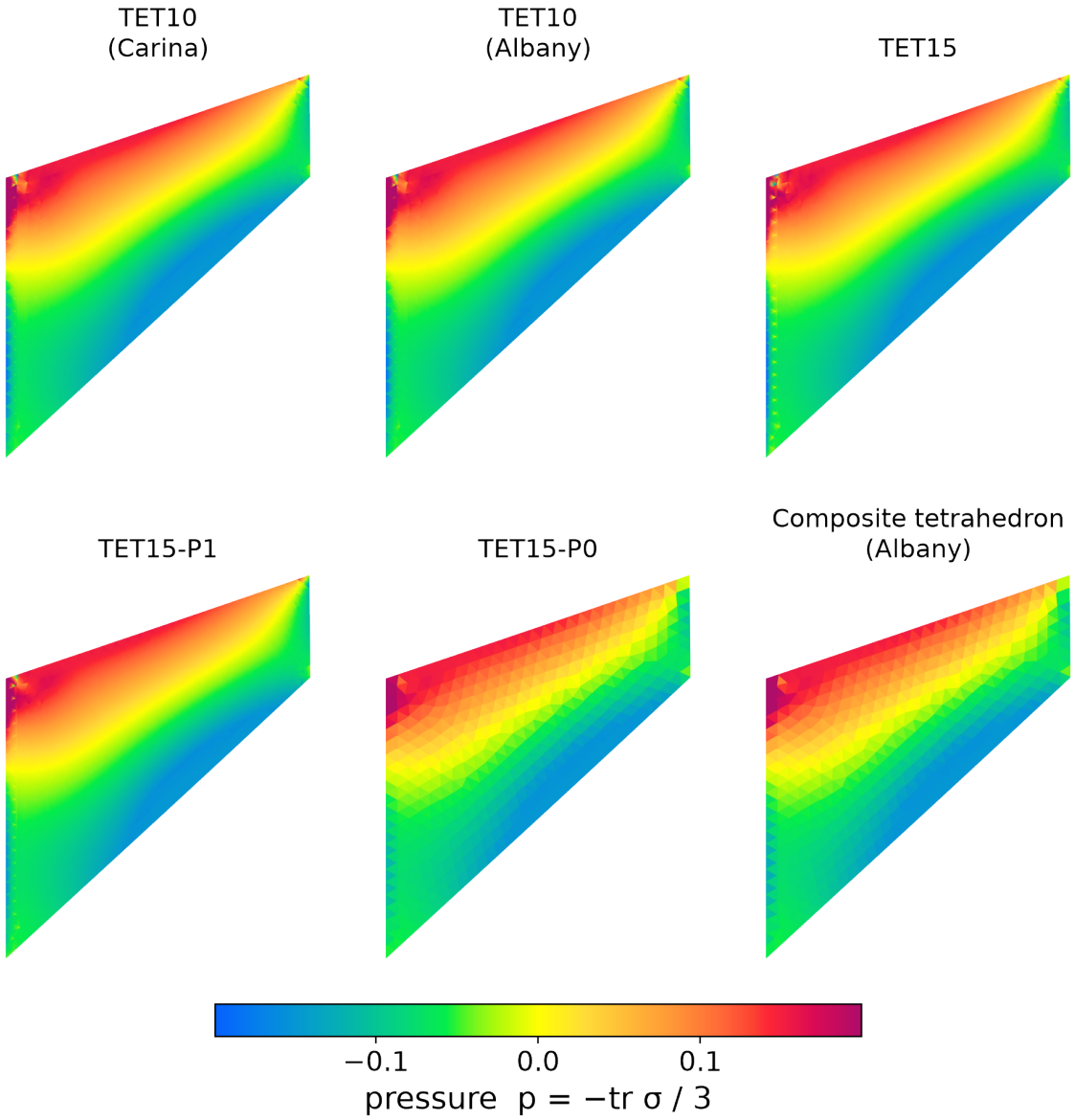



Figure 2: Plastic case, $h = 2$: pressure on the face $z = 10$ at full load, as in Figure 1.

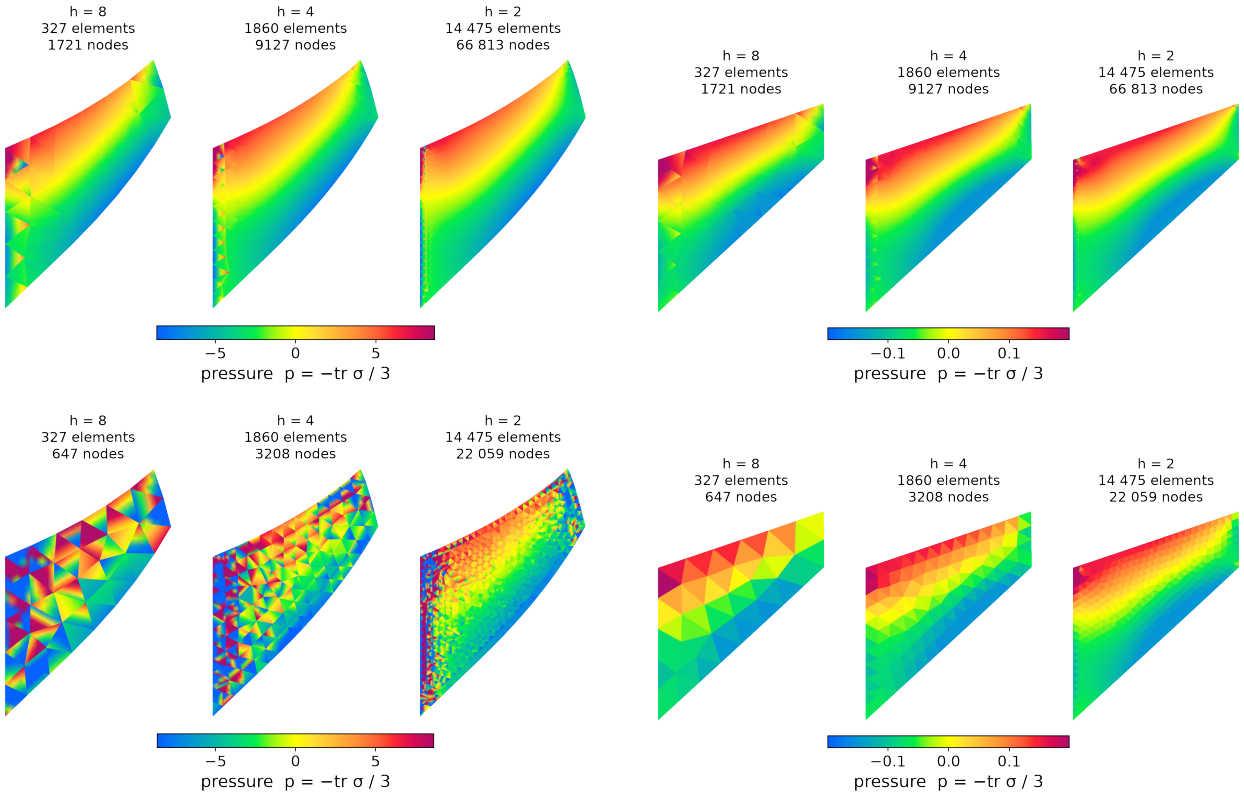



Figure 3: Pressure on the face $z = 10$ under mesh refinement, $h = 8$, 4, 2 from left to right in each panel, with the color scale of the case. Top: TET15-P1, elastic (left) and plastic (right). Bottom left: TET10 pointwise, elastic. Bottom right: the CT10, plastic.

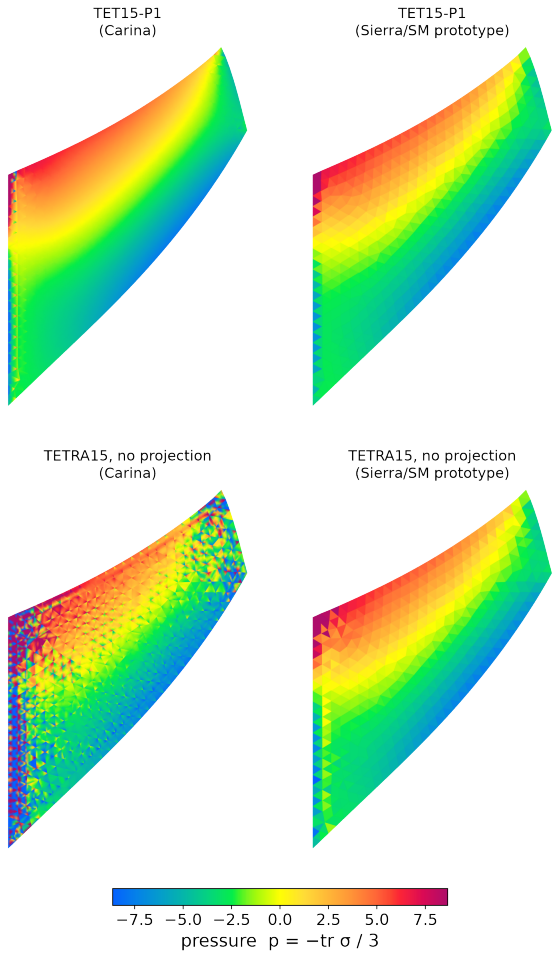



Figure 4: Cook's membrane, elastic case, $h = 2$: pressure on the front face at full load, on the color scale of Figure 1. Top, TET15-P1 in Carina (the quadratic of each element) and in Sierra/SM (one value per element); bottom, TETRA15 without the projection in the two codes.

## 11 Explicit dynamics: the Taylor bar impact

This section measures the element in explicit dynamics with plastic strains above 3, against the Sierra/SM CT10, the code of Foulk III et al. [12], on the same meshes. The quantity measured is the final radius of the impact face, for which a converged reference value exists; the equivalent plastic strain is not measured.

**Problem.** A copper bar of length 32.4 mm and radius 3.2 mm, with its axis along $z$, strikes a rigid frictionless wall at $z = 0$ with velocity 227 m/s [30, 23, 12]. The material has density $\rho = 8930$ kg/m$^3$, Young's modulus $E = 117$ GPa, Poisson's ratio $\nu = 0.35$ ($\kappa/\mu = 3.0$; the plastic flow is isochoric, so the response in the plastic zone is nearly incompressible), yield stress 400 MPa and a linear isotropic hardening modulus of 100 MPa; the Simo–Hughes $J_2$ model (Remark 5) in Carina and the finite-deformation $J_2$ model of the Sierra material library, with the same constants. The wall is the condition $u_z = 0$ on the impact face, which is in contact at $t = 0$ and remains in contact while the bar moves toward the wall. The equations are integrated by central differences with the row-sum lumped mass of Section 7 to $t = 80\boldsymbol{\mu}$s, without artificial bulk viscosity. The measured quantities are the radius of the impact face, the largest distance of its nodes from the axis, and the length of the bar, the largest $z$ of its free end, at every microsecond. Foulk III et al. [12] give 7.22 mm for the final radius of the eight-node hexahedron with constant pressure (Q1/P0) on their finest mesh, $h = 0.047$ mm, which is the reference here; Simo [23] gives 7.12 mm and Zienkiewicz et al. [32] 7.11 mm on coarser meshes.

**Meshes and elements.** Four levels, $h = 1.5$, 0.75, 0.38 and 0.19 mm, of the full bar are meshed by Cubit with four-node tetrahedra, the Cubit size being adjusted until the element count is within 3% of that of Foulk III et al. [12, Figure 14]: 3522, 25 029, 190 727 and 1 521 212 elements, with 5601, 36 666, 267 150 and 2 083 320 nodes as `TETRA10` meshes and 16 587, 113 331, 845 573 and 6 672 877 as `TETRA15` meshes. Each mesh is smoothed by the energetic mesh smoothing of Norma, which minimizes a strain energy of the mesh over the positions of its nodes with every boundary node held on its surface; this raises the smallest shape quality $q = 12\,(3V)^{2/3}/\sum_e l_e^2$, with $V$ the volume and $l_e$ the six edge lengths, from 0.58–0.65 to 0.69–0.71 at every level. The edge midpoints are added with those on the lateral surface projected onto the cylinder (`TETRA10`, the mesh of CT10), and the face and interior nodes are added by the conversion of Section 4.3 (`TETRA15`). Three elements are compared: TET15-P1 and TET15-P0 in Carina, and the Sierra/SM CT10 with its stabilization parameter $\alpha = 0.1$ and the stabilization exponent 0 of Foulk III et al. [12]. The displacement unknowns of TET15 are 49 761, 339 993 and 2 536 719 on the first three levels; those of CT10 are 109 998, 801 450 and 6 249 960 on the second to fourth.

**Stable time step.** The step of central differences is stable when $\Delta t \le 2/\sqrt{\lambda_{\max}}$, with $\lambda_{\max}$ the largest eigenvalue of $M_L^{-1}K$, $M_L$ the lumped mass and $K$ the tangent stiffness. The runs of Table 14 set the step to a Courant number of 0.25 times an element estimate, the smallest distance between two nodes of an element divided by the dilatational wave speed $c_p$, recomputed every ten steps on the current configuration. That estimate is not a bound: $\lambda_{\max}$ computed by power iteration on the TET15-P1 run at $h = 0.75$ mm gives a ratio of the critical step to the element estimate of 1.14 at 1$\boldsymbol{\mu}$s, 1.02 at 10$\boldsymbol{\mu}$s, 0.69 at 20$\boldsymbol{\mu}$s, 0.42 at 28$\boldsymbol{\mu}$s, 0.31 at 40$\boldsymbol{\mu}$s and 0.29 at 60 and 80$\boldsymbol{\mu}$s. At a Courant number of 0.5 the run stopped with a non-finite residual at 28$\boldsymbol{\mu}$s; at 0.25 it reached 80$\boldsymbol{\mu}$s with a step 0.82 times the critical one at 40$\boldsymbol{\mu}$s; TET15-P0 at $h = 0.38$ mm stopped at 78.7$\boldsymbol{\mu}$s, and its radius at 78$\boldsymbol{\mu}$s is reported, the radius being constant within 0.06% after 50$\boldsymbol{\mu}$s for every element (Figure 5). Carina also offers the step $0.8 \cdot 2/\sqrt{\lambda_{\max}}$, with $\lambda_{\max}$ computed every 200 steps and the element estimate scaled by the ratio of the two in between; on the same run it takes 43 863 steps against about 54 000 at the Courant number 0.25, and the final radius differs by 0.0007 mm.

**Accuracy.** Table 14 and Figure 5. CT10 converges from above: its differences between successive levels are 0.0367 and 0.0127 mm, a ratio of 2.89, which corresponds to an order of 1.53 in $h$; the extrapolation of its three levels by that ratio gives 7.2259 mm. TET15-P1 is at 7.2217, 7.2211 and 7.2242 mm at $h = 0.75$, 0.38 and 0.19, within 0.07% of that value, and at 7.2405 on the coarsest mesh, where CT10 did not reach 80$\boldsymbol{\mu}$s. CT10 is 0.78%, 0.27% and 0.09% from the extrapolated value at $h = 0.75$, 0.38 and 0.19. Both elements approach the reference within 0.1% in the limit. TET15-P0 differs from TET15-P1 only in the constant pressure, and it is sensitive to the projected measure where TET15-P1 is not: it is 11% above the extrapolated value at $h = 0.75$ and inverts an element at 1$\boldsymbol{\mu}$s at $h = 0.38$; projecting $J - 1$ instead of $\log J$ changes the

Table 14: Taylor bar, final radius of the impact face and final length of the bar in mm at 80$\mu$s, per element and mesh level $h$ in mm with its element count. Reference: 7.22 for the converged Q1/P0 hexahedron [12]. TET15-P1 and TET15-P0 project $\log J$ (Carina 29c9606; $h = 0.19$ on an A100); TET15-P0 at $h = 0.38$ stopped with an inverted element at 1$\mu$s. With $J - 1$ projected, TET15-P1 gave 7.2399, 7.2225 and 7.2255 at $h = 1.5$, 0.75 and 0.38. CT10 at $h = 1.5$ ended at 41.6$\mu$s. Driver: `benchmark/tet15-p1/taylor/run.jl`; histories in `benchmark/tet15-p1/taylor/data`.

| | | TET15-P1 | | TET15-P0 | | CT10 | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| $h$ | elements | radius | length | radius | length | radius | length |
| 1.5 | 3522 | 7.2405 | 21.4262 | 8.0915 | 21.5434 | — | — |
| 0.75 | 25 029 | 7.2217 | 21.4199 | 8.0249 | 21.5075 | 7.2820 | 21.4760 |
| 0.38 | 190 727 | 7.2211 | 21.4186 | — | — | 7.2453 | 21.4395 |
| 0.19 | 1 521 212 | 7.2242 | 21.4193 | — | — | 7.2326 | 21.4304 |

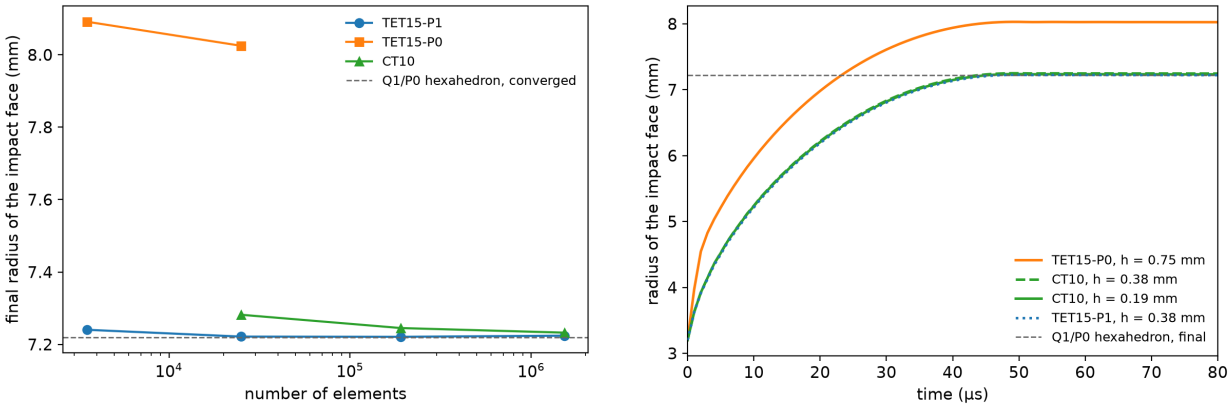



Figure 5: Taylor bar. Left: final radius of the impact face against the number of elements. Right: radius of the impact face against time for TET15-P1 at $h = 0.38$ mm, TET15-P0 at $h = 0.75$ mm and CT10 at $h = 0.38$ and 0.19 mm. Dashed gray: the converged Q1/P0 hexahedron of Foulk III et al. [12]. Carina projects $\log J$. Script: `benchmark/tet15-p1/taylor/plot.py`.

Table 15: Taylor bar at $h = 0.75$ mm (25 029 elements), both codes on the same two-socket AMD EPYC 9634, each run alone. One-core figures from runs to 5$\boldsymbol{\mu}$s. Core-$\mu$s: wall time times the number of cores. Memory of Sierra/SM: the largest of its processes.

| | TET15-P1 (Carina) | CT10 (Sierra/SM) |
|---|---|---|
| per element and step, 1 core ($\mu$s) | 6.27 | 4.47 |
| per element and step, 16 cores (core-$\mu$s) | 15.5 | 5.09 |
| steps to 80$\boldsymbol{\mu}$s | 52 100 | 44 260 |
| time stepping to 80$\boldsymbol{\mu}$s on 16 cores (s) | 1265 | 352 |
| largest resident memory (GB) | 1.63 | 0.27 |
| final radius (mm) | 7.2225 | 7.2820 |

TET15-P1 radius by 0.01% at $h = 1.5$ and 0.75 and by 0.06% at $h = 0.38$. A constant pressure leaves the pointwise $J$ free to vary across the element, and the element mean of $\log J$, unbounded as $J \to 0$ at a single quadrature point, is then far from that of $J - 1$; the linear pressure of TET15-P1 keeps the pointwise $J$ close to the projected one.

**Operations.** The two codes were run on the same machine, a two-socket AMD EPYC 9634 with 168 cores, one run at a time with no other job, at $h = 0.75$ mm (Table 15). Per element and time step on one core, TET15-P1 takes 1.40 times the time of CT10; per element degree of freedom, 45 against 30, it takes 0.93 times as long. On 16 cores the ratio per element and step is 3.0, because Carina's time per step decreases by a factor of 6.5 from 1 to 16 threads, a parallel efficiency of 0.40, against 0.88 for Sierra/SM on 16 processes; the difference is in the implementation of the time step in Carina, not in the element. The time step of TET15-P1 at $t = 0$ is $3.86 \times 10^{-9}$ s under the element estimate at the Courant number 0.25, and its critical step is $1.77 \times 10^{-8}$ s; that of the CT10 is $2.44 \times 10^{-8}$ s.

**Comparison at equal accuracy.** TET15-P1 at $h = 0.75$ mm is closer to the extrapolated radius (0.05%) than CT10 at $h = 0.19$ mm (0.09%). On the machine above, each run alone, the first takes 1303 s on 16 cores, $2.1 \times 10^4$ core-seconds, and the second 10 983 s on 128 processes, $1.41 \times 10^6$ core-seconds: a factor of 67 in core-seconds and of 8.4 in wall time, on 25 029 elements against 1 521 212. At equal mesh CT10 takes 3.6 times less time to 80$\boldsymbol{\mu}$s on 16 cores, with an error 16 times larger.

**The same run on GPUs.** The explicit integration of TET15-P1 runs on a GPU through the same kernels, with the stable step recomputed on the device. At $h = 0.75$ mm with the global stable step, the radius and the length of every output frame of the run are the same numbers to every written digit on the CPU, on an AMD RX 7600 and on NVIDIA L4, V100, A100 and H100 cards (the last four on one mesh, the first two on another smoothing of the same Cubit mesh, which changes the radius by $2.8 \times 10^{-7}$ relative), and so are the 221 stable-step estimates. Table 16 gives the time per step from the kernel timings and the wall time of the run. Three defects were found and corrected in making these runs: the stable-step recomputation read the block sizes and the material properties through accessors defined for host arrays only, so it had never run on a device; the temporaries of the explicit step (about 0.65 MB per step at 340 000 unknowns) are released only when the garbage collector runs, which host pressure did not trigger, so the run exhausted the 8 GB of the RX 7600 after about 5 000 steps, and the collector is now run every 100 steps on a device; and the $J_2$ tangent of the material library built its pull-back in mutable buffers that CUDA places on the device heap, which is never freed, so the matrix-free solves of the implicit tests failed on the L4 after some thousands of tangent calls (the buffers are now immutable, and the tangent is 5% faster on every device). The eigenvalue estimate of the stable step runs 20 to 40 power iterations, each two residual evaluations, every 200 steps. Its share of the run, from the saving of the adaptive interval below, is 14.8% on the RX 7600, 14.4% on the L4, 11.4% on the V100 and about 3% on the H100. An earlier estimate of 25 to 40% on the GPUs, from a single timed estimate, was too high: timed once right after the warm-up of the timing script, the estimate took 1.5 to 4.4 times the median of five. A fixed longer interval is not safe: the ratio of the eigenvalue step to the element estimate falls by up to 11% between two estimates 200 steps apart while the bar spreads, between 8 and 30$\boldsymbol{\mu}$s, and by up to 23% within 1000 steps, more than the 20% margin of CFL 0.8; after 30$\boldsymbol{\mu}$s it varies by at most 1.3% per 200 steps, and after 60$\boldsymbol{\mu}$s by 0.04%. Carina therefore sets the interval from the observed

Table 16: TET15-P1, split form, explicit Taylor bar: time per step of a run from the kernel timings (median of 20, deformed state with plastic strains to 1.0; includes the stable-step estimates at their intervals), in microseconds per element-step, at $h = 0.75$ and 0.38 mm, the ratio of the general form's time to the split form's at $h = 0.75$ mm, and the wall time of the run to 80$\mu$s at $h = 0.75$ mm. GPU rows and the Ryzen row: Carina 36b4a9f and 178e811, the eigenvalue estimate as the median of five (2026-10-06). EPYC rows (*): Carina 9e4bfaf, the eigenvalue estimate timed once (2026-10-04), which on a CPU agrees with the median (on the Ryzen 459.6 against 457.1 ms). Wall times: Carina 9e4bfaf, the H100 36b4a9f. One process alone on each GPU. Scripts: `benchmark/tet15-p1/taylor/kernel_timing.jl`, `timing_table.py`; records in `data/`.

| device | $h = 0.75$ | $h = 0.38$ | general/split | run (s) |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| AMD Ryzen 9 9900X, 12 threads | 0.704 | — | 1.39 | 839 |
| 2×AMD EPYC 9634, 32 threads* | 0.700 | 0.772 | 1.36† | 1283† |
| 2×AMD EPYC 9634, 64 threads* | 0.836 | 0.652 | — | — |
| AMD RX 7600 | 0.430 | — | 1.42 | 513 |
| NVIDIA L4 | 0.321 | 0.279 | 1.71 | 406 |
| NVIDIA V100 | 0.271 | 0.209 | 2.27 | 404 |
| NVIDIA A100 | 0.119 | 0.097 | 2.18 | 227 |
| NVIDIA H100 | 0.069 | 0.052 | 2.43 | 159 |

†at 16 threads.

change (input key `stable time step eigenvalue change` $c$): after each estimate the next interval is the one over which the relative decrease of the ratio observed over the last interval would amount to $c$, at least the given interval, at most twice the last one and at most 16 times the given one. With $c = 0.02$ the run at $h = 0.75$ mm on the RX 7600 takes 52 estimates instead of 220, at intervals from 200 to 3200 steps, 43 557 steps instead of 43 865, and 443 instead of 500 s, with the radius and length histories equal to within $7 \times 10^{-7}$ relative; the same runs take 399 instead of 449 s on the L4, 367 instead of 402 s on the V100 and 155 instead of 159 s on the H100 (a difference within the variation between runs), with the same histories, frame for frame, on the four NVIDIA cards. Applied to the ratios recorded with the fixed interval, the rule keeps the largest decrease of the ratio within an interval at the one over 200 steps.

**A second implementation.** An implementation of TET15-P1 in Sierra/SM, Sierra/SM TET15-P1, was run on the same TETRA15 meshes with the finite-deformation $J_2$ model of the Sierra material library and linear hardening, as in the CT10 runs, and a stable step of 0.25 times the smallest node distance over $c_p$ (the Sierra/SM element estimate, 0.5 times that distance over $c_p$, with an input factor of 0.5). The final radius is 7.2344, 7.2186, 7.2181 and 7.2217 mm at $h = 1.5$, 0.75, 0.38 and 0.19 mm: 0.084%, 0.043%, 0.042% and 0.035% below Carina's at the four levels, both projecting $\log J$ (with $J - 1$ projected in Carina the differences were 0.08%, 0.05% and 0.10% at the first three), and within 0.12% of CT10's extrapolated limit at every level (0.06% below it at $h = 0.19$ mm). Both codes give a sequence that is not monotone at the finest level: the radius at $h = 0.19$ mm is 3.6$\mu$m above the $h = 0.38$ mm value in Sierra/SM and 3.1$\mu$m above it in Carina. Over the run the radii of the two codes differ by at most 0.16%, in the first 10$\mu$s, and after 40$\mu$s by a nearly constant 0.035 to 0.084% that decreases with $h$ (Figure 6); the two codes' $J_2$ implementations and time steps differ. Without the projection, TETRA15 at $h = 1.5$ mm ends at 7.1268 mm, 1.5% below, which is the volumetric locking the projection removes. The step used makes the Sierra/SM TET15-P1's step 7 times smaller than CT10's at 1$\mu$s. The critical step $2/\sqrt{\lambda}$, with $\lambda$ from a converged global estimate, is 2.2 to 3.1 times the element estimate alone before 20$\mu$s and 0.60 to 0.62 times from 40$\mu$s on, at $h = 1.5$ and 0.75 mm: the element estimate alone is not a bound on the deformed meshes, as Carina's node-distance estimate was not (Section 11), and the runs were stable through the input factor, with a margin of about 1.2. The global estimate of Sierra/SM, a power iteration for the largest eigenvalue of $M^{-1}K$, diverged on these meshes. It forms $K\,x$ from the internal force under a trial displacement of fixed size, $10^{-5}$ in model length units (10$\mu$m here); once the iterate concentrates on a few nodes, that displacement inverts quadrature points of the 15-node elements, whose nodes are 0.1 to 0.4 mm apart, and the estimate rises from $2.66 \times 10^{15}$ to $6.6 \times 10^{17}$ s$^{-2}$. The same size makes CT10's first estimate 22% low at $h = 0.75$ mm. With the trial displacement set to $10^{-5}$ of the local element length, and the iteration stopped only when the remaining change extrapolated from successive changes is below $5 \times 10^{-4}$, the global estimate runs to 80$\mu$s with 22% and 15% fewer steps than the element estimate at $h = 1.5$ and 0.75 mm and a final radius within 0.007%; the power iterations add 3 to 5% to the number of steps. Its pressure at 12$\mu$s, one value per element, has the distribution of Carina's

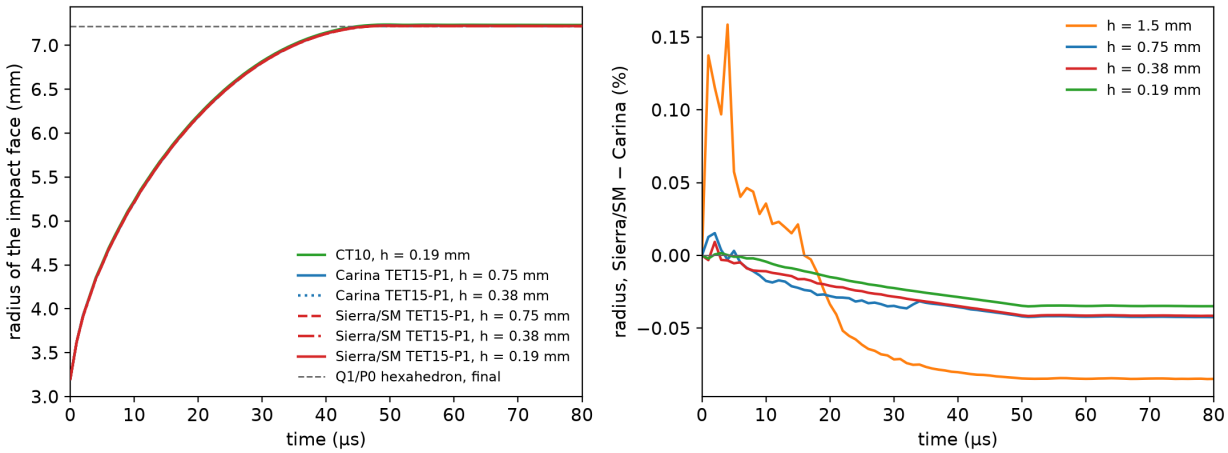



Figure 6: Taylor bar: TET15-P1 in Carina and in Sierra/SM on the same meshes. Left, the radius of the impact face against time at $h = 0.75$ and 0.38 mm in both codes, Sierra/SM TET15-P1 at $h = 0.19$ mm, and CT10 at $h = 0.19$ mm; right, the relative difference of the two codes' radii at the four levels, both projecting $\log J$.

on every mesh, with a largest value of 1.56, 1.62, 1.63 and 1.63 GPa against Carina's 1.67, 1.58, 1.56 and 1.54 GPa at $h = 1.5$, 0.75, 0.38 and 0.19 mm (Figure 7). TET15-P1 took 271 and 6 473 s at $h = 0.75$ and 0.38 mm on 96 and 160 MPI ranks, against 90 and 626 s for CT10, and 598 681 steps at $h = 0.19$ mm on 168 ranks, 71 h on a machine shared with other work (`benchmark/tet15-p1/taylor/README.md`).

**Pressure field.** Figure 8 shows the pressure $p = -\frac{1}{3}\operatorname{tr}\boldsymbol{\sigma}$, positive in compression, on the impact face at $t = 12\boldsymbol{\mu}$s, the time of Figure 12 of Foulk III et al. [12], for both elements on the same meshes. CT10 has one value per element, the element mean of the stress that Sierra/SM writes; for TET15-P1 the pressure in each element is the quadratic fitted to its fourteen quadrature-point values, as in Section 10. The largest pressure on the impact end is 0.33, 0.48, 1.37 and 1.59 GPa for the CT10 at $h = 1.5$, 0.75, 0.38 and 0.19 mm, and 1.67, 1.58, 1.56 and 1.54 GPa for TET15-P1, between 3% below and 5.2% above CT10's value on its finest mesh at every level; on that mesh the two differ by 3%. On the two coarser meshes the pressure of CT10 varies from element to element without a maximum on the axis; TET15-P1 gives the maximum on the axis on every mesh. The radius of the impact face at $12\boldsymbol{\mu}$s is 5.4944, 5.4957, 5.4750 and 5.4661 mm for the CT10 and 5.4517, 5.4507, 5.4533 and 5.4570 mm for TET15-P1. Foulk III et al. [12] plot the $L^2$ projection of CT10's pressure onto a continuous field, and the range of their color scale, $-1.2$ to 0.32 GPa, indicates the mean stress $\frac{1}{3}\operatorname{tr}\boldsymbol{\sigma} = -p$. Scripts: `benchmark/tet15-p1/taylor/pressure.jl`, `render_pressure.py` and `compose_pressure.py`.

**What the benchmark establishes.** In explicit dynamics with plastic strains above 3, TET15-P1 gives the final radius of the Taylor bar within 0.05% of the converged value on a mesh of 25 029 elements, where the CT10 needs 1.5 million elements to reach 0.09%, and the constant-pressure variant on the same displacement space is 2.1 to 3.4% from it. On 3522 elements its largest pressure on the impact face at $12\boldsymbol{\mu}$s is 5.2% above that of CT10 on 1.5 million, and on 1.5 million elements the two differ by 3%. Its time per element and step is 1.40 times that of CT10 on one core. The element estimate of the stable step used by Carina is not a bound on distorted elements; the eigenvalue estimate replaces it. The equivalent plastic strain was not written in these runs and is not compared.

## 12 Quasi-static plasticity: indentation by a flat punch

This section measures the element in quasi-static finite-deformation plasticity with a plastic zone confined by elastic material at $\kappa/\mu = 10^4$, the regime in which the soft mode of CT10 is expected (Section 9.7), against CT10, Sierra/SM TET15-P1 and the plain fifteen-node tetrahedron, on the same meshes. The problem has no published three-dimensional tetrahedral instance; its definition is the reference. The measured quantities

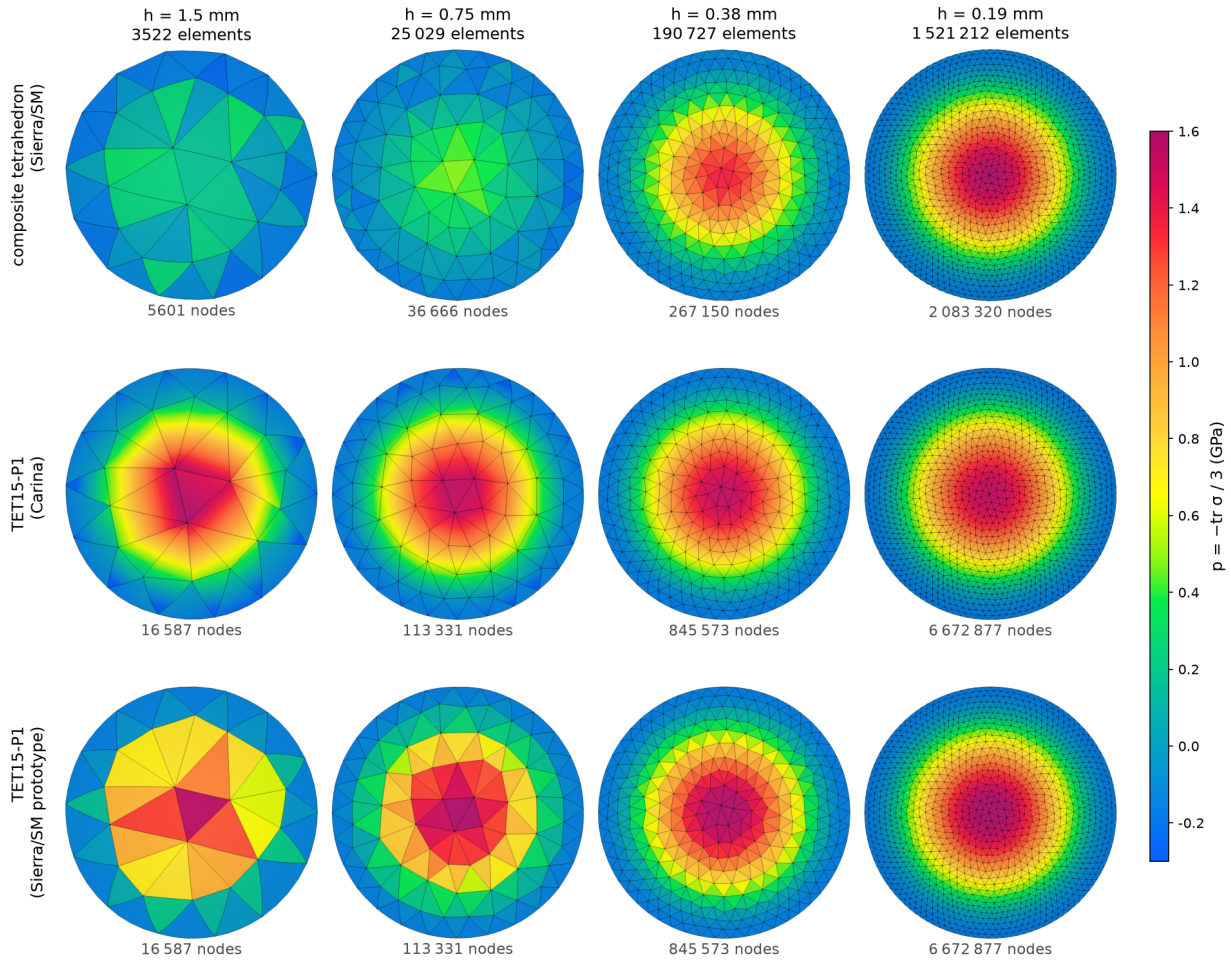



Figure 7: Taylor bar: pressure on the impact face at 12$\mu$s on the scale of Figure 8, for the Sierra/SM CT10 (), TET15-P1 in Carina and TET15-P1 in Sierra/SM (one value per element).

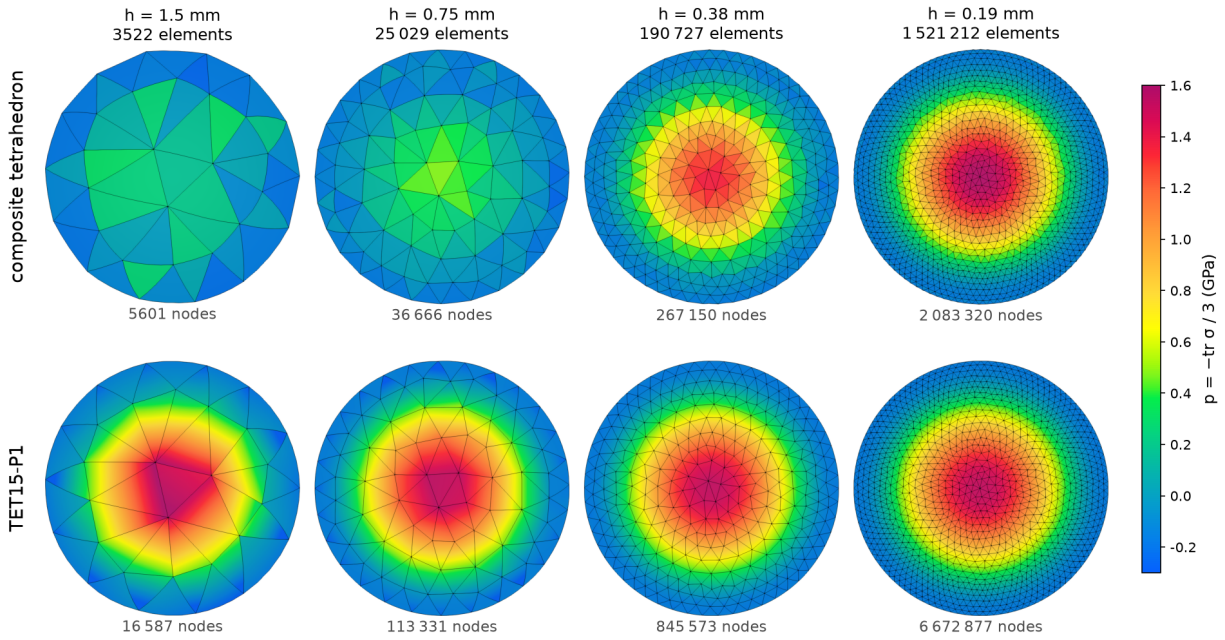



Figure 8: Taylor bar, pressure $p = -\frac{1}{3}\operatorname{tr}\boldsymbol{\sigma}$ on the impact face at $t = 12\boldsymbol{\mu}$s, seen along the axis, on the same meshes for both elements, with the element count of each level and the node count of each mesh (`TETRA10` for CT10, `TETRA15` for TET15-P1); one color scale, values beyond it saturate. Top: CT10 (Sierra/SM, $\alpha = 0.1$, exponent 0), one value per element. Bottom: TET15-P1, the quadratic fitted in each element.

are the punch force, the element-to-element jumps of the pressure and of the equivalent plastic strain near the punch, and the departure of the surface displacement from axisymmetry. The results at the coarsest level are reported here; the finer level is in progress.

**Problem.** A cylinder of radius $R = 4a$ and height $H = 4a$, $a = 1$ mm, rests on a frictionless rigid plane ($u_z = 0$ on the base, $u_x$ and $u_y$ free) and is indented on its top face by a frictionless rigid flat punch of radius $a$ centered on the axis: $u_z = -d(t)$ on every node of the footprint faces, including the nodes on the circle $r = a$, with $u_x$ and $u_y$ free, and $d(t) = 0.2a\,t$ for $t \in [0, 1]$, with output at the twenty times $t = 0.05, 0.10, \ldots, 1$. Under a flat punch every footprint node stays in compression and the material outside piles up beside the punch without meeting it, so this is frictionless contact without a contact algorithm, with the contact set fixed to the footprint. The computational domain is the quarter $x \geq 0$, $y \geq 0$, with $u_x = 0$ on the plane $x = 0$ and $u_y = 0$ on the plane $y = 0$; these conditions remove the rigid-body translations in $x$ and $y$ and the rotation about $z$, so that both codes solve the same discrete problem with no further constraint, and the full punch force is four times the reaction of the quarter. The material is the $J_2$ model with linear isotropic hardening: $\mu = 10^9$ Pa, $\kappa = 10^{13}$ Pa ($E = 2.9999 \times 10^9$ Pa, $\nu = 0.49995$), yield stress $\sigma_y = 10^6$ Pa, hardening modulus $H = 10^7$ Pa (case A) or $H = 0$ (case B); the Simo–Hughes model (Remark 5) in Carina and both the hypoelastic rate form and the multiplicative hyperelastic form of the Sierra material library, which agree with each other to five or six digits in force and to three in the field statistics in every pair of runs. The mean pressure under a smooth circular punch on a rigid-perfectly-plastic half-space is about $5.7\,\sigma_y/\sqrt{3}$, so the full force approaches about 10.3 N in case B as the depth grows, modified by the finite body and the pile-up; at small depth it is the elastic flat-punch value $8\mu ad$ of an incompressible half-space.

**Meshes and elements.** The quarter is meshed by Cubit with four-node tetrahedra of size $h$ within $r \leq 2a$, $z \geq H - 2a$ and $4h$ elsewhere, the quarter circle of the footprint imprinted on the top face so that its edge lies on element edges, and smoothed by Cubit's condition-number smoother only, so that the footprint circle and the symmetry planes stay exact. Three levels, $h = a/4$, $a/8$ and $a/16$, have 6187, 38 818 and 277 530 tetrahedra, 9146, 54 582 and 380 564 nodes as `TETRA10` meshes and 28 129, 172 391 and 1 218 149 as `TETRA15`

meshes; the smallest shape quality is 0.58 to 0.62. Four elements are compared on each mesh: the Sierra/SM CT10 with its stabilization parameter $\alpha = 0.1$ and with $\alpha = 0$ (`TETRA10` meshes), Sierra/SM TET15-P1 and TET15-P1 in Carina (`TETRA15` meshes), and the plain fifteen-node tetrahedron without the projection in both codes, the locking reference.

**Time stepping.** The first iterate of a step from the converged solution with only the footprint displacement advanced carries the whole increment $\Delta d$ in the first element layer: a volumetric strain $\Delta d/h$ and a pressure $\kappa\,\Delta d/h$, $400\mu$ at the nominal step of $0.01a$ at $h = a/4$. Newton converges from that state only while $(\Delta d/h)(\kappa/\mu)$ is below about 1, that is $\Delta t$ below about $1.2 \times 10^{-4}$ at $h = a/4$ (measured: steps converge at $9.8 \times 10^{-5}$ and fail at $1.95 \times 10^{-4}$), which would take $10^4$ steps to $t = 1$. Carina therefore starts each step from $U_n + \Delta U$ with $K_n \Delta U = -K_n[0; \Delta g]$, the response of the tangent at the converged state to the increment $\Delta g$ of the prescribed values, computed by the matrix-free action with $\Delta g$ in the Dirichlet slots (`predictor: tangent`); the right-hand side is not the residual at the advanced boundary values, whose second-order part at $\kappa/\mu \gg 1$ has a component outside the range of the volumetric stiffness that only $\mu$ resists and gives an increment of order $(\Delta d/h)(\kappa/\mu)\,\Delta d$, $400\,\Delta d$ at $h = a/4$, in place of the lift of order $\Delta d$. From the predicted state the error is of second order, and the admissible step is set by $(\Delta d/h)^2 \kappa/\mu \lesssim 1$: both codes start at $\Delta t = 0.05/4096$, double after each converged step up to a maximum of 0.00625 at $h = a/4$ halved per level, halve a failed step and regrow by 1.5, with the twenty output times as block boundaries; Sierra/SM uses its load-step predictor, the previous increment scaled by the ratio of the steps. At 0.0125 on $h = a/4$ Newton needs about fifty iterations with cutbacks; at 0.00625, between two and twenty. The cost of the nonlinear iteration is the change of the active set near the punch edge: quadrature points switch between elastic and plastic states under the iteration, the merit function rises by two orders of magnitude at the full Newton step, and the line search accepts $\alpha = 1/8$ or less with a decrease of 2 to 10% per iteration until the active set stops changing. The algorithmic tangent of the $J_2$ model, the symmetric part of the derivative of the return map, differs from that derivative by 4 to $6 \times 10^{-5}$ of its norm at a homogeneous plastic state in both elements and is not the cause: the homogeneous plastic cube converges in two to three iterations per step with it. The exact linear solves of a direct solver give the same counts as the iterative ones. Applying the Armijo condition to the first Newton iteration after a kept prediction lowers the count in case A from 124 to 77 iterations over the first fifteen steps.

**Linear solver.** Carina solves the Newton systems by conjugate gradients with the smoothed-aggregation multigrid V-cycle of Section 7 applied on the device; Sierra/SM by conjugate gradients with a FETI preconditioner on 8 to 16 ranks. At $\kappa/\mu = 10^4$ the multigrid hierarchy built on the tangent $K(\kappa)$ coarsens on the volumetric couplings and its damped Jacobi smoother, scaled to the diagonal of $K(\kappa)$, leaves the deviatoric error to the Krylov iteration: on the tangent of the $h = a/4$ full cylinder (325 414 unknowns) the count to a relative residual of $10^{-8}$ grows as $\kappa^{0.4}$, 274, 747, 1283 and 1982 for $\kappa/\mu = 10^2$ to $10^5$, against 65 to 75 for the FETI preconditioner on the same meshes. The same V-cycle built on $K(\kappa')$, the tangent of the material with its bulk modulus set to $\kappa' = \mu$, and applied to $K(\kappa)$ needs 330, 483, 523 and 678; the saddle-point form in displacement and projected pressure with the augmented-Lagrangian block preconditioner $\mathrm{diag}\big(K(\kappa'),\, (1/\kappa + 1/\kappa')M\big)$ needs 326 to 340 independent of $\kappa$ but new device kernels. The first is one property substitution in the host assembly of the hierarchy and in the fine smoothing action (`operator: compressible`); on the quarter $h = a/4$ mesh to $t = 0.025$ it takes 34 637 conjugate-gradient iterations in 55 solves against 115 416 in 57, and 700 to 1000 iterations per solve at the plastic steps against 2500 to 3700.

**The jump measure.** Each code writes one value of the pressure $p = -\operatorname{tr}\sigma/3$ and of the equivalent plastic strain per element: in Carina the mean of the fourteen quadrature-point values, in Sierra/SM the element value of the code. Over the interior faces whose two elements have their centroids within $r \le 1.5a$ and $z \ge H - 1.5a$ in the reference configuration, the region around the plastic zone (2548 faces at $h = a/4$, 20 491 at $a/8$), the jump of a quantity $q$ across a face is $|q_L - q_R|$ of the two element values divided by the largest $|q|$ over the elements of the region; the statistics are the mean, the 99th percentile and the maximum over the faces, at $t = 0.5$ and $t = 1$. For a field that the mesh resolves, two neighboring elements differ by about $h$ times the gradient, so the normalized jump is of order $h\,|\nabla q|/\max|q|$ and halves when $h$ halves; for an oscillation that alternates from element to element, a pressure checkerboard, the two neighbors differ by the amplitude of the oscillation whatever $h$ is, and the jump does not decrease. The measure therefore separates

Table 17: Punch indentation, quarter model, $h = a/4$ (6187 elements): full punch force at $t = 1$ in N, mean and maximum of the normalized interior-face jumps of the pressure $p$ and of the equivalent plastic strain near the punch at $t = 1$, the axisymmetry measure, and the number of step cutbacks. Sierra/SM rows: the hypoelastic model; the multiplicative model agrees to the digits shown. Carina rows: V100S, conjugate gradients with the multigrid preconditioner at a cap of 1000 iterations, before the compressible operator. Case B of Carina in progress.

| element | code | force | $p$ jump | | eqps jump | | axisym. | cuts |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | mean | max | mean | max | | |
| Case A, $H = 10^7$ Pa | | | | | | | | |
| CT10, $\alpha = 0.1$ | Sierra/SM | 24.954 | 0.048 | 1.47 | 0.030 | 0.65 | 0.104 | 41 |
| CT10, $\alpha = 0$ | Sierra/SM | 24.202 | 0.044 | 1.44 | 0.030 | 0.69 | 0.168 | 49 |
| TET15-P1 | Sierra/SM | 24.160 | 0.024 | 0.86 | 0.025 | 0.67 | 0.168 | 12 |
| TET15-P1 | Carina | 24.149 | 0.025 | 0.85 | 0.025 | 0.65 | 0.168 | 1 |
| plain `TETRA15` | Sierra/SM | 27.225 | 0.176 | 1.97 | 0.034 | 0.56 | 0.144 | 0 |
| plain `TETRA15` | Carina | 27.221 | 0.152 | 1.53 | 0.034 | 0.56 | 0.144 | 0 |
| Case B, $H = 0$ | | | | | | | | |
| CT10, $\alpha = 0.1$ | Sierra/SM | 14.645 | 0.078 | 1.45 | 0.024 | 0.60 | 0.570 | 57 |
| CT10, $\alpha = 0$ | Sierra/SM | 14.025 | 0.055 | 1.08 | 0.023 | 0.63 | 0.315 | 81 |
| TET15-P1 | Sierra/SM | 14.116 | 0.033 | 0.99 | 0.018 | 0.80 | 0.279 | 86 |
| plain `TETRA15` | Sierra/SM | 18.864 | 0.191 | 1.94 | 0.035 | 0.56 | 0.233 | 3 |

a resolved gradient from a spurious mode by its behavior under refinement, not by its value on one mesh: the quantity of interest is the ratio of the statistics between two levels. The mean is dominated by the bulk of the region, where the field is smooth, and measures its roughness relative to the resolution; the 99th percentile is the roughest one percent of the faces, 25 at $a/4$ and 205 at $a/8$, where a localized mode appears before it reaches the mean; the maximum is a single face, under a flat punch the face at the punch edge where the pressure changes sign through the edge singularity, of order one for every element and every mesh, and carries no information about modes. The measure has three limitations. The normalization divides by the peak of the region, which a mode contaminates: the peak pressure of the plain element at $h = a/4$ is 146 MPa in Sierra/SM and 594 MPa in Carina against 7.5 MPa for TET15-P1, so its normalized jumps understate its mode, and the peak of CT10 is 1.7 to 2.7 times that of TET15-P1 at both levels, so the normalized ratio between the two understates the ratio in pressure units. The measure sees element averages only: the linear variation of the TET15-P1 pressure within an element and the variation over the sub-tetrahedra of CT10 are invisible to it, so a mode confined within elements would not register. Two levels give one ratio, which distinguishes a decrease from no decrease but not first order from second.

**Results at $h = a/4$.** Table 17 gives the full punch force at $t = 1$, the mean and the maximum of the jumps at $t = 1$, and the axisymmetry measure. The axisymmetry measure is the standard deviation over the angle of $u_z$ on the top face in radial bins of width $a/8$, relative to the mean pile-up. The two implementations of TET15-P1 agree in force to 0.05% at $t = 1$ and to 0.17% at every output time, in the jump statistics to the second digit and in the axisymmetry measure to the third, and their meridian renders of the pressure are indistinguishable by eye; for the plain element the two codes agree in force to 0.015%, with a lower pressure jump in Carina because its element mean is over the fourteen quadrature values where Sierra/SM writes one element value. TET15-P1 has the smallest pressure jumps of the four elements, half those of CT10 in case A and 0.4 to 0.6 of them in case B, with comparable jumps of the plastic strain; the plain element is stiffer than TET15-P1 by 12.7% (A) and 33.6% (B) with pressure jumps six to seven times larger, the locking expected of it. The stabilization $\alpha = 0.1$ raises the force of the CT10 by 3.1% (A) and 4.4% (B) and its mean pressure jump by 9% (A) and 42% (B); without it CT10 is within 0.2% (A) and 0.6% (B) of TET15-P1 in force. The axisymmetry measure, 0.10 to 0.57, is dominated by the coarse unstructured mesh at this level and does not discriminate between elements. Sierra/SM TET15-P1 implementation needs 65 to 103 FETI iterations per solve against 154 to 167 for CT10 and about 400 for the plain element.

**What the benchmark establishes so far.** On the coarsest mesh, TET15-P1 in two independent implementations gives the same force to 0.05% and the same field statistics to the second digit, has the smallest element-to-element pressure jumps of the four elements, and takes the fewest linear iterations per solve; CT10 without stabilization gives its force within 0.6% with twice the pressure jumps, and its stabilization raises both. The result of the benchmark, the change of the jump statistics under refinement from $h = a/4$ to $a/8$, is in progress. The definition of the problem, the drivers, the meshes and the extraction are in `benchmark/tet15-p1/punch`.

## 13 Summary of the evidence and open measurements

The formulation rests on six claims. For each, the section that establishes it and the number that carries it are given; the measurements that remain are listed at the end.

**The pair is inf-sup stable in three dimensions.** Section 9.5: the Crouzeix–Raviart pair has $\beta_h = 0.2968$ at a local rate of $-0.003$, above the Taylor–Hood control's 0.2216, with a one-dimensional pressure null space at every mesh; the constant-pressure pair with face bubbles is stable with a constant decreasing toward a limit near 0.35, and the five other element-local pairs decay. The face bubbles are the necessary part of the enrichment; the interior bubble alone is not sufficient (Remark 7). Uniformity in $\kappa/\mu$ follows from stability of the incompressible limit [5, §5.5.2, §8.12.1, Remark 8.12.1]. On deformed configurations (Section 9.6) the constant decreases with the shear of the deformation, to 0.204 at a 90° twist and 0.116 at 180°, and by 7% under a volume change of 2.3, and at each fixed deformation the sequence in $h$ is consistent with a positive limit; the constant is not uniform in the deformation.

**No spurious soft modes.** In elasticity the second hypothesis of Brezzi's theorem holds for every conforming pair (Section 6). The three exact zero-energy modes per element of a constant pressure (Section 9.2) do not persist after assembly (Section 9.4). Under a plastic tangent (Section 9.7) the coercivity constant is bounded below by (48) for every pair, and the dilatation of the soft modes separates them: 0.20–0.27 without decay for the constant-pressure pairs, CT10 with its averaged $J$ among them at 0.22–0.25, $h^2$ decay for the Crouzeix–Raviart pair, and in a confined zone with a varying flow direction no spurious mode among the twenty softest of the Crouzeix–Raviart pair at $N = 5$ against five to nineteen for the constant-pressure elements.

**No volumetric locking.** Section 9.4: the discretely isochoric fraction $\dim\ker \boldsymbol{G}/n_u$ is 0.61–0.63 for the Crouzeix–Raviart pair, at the bound $1 - n_p/n_u$, against 0.03–0.07 for $P_2/P_1^{\mathrm{disc}}$, which locks. Section 10: on Cook's membrane at $\nu = 0.4999$ the element agrees with CT10 in the tip displacement within 0.6% on meshes of 327 to 14 475 elements, and its pressure is smooth away from the singular clamped edge, where the quadratic tetrahedron without projection oscillates in sign inside every element.

**Accuracy in explicit dynamics.** Section 11: on the Taylor bar the final radius is within 0.05% of the converged value on 25 029 elements, against 0.09% for CT10 on 1 521 212, at 1/67 of its core-seconds on the same machine; the constant-pressure variant is 2.1 to 3.4% from it.

**Element-local elimination.** Section 4.2: the pressure is discontinuous, so its elimination is element by element and the tangent has the sparsity of the displacement mesh; the face bubbles add global displacement unknowns, 2.6 times those of $P_2/P_0$ at $N = 12$ (Section 9.3).

**Quadrature and basis.** Section 9.8: the 14-point degree-5 rule keeps six zero-energy modes and the assembled constant within 1%; the nodal basis has a positive row-sum lumped mass that conserves the momentum of a rigid translation, and a Courant number of 0.145 under HRZ lumping against 0.476 for TET4.

**Open measurements.** Three remain. An unstructured mesh sequence for the negative stability results, which are established here on the Freudenthal family only (Remark 8). The smoothness of the equivalent plastic strain in problems with a plastic zone confined by elastic material, where CT10's soft mode is expected: Foulk III et al. [12] report it under contact and on the Taylor bar, and their published examples contain no such problem. Three are planned: the frictionless indentation of a cylinder by a flat circular punch (the classical plasticity benchmark of Prandtl's slip-line solution, used since Nagtegaal et al. [19] as the test of locking in the fully plastic range), the large-rotation twist of a bar, and a weak shock in a material of high $\kappa/\mu$, measured with the implemented Simo–Hughes instance (Remark 5) against the CT10 on the same meshes; Cook's membrane at the load of Section 10 does not separate the elements on that quantity, and the Taylor bar runs of Section 11 did not write it. The comparison at equal accuracy against CT10 has been made on one problem, the Taylor bar (Section 11); a problem that the quadratic element does not resolve on a coarser mesh would give a different result.

## 14 Limitations

This section states what the formulation requires, what it does not establish, and what its parts are.

**The number of unknowns.** The face bubbles of the Crouzeix–Raviart pair are shared between neighbors and do not condense: at $N = 12$ the enriched space carries 96,117 global displacement degrees of freedom against 36,501 for $P_2/P_0$ and for CT10 on the same mesh, a factor of 2.6, and 2.5 times Taylor–Hood's 38,698 (Section 9.3); the implementation does not condense the interior bubble, and on the Cook meshes of Section 10 the factor is 3.0. On the Taylor bar (Section 11) the accuracy on a coarser mesh more than compensates for that factor: the final radius within 0.05% on 25 029 elements, against 1.5 million elements for CT10 at 0.09%. On other problems it is not established; for elasticity that is the comparison with Taylor–Hood, whose pressure is global and whose displacement space is 2.5 times smaller, and for plasticity Taylor–Hood's softest modes are dilatation almost entirely (Section 9.7), so the comparison there is with CT10.

**Operations per element.** With the 14-point rule of Section 9.8 the enriched element evaluates the constitutive law at 14 points on 45 displacement degrees of freedom, against 4 or 5 points on 30 for TET10 and one on 12 for TET4. On the Taylor bar the time per element and explicit step on one core is 1.40 times that of CT10 in Sierra/SM (Section 11).

**The explicit stable step.** Row-sum lumping in the nodal basis gives positive masses and conserves momentum, and the stable step is 3.3 times smaller than TET4's on the same element, of which a factor of 2.4 is the quadratic element and 1.4 the enrichment (Section 9.8). On the Taylor bar at equal accuracy the smaller element count outweighs the smaller step (Section 11). On a deformed mesh an element estimate from node distances does not bound the critical step; a step of 0.8 times $2/\sqrt{\lambda_{\max}}$, with $\lambda_{\max}$ the largest eigenvalue of $M_L^{-1}K$, stays below it, at a cost of 3 to 15% of the run on the GPUs with the estimate every 200 steps (Section 11); a fixed longer interval is unsafe on the Taylor bar, and the interval set from the observed change of the ratio reduces the time of the run by 11% on the RX 7600 and the L4, 9% on the V100 and 3% on the H100. If weak shocks are run with the implicit integrator the factor does not apply.

**The material.** The element places no requirement on the material: the split form of Section 4.4 calls it through the split of Section 3.5, which of the seven material models of Table 1 five have, and the general form of Section 3.6 calls any material at the modified deformation gradient (25), at 1.36 to 1.60 times the split form's time per residual. What the general form requires is a positive volumetric tangent of the material over the states reached, and what it changes for a material whose isochoric response depends on $J$ is that this response is evaluated at the projected volume. The element matrix and the diagonal of the general form take 0.9 and 1.2 times the split form's time on a CPU with 12 threads, and the diagonal 2.5 times on the RX 7600 (Section 3.6). For the split form, the action of the tangent on a vector takes 2.4 times the residual's time on the RX 7600 (20.8 against 8.6 ms on the Taylor mesh at $h = 0.75$ mm).

**The parts.** Mixed volumetric treatment [25], logarithmic-strain plasticity [15] and displacement–pressure pairs satisfying (37) uniformly [5] are established, and the pair itself has been used in large-deformation hyperelasticity [7]. The contribution is their combination for finite-deformation plasticity: an element-local pair satisfying (37) uniformly, a projected volumetric strain, and a deviatoric law evaluated pointwise, which removes the stabilization that the CT10 and variational-multiscale methods carry; together with the measurements that support it, of the dilatation of the soft modes under a plastic tangent (Section 9.7), of the inf-sup constant on deformed configurations (Section 9.6), and of the nonlinear response (Sections 10 and 11). The evidence is that of Sections 9 to 11; the smoothness of the equivalent plastic strain is the open measurement of Section 13. Hybrid high-order methods, with unknowns on element faces and element interiors coupled only through the faces, are locking-free and eliminate their interior unknowns element by element, and exist for small-deformation plasticity [1] and for finite plasticity in logarithmic strain [2]; they are the alternative, at the price of face unknowns that are not the nodal displacements of a standard element.

# References


1. M. Abbas, A. Ern, and N. Pignet. "A hybrid high-order method for incremental associative plasticity with small deformations". In: *Computer Methods in Applied Mechanics and Engineering* 346 (2019), pp. 891–912.
2. M. Abbas, A. Ern, and N. Pignet. "A hybrid high-order method for finite elastoplastic deformations within a logarithmic strain framework". In: *International Journal for Numerical Methods in Engineering* 120.3 (2019), pp. 303–327.
3. F. Auricchio et al. "A stability study of some mixed finite elements for large deformation elasticity problems". In: *Computer Methods in Applied Mechanics and Engineering* 194.9–11 (2005), pp. 1075–1092.
4. F. Auricchio et al. "Approximation of incompressible large deformation elastic problems: some unresolved issues". In: *Computational Mechanics* 52.5 (2013), pp. 1153–1167.
5. D. Boffi, F. Brezzi, and M. Fortin. *Mixed Finite Element Methods and Applications*. Vol. 44. Springer Series in Computational Mathematics. Springer, 2013.
6. F. Brezzi. "On the existence, uniqueness and approximation of saddle-point problems arising from Lagrangian multipliers". In: *Revue Française d'Automatique, Informatique et Recherche Opérationnelle. Analyse Numérique* 8.R2 (1974), pp. 129–151.
7. É. Chamberland, A. Fortin, and M. Fortin. "Comparison of the performance of some finite element discretizations for large deformation elasticity problems". In: *Computers & Structures* 88.11–12 (2010), pp. 664–673.
8. D. Chapelle and K.-J. Bathe. "The inf-sup test". In: *Computers & Structures* 47.4–5 (1993), pp. 537–545.
9. R. D. Cook. "Improved two-dimensional finite element". In: *Journal of the Structural Division, ASCE* 100.ST9 (1974), pp. 1851–1863.
10. M. Crouzeix and P.-A. Raviart. "Conforming and nonconforming finite element methods for solving the stationary Stokes equations I". In: *Revue Française d'Automatique, Informatique et Recherche Opérationnelle* 7 (1973), pp. 33–75.
11. M. Fortin. "An analysis of the convergence of mixed finite element methods". In: *RAIRO. Analyse Numérique* 11.4 (1977), pp. 341–354.
12. J. W. Foulk III et al. "Extending a 10-node composite tetrahedral finite element for solid mechanics". In: *International Journal for Numerical Methods in Engineering* 122 (2021), pp. 6939–6967.
13. E. Hinton, T. Rock, and O. C. Zienkiewicz. "A note on mass lumping and related processes in the finite element method". In: *Earthquake Engineering and Structural Dynamics* 4 (1976), pp. 245–249.
14. T. J. R. Hughes. *The Finite Element Method: Linear Static and Dynamic Finite Element Analysis*. Englewood Cliffs, NJ: Prentice-Hall, 1987.

15. C. Miehe, N. Apel, and M. Lambrecht. "Anisotropic additive plasticity in the logarithmic strain space: modular kinematic formulation and implementation based on incremental minimization principles for standard materials". In: *Computer Methods in Applied Mechanics and Engineering* 191 (2002), pp. 5383–5425.
16. A. H. Al-Mohy, N. J. Higham, and S. D. Relton. "Computing the Fréchet derivative of the matrix logarithm and estimating the condition number". In: *SIAM Journal on Scientific Computing* 35 (2013), pp. C394–C410.
17. A. Mota et al. "Lie-group interpolation and variational recovery for internal variables". In: *Computational Mechanics* 52 (2013), pp. 1281–1299.
18. J. C. Nagtegaal, D. M. Parks, and J. R. Rice. "On numerically accurate finite element solutions in the fully plastic range". In: *Computer Methods in Applied Mechanics and Engineering* 4 (1974), pp. 153–177.
19. J. C. Nagtegaal, D. M. Parks, and J. R. Rice. "On numerically accurate finite element solutions in the fully plastic range". In: *Computer Methods in Applied Mechanics and Engineering* 4 (1974), pp. 153–177.
20. J. T. Ostien et al. "A 10-node composite tetrahedral finite element for solid mechanics". In: *International Journal for Numerical Methods in Engineering* 107 (2016), pp. 1145–1170.
21. S. Sauter and C. Torres. *On the inf-sup stability of Crouzeix–Raviart Stokes elements in 3D*. arXiv:2205.00062 [math.NA]. 2022. arXiv: 2205.00062.
22. G. Scovazzi et al. "A simple, stable, and accurate linear tetrahedral finite element for transient, nearly, and fully incompressible solid dynamics: a dynamic variational multiscale approach". In: *International Journal for Numerical Methods in Engineering* 106 (2015), pp. 799–839.
23. J. C. Simo. "Algorithms for static and dynamic multiplicative plasticity that preserve the classical return mapping schemes of the infinitesimal theory". In: *Computer Methods in Applied Mechanics and Engineering* 99 (1992), pp. 61–112.
24. J. C. Simo and T. J. R. Hughes. *Computational Inelasticity*. Vol. 7. Interdisciplinary Applied Mathematics. New York: Springer, 1998.
25. J. C. Simo, R. L. Taylor, and K. S. Pister. "Variational and projection methods for the volume constraint in finite deformation elasto-plasticity". In: *Computer Methods in Applied Mechanics and Engineering* 51 (1985), pp. 177–208.
26. J. C. Simo and F. Armero. "Geometrically non-linear enhanced strain mixed methods and the method of incompatible modes". In: *International Journal for Numerical Methods in Engineering* 33.7 (1992), pp. 1413–1449.
27. E. A. de Souza Neto et al. "Design of simple low order finite elements for large strain analysis of nearly incompressible solids". In: *International Journal of Solids and Structures* 33.20–22 (1996), pp. 3277–3296.
28. P. Thoutireddy et al. "Tetrahedral composite finite elements". In: *International Journal for Numerical Methods in Engineering* 53 (2002), pp. 1337–1351.
29. N. J. Walkington. *Quadrature on simplices of arbitrary dimension*. Tech. rep. 00-CNA-023. Department of Mathematical Sciences, Carnegie Mellon University, 2000.
30. M. L. Wilkins and M. W. Guinan. "Impact of cylinders on a rigid boundary". In: *Journal of Applied Physics* 44.3 (1973), pp. 1200–1206.
31. S. Zhang. "Quadratic divergence-free finite elements on Powell–Sabin tetrahedral grids". In: *Calcolo* 48 (2011), pp. 211–244.
32. O. C. Zienkiewicz et al. "Triangles and tetrahedra in explicit dynamic codes for solids". In: *International Journal for Numerical Methods in Engineering* 43.3 (1998), pp. 565–583.